



CITY: Pg 3

Eco survey cites rising per capita income, GSDP



NATION: Pg 5

Cong wants India to lead West Asia peace talks



FILM: Pg 14

Many faces of Imtiaz Ali's heroes

IRAN STATE MEDIA SAYS US 'BACKED DOWN' AFTER WARNINGS

Trump halts promised Iran strikes after 'productive talks'; Tehran disputes claim

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI: Iran's powerful Parliament speaker Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf said on Monday that "no negotiations" were held with the United States after US President Donald Trump announced talks were ongoing. "No negotiations have been held with the US, and fake news is used to manipulate the financial and oil markets and escape the quagmire in which the US and Israel are trapped," Ghalibaf said in a post on X.

His post came after Trump said Iran was eager to make a deal and that US envoys were talking to a "respected" Iranian leader.

President Trump extended his deadline for Iran to reopen the crucial Strait of Hormuz to international shipping, saying

CLOSER LOOK

- » No Iranian officials named in alleged US talks
- » Iran's Foreign Ministry rejects Trump's negotiation claims
- » Trump delays strike threat on Iranian power plants by five days

- » Deadline tied to reopening Strait of Hormuz shipping route
- » Trump hints at "complete resolution" if talks succeed
- » War enters fourth week with over 2,000 deaths reported
- » Conflict hits energy markets, drives global oil prices higher

IRAN EAGER FOR DEAL, ENVOYS HOLDING DISCUSSIONS — DONALD TRUMP



into the evening, and that the negotiations would continue.

Trump did not name any official or officials representing Tehran. He said the US has not talked to Supreme Leader Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei. Trump said if a deal is reached with Iran, the US will move to take Iran's enriched uranium critical to its disputed nuclear program.

Shortly after Trump's social media announcement — hours before the deadline was set to expire — Iranian state television declared that the American leader had backed down "following Iran's firm warning."

The war, now in its fourth week, has already seen several dramatic turning points — the killing of Iran's supreme leader, the bombing of a key Iranian gas field, and

Continued on P4

EC REMOVES 73 RETURNING OFFICERS

Bengal SIR: First supplementary voter list released around midnight

Bengal CEO had earlier said 29L cases adjudicated

SOUMITRA NANDI

KOLKATA: After much wait and anticipation, the first supplementary voter list was finally uploaded on the websites of the Election Commission of India (ECI) and West Bengal CEO at around 11:55 pm on Monday. The list provides Assembly-wise details of adjudicated cases, along with the names of voters who have been excluded.

However, the problem with downloading the list persisted until the paper went to print.

Earlier, Bengal Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) Manoj Agarwal stated on Monday that, as of late afternoon, 29 lakh adjudications have been completed out of the 60 lakh cases placed under judicial review. Agarwal had also told reporters earlier that the supplementary list will be released around 9.30 pm on Monday.

"Centralised processing of the list is going on in the office of the apex poll body in Delhi, as the server is located there. We have no such server here. Once we receive the list, we will upload it in the website of our office," Agarwal had said in the evening.

The CEO had informed that adjudication of all the cases has been completed in the districts, namely Kalim-

BENGAL SIR

» The CEO informed that adjudication of all the cases has been completed in the districts, namely Kalimpong, Jhargram, Purulia, and Bankura

» The judicial officers from these districts have been diverted to those places where cases are high

» EC on Monday removed 73 ROs; Most of them are SDOs

» The state comprises 294 Assembly constituencies, and typically, there is one RO assigned to each Assembly segment

pong, Jhargram, Purulia, and Bankura. The judicial officers from these districts have been diverted to those places where cases are high. The move is expected to fast-track the list of cases 'under adjudication'.

The hard copy of the supplementary list will also be published at the office of the district electoral officers (DEOs) and will also be made available to the Electoral Registration Officer, SDO and BDO level, informed an official in the state CEO office.

Continued on P4

lution to the war — though Iranian officials denied there were negotiations. Trump's turnaround appeared to offer something of a reprieve after the US and Iran traded threats

with potentially catastrophic repercussions for civilians across the region.

Trump later told reporters that Iran wants "to make a deal," and claimed US envoys

have been holding talks with a "respected" Iranian leader. He said his Middle East special envoy Steve Witkoff and Trump's son-in-law Jared Kushner, conducted talks Sunday

Stock markets sink, Rupee breaches 94-level

Sensex plunges 1,836 points; Nifty down to 22,512

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: Equity benchmarks tumbled sharply on Monday while the rupee sank to a record low, as escalating tensions in the Middle East, elevated crude oil prices and persistent foreign fund outflows unsettled

markets. The Sensex plunged 1,836.57 points, or 2.46 per cent, to close at 72,696.39 after dropping nearly 1,975 points intraday, while the Nifty fell about 2.6 per cent to end near 22,513. The selloff came as Brent crude hovered above USD 113 per barrel and global markets,

including Asia and Europe, recorded steep declines.

The rupee weakened by 50 paise to breach the 94-dollar mark for the first time, ending at 94.03, pressured by a stronger US dollar and sliding equities. "Spiralling crude prices and foreign outflows

unnerved investors," forex traders said.

Foreign investors sold Rs 5,518.39 crore worth of equities, contributing to a monthly outflow of Rs 88,180 crore, while broader markets and sectoral indices posted widespread losses.

See P10

TIES SET FOR BOOST

Modi to visit Russia this year, says Lavrov

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi is likely to travel to Russia later this year, Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov said, signalling continued high-level engagement between the two countries.

Lavrov made the remarks in a video address to the conference titled 'Russia and India: To the New Agenda of Bilateral Relations'. Referring to President Vladimir Putin's visit to New Delhi in December, he said the trip confirmed alignment in strategic priorities and resulted in "a solid package of documents". He also highlighted the importance of sustained dialogue at the highest levels.

Putin's December visit, described as his tenth to India, was also noted by External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, who addressed the same event. Jaishankar said the visit opened new areas of cooperation, including skilled mobility, health, food safety, maritime collaboration, fer-



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tilisers, customs, commerce, and academic and media ties.

He reiterated that both countries aim to raise annual bilateral trade from \$68.7 billion to \$100 billion by 2030 in a balanced and sustainable way. "We must continue efforts to conclude the India-EAEU FTA, address non-tariff barriers and regulatory impediments, and utilise a skilled Indian workforce," Jaishankar said, adding confidence in Russia as a reliable partner in meeting India's energy needs.

AGENCIES

Centre plans early rollout of Women's Reservation Act using 2011 Census data

Proposal delinks implementation from fresh census and delimitation exercise

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Union government has begun consultations to fast-track the implementation of the Women's Reservation Act by proposing to base the exercise on the 2011 Census and delink it from the pending nationwide census and delimitation process, according to sources familiar with the discussions. The move could significantly expand the strength of the Lok Sabha from 543 seats to 816, with 273 seats earmarked for women, marking a major structural shift in parliamentary representation.

Officials indicated that the government is considering introducing an amendment during the ongoing Budget session to enable early rollout of the quota. The current law,



- » Lok Sabha strength may rise from 543 to 816 seats
- » Around 273 seats likely reserved for women under new framework

passed in 2023 as the Constitution (One Hundred and Sixth Amendment) Act, mandates that one-third reservation for women in the Lok Sabha and state assemblies will only take effect after a fresh census and a subsequent delimitation exercise. With the census timeline uncertain and possibly extending beyond 2029, the govern-

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Current law mandates reservation only after census and delimitation
- » Government considering constitutional amendment to bypass existing condition
- » Section 5 of the Act would need modification
- » BJP lacks numbers, seeking opposition support for passage

» Amendment requires two-thirds majority in both Houses under Article 368(2)

» Amit Shah held talks with BJD, YSRCP, NCP (SP), Shiv Sena (UBT), AIMIM

» Further consultations planned with Congress, TMC, DMK and SP

» Proposal includes 50 percent increase in Lok Sabha and Assembly seats

ment is exploring legal changes to bypass this requirement.

Sources said the proposed framework would require amending Section 5 of the Act, which ties implementation to post-census delimitation. As a constitutional amendment, it would need to be passed under Article 368(2), requiring approval by a majority of

the total membership in both Houses of Parliament and at least two-thirds of members present and voting.

The Bharatiya Janata Party, which has 240 members in the Lok Sabha and 103 in the Rajya Sabha, does not have sufficient numbers to secure passage on its own. This has prompted outreach to

Continued on P4

India braces for energy shock as PM warns of tough days ahead

Will overcome West Asia crisis like Covid, Modi tells Lok Sabha

VINAY KUMAR

NEW DELHI: Amid rising tensions in West Asia and concerns over supply disruptions through the vital Strait of Hormuz, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday said that the war will have far-reaching consequences, adding that India must prepare for long-term impact.

"Another major challenge of the war is that summer is beginning in India. In the coming days, with rising temperatures, the demand for electricity will increase. Currently, adequate coal stocks are available at all power plants across the country," the Prime Minister said.

He drew a parallel between the COVID-19 pandemic and the current geopolitical situation because of the war in the Middle East, saying elements such as black marketeers and hoarders try to take advantage of such crises and urged all political parties and governments to stay united.

The Prime Minister was addressing the Lok Sabha on the Middle East conflict and the challenges it has created for India. Advising state governments to stay alert, he said that elements such as hoarders become active during such crises, and strict monitoring



TAKEAWAYS

- » Modi says India must prepare for prolonged instability and remain united
- » Power demand to rise with summer; government assures adequate coal stocks at plants
- » PM draws parallels with COVID-19 pandemic, warning against hoarding and black marketing
- » Urges strict monitoring to curb hoarders and prevent artificial shortages
- » India expands energy import sources from 27 to 41 countries, reducing dependency

and swift action are required to tackle this menace. "Because of this war, the difficult global situation may continue for a long time. Therefore, we must remain prepared and stay united."

Continued on P4

SEBI NSE IPFT

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TERROR MODULE BUSTED

Key operative of Pak-based terrorist Shahzad Bhatti’s network held: Cops

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police’s Special Cell has arrested a key operative of Pakistan-based terrorist Shahzad Bhatti’s network and busted a module that was recruiting Indian youths through social media and grooming them for activities ranging from propaganda to terror attacks, an official said on Monday.

The accused, identified as Harmandeep Singh alias Harman (18), a resident of Rampur in Uttar Pradesh, was apprehended following discreet surveillance on Bhatti and his foreign-based network, he said.

“The arrest has exposed a structured terror syndicate being operated remotely from Pakistan, wherein handlers were targeting vulnerable youth in India and luring them with promises of money, recognition and a lavish lifestyle,” Deputy Commissioner of Police (Special Cell) Narra Chaitanya said in a statement.

Police said the accused was in regular contact



Police said the accused was in regular contact with Bhatti

FILE IMAGE

with Bhatti and his associates through multiple social media platforms. His mobile phone allegedly contained incriminating chats with Pakistan-based handlers, along with photos and videos of activities carried out at their behest.

Harman also claimed that his associates were involved in a firing incident in the Kashmiri Gate area in Delhi.

It also emerged during the probe that a Pakistan-based associate of Bhatti had pub-

licly claimed responsibility for planning the incident on social media, they said.

“As part of his assigned tasks, Harman was instructed to paint graffiti at public places to spread fear and attract attention towards the module. Acting on these directions, he allegedly painted graffiti at three locations in Talwara in Punjab’s Hoshiarpur district and shared images and videos with his handlers as proof,” the officer said.

A black spray paint bottle

TAKEAWAYS

» The arrest has exposed a structured terror syndicate being operated remotely from Pakistan

» Handlers were targeting vulnerable youth, luring them with promises of money, recognition and a lavish lifestyle: DCP

» Police officials said the module followed a well-defined modus operandi

DCP Chaitanya said. Initially, they were given low-risk assignments such as arranging logistics, transferring money, conducting reconnaissance of sensitive locations and sharing videos, or painting graffiti at public places.

After gaining their trust and assessing their commitment, handlers would escalate their roles to more serious tasks such as carrying out grenade attacks or firing incidents, the officer said.

“During interrogation, Harman revealed that he had discontinued his studies at an early stage and later became active on social media platforms. Influenced by posts showcasing the lifestyle... of gangsters, he developed an inclination towards joining such networks,” Chaitanya said.

Police said the accused was recruited into a terror module, tasked with expanding its network and planning attacks, including a grenade strike in Rampur. His arrest thwarted potential threats.

TIGHT VIGIL FOR NAVRATRI

High alert in Uttam Nagar

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Security remains heightened in south-west Delhi’s Uttam Nagar, with markets witnessing low footfall and police maintaining a high alert to ensure law and order for the Navratri festival, an official said on Monday.

The police had detained more than 100 people as a preventive measure during Eid to avoid any untoward incident. All of them were later released after verification, he said.

“The security will be deployed in JJ Colony area during the Navratri festival. This is a completely precautionary step to maintain peace during the festival,” Deputy Commissioner of Police (Dwarka) Kushal Pal Singh said.

He further said that the situation is now normal, but the police are continuing heightened vigilance in view of festivals. People have been advised to maintain law and order and not pay heed to rumours.

On Holi (March 4), a 26-year-old man, Tarun, died after being injured in a clash between two neighbouring families in JJ Colony. The altercation was triggered after a water balloon thrown by a girl from one community accidentally hit a woman



from the other.

Many Hindu political outfits demanded strict action against the accused and even blocked the road near Uttam Nagar East Metro station. The police had to use mild force to disperse the protestors.

The police have so far arrested and apprehended 16 people, including three women and two juveniles, and further investigation is underway.

The police also said that they are continuously monitoring on the ground and online media platforms. “The police are closely monitoring social media platforms to curb the spread of misinformation and provocative content. Strict action will also be taken against those found spreading rumours,” the officer said.

Sources said that so far, requests have been sent to block more than 200 suspicious social media accounts, out of which around 70 to 80

have already been blocked. These accounts were primarily active on different social media platforms.

“During the probe, it also came to light that some people had circulated emotional videos related to the incident and managed to collect nearly Rs 37 lakh within two days through online funding. The police have frozen the amount and are examining the sources of the funds,” he added.

On the ground, elaborate security arrangements remain in place. Heavy barricading has been installed outside the Uttam Nagar police station, with separate entry and exit routes created to regulate movement. Every person passing through key points is being checked thoroughly. The impact of the heightened security is visible in local markets, including Hastal Colony and nearby commercial areas, where several shops remain partially shut and customer footfall is significantly lower than usual.

Traders said heavy police deployment has hit business, with residents limiting movement. Police maintained the situation is peaceful, adding regular meetings with ‘aman’ committees are being held.

Power rates may rise as govt prepares to clear discom dues

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The electricity rates in the city are likely to rise from April as the Delhi government is preparing for disbursement of pending dues of over Rs 38,000 crore to the three power discoms, officials said on Sunday.

The government is, however, planning to subsidise the hike in power tariff to cushion the impact on the consumers, they said.

The Supreme Court in August last year directed that the regulatory assets, including carrying costs of Rs 27,200 crore, be paid to Delhi’s three private discoms, BRPL, BYPL and TPDDL, in seven years.

Regulatory assets — costs that are expected to be recovered in future — have risen sharply due to a lack of any power tariff hike in the past decade under the Aam Aadmi Party rule.

Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission (DERC), city’s power regulator, informed the central agency, Appellate Tribunal for Electricity (APTEL), in January that total regulatory assets in Delhi stand at Rs 38,552 crore.

As per DERC filing, the outstanding amount includes Rs 19,174 crore for BRPL, Rs 12,333 crore for BYPL and Ra



7,046 crore for TPDDL. The amounts are approved expenditures incurred by the discoms for supplying electricity.

The original regulatory asset amounts have increased due to piling up interest because of the delay in recovery, they said.

The court had also directed DERC to prepare a recovery plan, account for carrying costs (interest) and conduct a detailed audit explaining the prolonged delay in cost recovery.

The recovery is likely to be made through an increased regulatory asset surcharge in electricity bills over a seven-year period.

Delhi Power Minister Ashish Sood in March last year said the discoms were authorised to recover Rs 27,000 crore accumulated as regulatory assets, hinting that the electricity rates may go up in the city.

1 killed, another hurt in motorcycle accident near Signature Bridge

NEW DELHI: A 17-year-old boy was killed and another minor was injured after their motorcycle met with an accident near Signature Bridge in northeast Delhi, police said on Monday.

The incident occurred on the intervening night of Sunday and Monday. Police received an information about the accident and rushed to the spot near Signature Bridge, where a motorcycle was found in a damaged condition.

“By the time the police team reached the spot, the injured had already been shifted to a nearby hospital in Civil Lines by passersby. At the hospital, one of the injured, identified as Nikhil (17), was declared brought dead,” a senior police officer said. The deceased was a resident of Karawal Nagar Extension in northeast Delhi. Inderjit (16), also a resident of Karawal Nagar, sustained minor injuries in the accident and was discharged after



receiving treatment, he added.

Police said a forensic team inspected the scene of the accident and collected evidence to ascertain the sequence of events leading to the crash. A case has been registered at New Usmanpur police station, and further investigation is underway.

Police said that efforts are being made to determine the exact cause of the accident, including whether overspeeding. “We are checking CCTV footage if any other vehicle is involved in the crash. Teams have been formed to investigate the entire matter,” the officer said. MPOST

INDUCTION COOKING ADDS TO FINANCIAL BURDEN

LPG hike leaves students, small vendors struggling

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The recent hike in LPG cylinder prices has severely disrupted daily life across sections of the city, affecting household cooking, small businesses, and informal settlements.

The sudden increase has not only made cooking unaffordable for many but has also halted income for several small vendors who rely heavily on LPG for their livelihoods.

The impact has been particularly visible among students, street vendors, and residents of jhuggi jhopdi clusters, many of whom depended on local gas stove retailers who previously sold LPG in smaller quantities at relatively affordable rates.

Before the price hike, these retailers supplied gas at approximately Rs 100–110 per kilogram, enabling low-income households and students in rented accommodations to manage their daily cooking needs.

However, following the price increase, most of these retailers have either shut operations or significantly raised prices to Rs 300–450 per kilogram.

Students living in rented



apartments have been among the worst affected, as they now face limited and costly alternatives.

A Delhi University student expressed concern over the situation, saying, “We are stuck without a practical solution. If we switch to induction stoves, landlords demand extra electricity charges, but cooking with gas was much more manageable earlier.”

Similarly, a student from IGNOU highlighted the difficulties during the examination period, stating, “With exams approaching, going back home is not an option, but this situation is forcing us to shift to expensive alternatives like induction cooking.”

Small food vendors, whose daily income depends on unin-

“Our entire daily earnings have been affected. Earlier, we could easily get gas from local suppliers, but now it has become almost impossible”

shared his distress, saying, “We are struggling to cook food at home. We depended on local gas sellers, but now even they don’t have supply.”

Another resident pointed out the exploitation by some sellers, stating, “Some retailers still have gas, but they are selling it at three to four times the earlier rate, which is simply unaffordable for us.”

The shutdown of informal LPG retail operations has exposed the vulnerability of those who depended on such networks for affordable cooking gas. While these retailers previously filled a critical gap in accessibility, the current price surge has rendered their services either unsustainable or exploitative due to steep price increases.

As LPG prices continue to rise, the burden is being disproportionately borne by economically weaker sections, students, and small-scale vendors.

With limited access to affordable alternatives and no immediate relief in sight, many households are being forced to cut down on basic cooking needs, while others are shifting to costlier or less convenient methods, further straining their daily lives.

Homebuyers get possession in delayed Amrapali project

DIPIKA KIROLA

GREATER NOIDA: After years of uncertainty and financial strain, thousands of homebuyers have begun receiving possession of flats in the long-delayed Amrapali Verona Heights project, nearly 15 years after bookings first opened.

Launched by the Amrapali Group, the project remained incomplete for years due to financial mismanagement and legal hurdles, leaving buyers in limbo. Many continued paying EMIs while also bearing rental costs.

The situation improved following intervention by the Supreme Court of India, which stepped in to safeguard homebuyers’ interests and appointed NBCC (India) Limited to complete stalled projects. Construction has since progressed steadily under court supervision.

Supreme Court intervention led to project revival

Officials said possession of around 3,500 flats has now begun in phases, with basic amenities such as electricity, water supply and internal infrastructure in place to support residents.

For many allottees, the development ends a prolonged period of anxiety. Several buyers said they had waited over a decade for their homes and had nearly lost hope at various stages.

Authorities added that work is ongoing to complete the remaining units and ensure timely delivery. The project’s revival is being seen as a significant step towards resolving delayed housing projects in the region and restoring confidence among homebuyers.

News at a Glance

STUDENT IN COP NET FOR ROLE IN CYBER FRAUD SYNDICATE: POLICE

NEW DELHI: A cyber fraud syndicate that duped investors on the pretext of high stock market returns has been busted with the arrest of a 24-year-old student from Gurugram, police said. The accused, Aniruddh Pratap Singh, allegedly created shell companies and bank accounts to route cheated money. The case surfaced after a victim lost Rs 6.83 lakh via fake investment schemes. Police said Rs 1.7 lakh was traced to the accused’s account, with 18 complaints linked so far.

DOMESTIC HELP NABBED FOR THEFT

NEW DELHI: A 23-year-old domestic help has been arrested for allegedly stealing cash from his elderly employer’s residence in north Delhi, police said. The accused, Tilakram, was apprehended from Jammu after fleeing following the March 14 theft. Police recovered Rs 1.17 lakh from his possession and froze Rs 1.04 lakh in his bank account. The case was registered at Mukherjee Nagar police station after a complaint by a 66-year-old resident of Tagore Park.

MANGOLPURI: CLUSTER BUS HITS TREE, POLE; ONE INJURED; DRIVER DETAINED

NEW DELHI: A man sustained serious injuries after a cluster bus ramed into a tree and an electric pole in outer Delhi’s Mangolpuri area on Monday, police said. The driver, identified as Narender, has been detained for questioning. The accident occurred near the Police Colony when the bus, heading towards Mangolpuri police station, reportedly lost control after its front axle broke. The vehicle veered off the road before crashing. The injured pedestrian, Nitin (30), was rushed to a hospital. Police said a case is being registered and further investigation is underway.

HISTORIC COURTROOM RESTORED TRANSPORT, WELFARE, WATER GET MAJOR ALLOCATIONS; ELECTRIC BUS FLEET EXPANDS

CM Gupta unveils statue of Bhagat Singh on Shaheed Diwas

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday unveiled a statue of Bhagat Singh and inaugurated a restored historic courtroom on Shaheed Diwas at the Registrar Cooperative Society (RCS) office, Parliament Street.

Gupta said the site holds historical importance as it is where Bhagat Singh, Shivaram Rajguru and Sukhdev Thapar were tried after the Assembly bombing, adding that the premises still remain largely unchanged.

She said every Indian should visit the place to understand the legacy of freedom fighters and remember their sacrifice. The chief minister said some people do politics in the name of martyrs but fail to follow their ideals or sacrifices in their own lives. She said the nation will always remember their martyrdom and she bows to them with respect.

Delhi Social Security Minister Ravindra Singh Indraj said the initiative is a tribute to the martyrs and an effort to preserve the historical site.

Indraj said the corridor where the slogans of “Inquilab



Initiative is a tribute to the martyrs: Min

Zindabad” once echoed has been recreated and facts related to Bhagat Singh have been preserved for visitors. He said the courtroom has been restored to reflect how it looked during the trial, with efforts made to recreate the surroundings of that period.

He added that the site has been developed as a place where people, especially the youth, can learn about Bhagat Singh's life and ideals.

The minister said the project was completed under the initiative of the chief minister with support from PWD Minister Parvesh Verma.

Survey: Delhi processes only about 63% of its daily waste

NEW DELHI: Delhi generates nearly 11,862 tonnes of municipal solid waste daily, while processing capacity stands at 7,641 tonnes per day, leaving a gap of around 4,200 tonnes, according to the Economic Survey 2025–26.

Of the total waste, about 11,500 tonnes come from the Municipal Corporation of Delhi, with smaller shares from New Delhi Municipal Council and the Delhi Cantonment Board. While waste collection has reached 100 per cent, actual processing is about 7,460 tonnes per day, or 62.9 per cent.

Segregation remains uneven, with MCD areas at around 59 per cent, compared to over 90 per cent in NDMC and cantonment zones.

To bridge the gap, the government plans to add 7,750 tonnes per day capacity through new and expanded waste-to-energy plants, including facilities at Narela-Bawana and Ghazipur, and expansion of existing plants at Okhla and Tehkhand. Despite decentralised composting and recycling efforts, a significant volume of unprocessed waste continues to be dumped at landfill sites. MP0ST

AAP MLA’s car vandalised in east Delhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Aam Aadmi Party MLA Kuldeep Kumar alias Monu on Monday alleged his car was vandalised by some unknown people in east Delhi's Madhu Vihar, police said.

The incident was reported at 7.03 pm at the local station.

“Upon reaching the location, they found the MLA, who represents the Kondli Assembly constituency, present there along with his vehicle. The MLA informed the police that his car was parked on a road-side in front of a sweets shop when unknown persons allegedly targeted it,” an officer said.

The car's left rear quarter glass was shattered, indicating deliberate damage, the officer said.

The police have filed a case and begun scanning CCTV footage from cameras in the area.

PAC tables report on excise policy, cites losses from waiver and gaps

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A report of the Delhi Assembly's Public Accounts Committee (PAC), tabled on Monday, has flagged losses of Rs 890 crore due to failure to re-tender surrendered liquor shop licences, along with an additional Rs 144 crore loss linked to licence fee waivers under the excise policy 2021–22.

Presenting the report, PAC chairman Ajay Mahawar said it is based on findings of the Comptroller and Auditor General of India and action taken notes of the excise department, ensuring that it does not interfere with ongoing investigations or legal proceedings.

The CAG audit on the regulation and supply of liquor in Delhi, originally tabled in the Assembly in February 2022, had pointed to several discrepancies in the way

Eco survey cites rising per capita income, GSDP; CM says evidence of rapid growth

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday presented the Economic Survey 2025–26 in the Assembly on the opening day of the Budget Session, stating that it reflects “the capital's rapidly growing economy, robust infrastructure, and pro-people welfare policies.” She added that the government aims to make Delhi a “world-class, inclusive, equitable, and livable city.”

The survey estimates Delhi's Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) at Rs.13.27 lakh crore in 2025–26, registering a growth of 9.42 per cent at current prices. At constant prices, GSDP is projected at Rs.7.76 lakh crore, growing 8.53 per cent. The survey notes a steady growth trajectory in recent years, despite global and domestic challenges.

Per capita income is estimated at Rs.5,31,610, marking a 7.92 per cent increase over the previous year, and remains about 2.5 times higher than the national average. At constant prices, it is projected at Rs.3,05,433, reflecting a 7.09 per cent real increase.



Delhi's economy continues to be service-driven, with the sector contributing 86.32 per cent to Gross State Value Added (GSVA), followed by the secondary sector at 12.88 per cent and the primary sector at 0.80 per cent. Trade, hotels and restaurants account for Rs.1.38 lakh crore, contributing 11.59 per cent to GSVA, maintaining a consistent share over the past 15 years.

A major highlight is the 145 per cent increase in capital expenditure, indicating a strong push towards infrastructure and asset creation. The fiscal deficit stands at Rs.13,703 crore, within the 3 per cent of GSDP limit, while Delhi continues to maintain a

HIGHLIGHTS

- » A major highlight is the 145 per cent increase in capital expenditure, indicating a strong push towards infrastructure and asset creation
- » The fiscal deficit stands at Rs 13,703 crore, within the 3 per cent of

GSDP limit, while Delhi continues to maintain a revenue surplus of Rs 9,661.31 crore (0.73 per cent of GSDP)

- » In water supply, 93.5 per cent households now have piped water access, with supply maintained at around 1,000 MGD daily

revenue surplus of Rs.9,661.31 crore (0.73 per cent of GSDP). Around 68.7 per cent of expenditure is financed through own tax revenue, with GST and VAT contributing over 71 per cent of collections. Tax revenue is expected to grow by 15.54 per cent. The total budget for 2025–26 is Rs.1 lakh crore, with Rs.59,300 crore allocated for schemes, programmes and projects, up by ₹20,300 crore from the previous year. Sector-wise allocations include transport (20 per cent), social security and welfare (17 per cent), water supply and sanitation (15 per cent), education (13 per cent) and health (12 per cent).

The survey highlights

improvements across sectors. In transport, electric buses increased from 2,150 in April 2025 to 4,338 in March 2026, while the Delhi Metro records an average daily ridership of about 67 lakh passengers. The total bus fleet stands at 6,100.

In water supply, 93.5 per cent households now have piped water access, with supply maintained at around 1,000 MGD daily. About 18.91 lakh consumers benefit from free lifeline water. The network spans 15,700 km pipelines and over 123 reservoirs.

In education, Delhi has 1,270 government and aided schools, accounting for 39.75 per cent enrolment. Pass percentages stood at 97.7 per

cent (Class 10) and 98.3 per cent (Class 12). Seventy-five CM SHRI Schools have been launched under NEP 2020.

Healthcare infrastructure includes 40 major hospitals and over 700 health facilities, with beds increasing to 2.84 per 1,000 population. Social welfare schemes cover lakhs of beneficiaries, including 4.40 lakh senior citizens and 4.09 lakh women in distress.

On environment, ‘good’ air quality days increased from 159 in 2018 to 200 in 2025. Renewable energy capacity stands at 509 MW. Education Minister Ashish Sood said the survey shows Delhi is moving towards a “more robust, dynamic, and high-growth trajectory” adding that “capital expenditure has witnessed an unprecedented increase of 145 per cent... showcasing the government's clear intent and commitment towards development.”

The survey attributes growth to expansion of the digital economy, infrastructure investment, improved connectivity and policy-led formalisation, noting a shift “from announcements to execution” in governance.

‘City logs lowest annual PM2.5, PM10 levels since 2015, excluding Covid yr’

NEW DELHI: Delhi recorded the lowest yearly average of particulate matter PM2.5 and PM10 in 2025, barring the Covid year i.e. 2020, according to the economic survey of 2025-26 tabled in the Delhi Assembly by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday.

The report, which quotes Delhi Pollution Control Committee's (DPCC) Continuous Ambient Air Quality Monitoring System (CAAQMS) data, the yearly average of PM10 in 2025 was 209 (measured in micrograms per cubic metre) and that of PM2.5 was 100.

This was the lowest since 2015, before which data is not

available. In 2020, which was the year of the global Covid pandemic, PM10 yearly average had dropped to 187 but PM2.5 remained at 101, one unit higher than 2025. According to the DPCC data provided, the yearly average of PM10 and PM2.5 in 2024 were 225 and 110 respectively, in 2023 were 219 and 106.

The PM10 and PM2.5 yearly average were 223 and 103 in 2022, and were 221 and 113 in 2021, respectively.

The report quoted that the year-wise annual mean ambient air quality level in Delhi during 2025 was for the data till December 9, 2025.

“The average concentra-

tion was 100 µg/m³ and 209 µg/m³ respectively for PM2.5 and PM10. The peak of PM10 was recorded on May 15, 2025, when the concentration of PM10 reached up to 1154 µg/m³ due to heavy dust storm. However, PM2.5 reached up to 451 µg/m³ on the October 21, 2025, after Deepawali day,” the report said.

The survey further mentioned that the number of ‘good air days’ (good/satisfactory/moderate air quality days combined) have increased from 159 in 2018 to 200 in 2025, it said.

The standard or desirable value of the yearly average should be around 60 for PM10 and 40 for PM 2.5. MP0ST

Delhi vehicle count up 7.9% to 87.6 lakh

NEW DELHI: The total number of motor vehicles in Delhi rose to 87.61 lakh in 2025–26, marking a 7.93 per cent increase from 81.18 lakh in the previous year, according to the Economic Survey released on Monday.

Vehicles per thousand population stood at 522 as of March 19, 2026. Meanwhile, 66.20 lakh vehicles have been deregistered under norms banning diesel vehicles older than 10 years and petrol vehicles older than 15 years.

Two-wheelers accounted for the largest share, with nearly 59.28 lakh registrations, making up 67.65 per



cent of the total.

In public transport, the Delhi Transport Corporation recorded an average daily ridership of 24.29 lakh passengers in 2025–26, down from 25.58 lakh the previous year. Its fleet includes over 6,100 buses, along with electric buses. The report also noted a rise in bus breakdowns and continued growth in EV registry. MP0ST

MCD gets funding boost but utilisation, coordination key to translating into improved services: Eco Survey

NEW DELHI: Funding for the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has improved, but effective utilisation and coordination among agencies remain key to translating these allocations into cleaner streets, better schools and improved public health services, the Delhi Economic Survey 2025-26 has stated.

The survey tabled in the Assembly by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday, also stated that the steady rise in

allocations comes at a time when Delhi is almost entirely urbanised, placing immense pressure on civic infrastructure, including waste management, school education and neighbourhood-level development. While funding has improved, effective utilisation and coordination among agencies remain key to translating these allocations into cleaner streets, better schools and improved public health services, the survey noted.

According to the survey, overall devolutions to local bodies were increased to Rs 6,897.01 crore in 2025–26 (Budget Estimates), up from Rs 6,231.79 crore in 2024–25, indicating a broader push to support urban services.

A large share of this continues to flow to the MCD. Under Basic Tax Assignment (BTA), the corporation is set to receive Rs 3,282.26 crore in 2025–26, compared to Rs 2,983.87 crore in the previous financial year,

which is a rise after unification. NDMC is also set to receive Rs 32.37 crore and Delhi Cantonment Board is set to receive Rs 22.19 crore under BTA. Total allocation under BTA to local bodies stands at Rs 3,336.82 crore, according to the survey. Education, health and urban development allocations for local bodies have increased, with education funds rising to Rs 2,293 crore and urban infrastructure grants also seeing a boost. PTI

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‘Highly inflammable materials stored in building’s basement’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The initial report of the fire department states that “highly inflammable” materials were stored in the basement of the building in Palam, where a recent fire incident occurred, Delhi Home Minister Ashish Sood said on Monday.

Sood accused the AAP of playing “blame game” and “culture politics” in the matter while blaming the previous government for not taking initiatives to modernise the fire service. There was no immediate response from AAP on the matter.

“The initial fire report in the Palam incident states that only a single staircase, from ground to terrace floor, was present, which was not accessible from outside of the building,” Sood said in the Delhi Assembly.

Materials involved, such as garments, cosmetics, thinner, perfumes, and nail polish, which were highly inflammable, were kept in the building's basement, the minister further said.

“Despite all this, our government did not engage in ‘blame politics’. I express grief,



and I stand with the family in this difficult time, along with the entire government.

Within two hours, a magisterial inquiry was announced by the CM, and an ex gratia amount was announced,” Sood added.

Sood, in his statement, also listed out several previous fire incidents, including the Bawana Industrial area fire in January 2018, the Arpit Hotel fire in February 2019 and the Anaj Mandi fire in 2019, saying that the previous government just had a “passing the buck” attitude.

“During such a serious discussion, the opposition is outside, which shows their attitude. Several recommendations to modernise the fire department in 2019 were not fulfilled; however, no steps

were taken till February 2025,” Sood further said.

The minister said that since the BJP government came to power, several initiatives, including the revamp of wireless systems, deployment of 50 quick response vehicles and setting up a new Command and Control Centre for effective monitoring of fire-fighting efforts, are to be established soon.

Nine members of a family, including a 70-year-old woman and three of her granddaughters, were killed after a massive fire tore through a multi-storey residential building in southwest Delhi's Palam area last week. Since the incident, AAP has accused the BJP government of lapses in the fire-fighting system.

Delhi adds 1,288 hosp beds; 5L+ emergency calls handled in 2025

NEW DELHI: Delhi's healthcare infrastructure saw a modest expansion in 2025-26 with the addition of 1,288 beds, even as the government plans a much larger capacity boost through new hospitals and remodelling of existing facilities, according to the Economic Survey 2025-26.

The total number of beds in the city increased from 62,514 in 2024-25 to 63,802 in 2025-26. The increase has largely come from Government of India hospitals, other autonomous bodies and private nursing homes, while there was no addition in bed capacity under hospitals run by the Municipal Corporation of Delhi and the New Delhi Municipal Council.

Within Delhi government hospitals, beds rose from 14,380 to 15,659, an increase of 1,279 beds or about 8.89 per cent, even as the number of hospitals remained unchanged at 40, indicating that expansion is taking place within existing facilities.

However, access remains limited, with the bed population ratio rising only marginally from 2.82 to 2.84 beds per 1,000 people, still well below the World Health Organisation norm of five beds per 1,000 population.

Private hospitals, nursing homes and voluntary organisations account for 53.49 per cent of total beds, followed by Delhi government hospitals at 24.54 per cent. Government of India hospitals at 15.94 per cent and local bodies at 6.03 per cent, underscoring the dominance of the private sector, the report read. Delhi plans to add over 15,000 hospital beds through remodelling and new projects, the Economic Survey said. Emergency response improved, with CATS raising patient shifting rate to 84.3 per cent. Medical institutions rose to 3,878, with new recruitments underway. Under PM-JAY, over 7.45 lakh cards were issued. TB targets were met in the public sector, while dengue and other vector-borne diseases saw a sharp decline in 2025. PTI

NDMC lays foundation stone for redev of park

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) on Monday laid the foundation stone for the redevelopment of a park with modern amenities in southeast Delhi's Bharti Nagar, officials said.

According to NDMC Vice Chairperson Kuljeet Singh Chahal, the project, located along the colony's boundary wall, aims to provide residents with improved recreational facilities. Officials said the site was earlier inspected, following which it was decided to upgrade the park with modern features. According to the plan, the park will include an open-air gym, a covered gym with three-sided glass walls, a children's play area, a relaxation zone with seating benches, a pergola, and a sports zone.

A dedicated synthetic jogging track will run around the park. The total area of the park is around 1,750 square metres, of which about 925 square metres will be developed as a running and walking track.

Around 290 square metres will have PU sports flooring, and a combined badminton and basketball court will also be set up, officials said.

EDUCATION REFORMS TARGET LITERACY GAPS

Delhi to digitise 125 school libraries

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government will upgrade 125 government school libraries with digital infrastructure, while simultaneously addressing learning gaps among students, according to the Economic Survey of Delhi 2025–26.

Each upgraded library will be equipped with 20 digital devices, headphones, a kiosk, a charging cart and a printer, aiming to enhance digital learning access in schools during the current academic session.

The survey also revealed that around 7.5 lakh students from Classes 1 to 8 have been identified with gaps in foundational literacy and numeracy. A baseline assessment conducted in September 2025 led to the



classification of students into four levels—Beginner, Emerging, Progressive and Proficient. Based on this, targeted academic interventions are being implemented through readiness modules developed by SCERT for Classes 2 to 8 after mid-term exams under the NIPUN Sankalp programme.

On inclusive education, the Directorate of Education reported that 879 children with severe or profound dis-

abilities were enrolled in home-based education programmes in 2025. Additionally, 286 out-of-school children were mainstreamed into formal schooling, while a functional curriculum for children with intellectual disabilities has been introduced in 100 schools.

To streamline admissions, 2,333 special admission cells have been set up. The survey also highlighted participation

of 4,258 children with disabilities in 12 para-sports disciplines, while 46 per cent have received Unique Disability ID cards.

In terms of student support, 34,880 meritorious students received ₹2,500 each under the Lal Bahadur Shastri Scholarship Scheme. Competitive exam coaching for 2,200 students annually is planned under the Mahamana Pandit Madan Mohan Malviya Vidya Shakti Mission, with 350 seats reserved for girls.

The government has also increased sports incentives significantly under the Mukhyamantri Khel Protsahan Yojana and expanded language learning through Dr APJ Abdul Kalam language labs in 100 schools, benefiting nearly 60,000 students.

SC resumes final hearing on pleas related to retrospective environmental clearances

Centre’s 2017 notification allowed a limited six-month window for violators to seek regularisation

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday resumed its final hearing on a batch of pleas, including review petitions, challenging its Vanashakti verdict permitting grant of retrospective environmental clearance (EC) by the Centre and other authorities to projects found violating green norms on payment of heavy penalties.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi heard senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan, who mounted a strong challenge to the legality of retrospective ECs granted to projects found in violation of environmental norms.

Sankaranarayanan contended that a “blanket” regime allowing post-facto approvals violates Article 14 of the Constitution and runs contrary to the statutory framework requiring prior scrutiny.

He said that environmental law mandates a structured application of mind before granting clearances, not after violations have already

occurred. “The concept of ex post facto clearance was always meant to be narrowly tailored,” he submitted, referring to the Centre’s 2017 notification that allowed a limited six-month window for violators to seek regularisation.

According to him, this was a one-time “amnesty” measure, applicable only to projects operational without clearance at the time and which was valid till April 2018.

“The Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) cannot become a backdoor entry,” he said, adding that the framework is being misused beyond its intended scope.

He warned that the environmental impact of such approvals is “massive” and, in many cases, “irreversible,” particularly in ecologically sensitive areas dependent on water resources, biodiversity and air quality.

Highlighting the human cost of infrastructure expansion, Sankaranarayanan pointed to highway projects as an example, noting the lack of inclusive planning for non-motorised transport and rural



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communities.

“There are many sacrifices which are uncounted, untold and unenumerated,” he said, urging the court to strike down the impugned notifications.

Petitioners have argued that such post-facto approvals dilute environmental safeguards and incentivise violations.

The hearing remained inconclusive and will resume on Tuesday. On February 25, the top court resumed hearing on the pleas.

On November 18 last year, a three-judge bench headed by the then Chief Justice of India (CJI) B R Gavai reversed by a majority of 2:1 its own verdict by an interim order and paved the way for retrospective environmental clearance to projects found violating environmental norms, saying that otherwise “thousands of crores of rupees would go in waste”.

The top court had held that numerous vital public projects constructed with nearly Rs 20,000 crore of the public exchequer money would be demolished if the May 16, 2025, verdict, which barred the Centre from granting retrospective environmental clearance to projects, was not recalled.

It had ordered a fresh hearing on the pleas.

The CJI-led bench has heard a battery of lawyers, including senior advocates Gopal Sankaranarayanan and Sanjay Parikh who are opposed to the grant of

retrospective EC to the projects violating green norms.

Shankarnarayan had argued that the current legal framework for retrospective clearance is flawed and lacks statutory backing. He highlighted that the 2017 notification, which allowed a one-time six-month window for violators to apply for EC, was a “protem measure” that expired in April 2018.

Senior advocate Sanjay Parikh, also appearing for the petitioners, raised broader constitutional concerns.

Earlier, the bench had observed that as the highest court of the country, the endeavour should be to minimise the scope of committing any mistake which may have a far-reaching effect on the development and growth of the nation.

The top court’s Vanashakti ruling in May 2025 had barred the Ministry of Environment, Forests and Climate Change and the authorities concerned from granting retrospective environmental clearances to projects which are found in violation of environmental norms.

No visit of Israeli PM to India was scheduled or cancelled in recent past, Centre tells Parl

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: No visit of Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu to India was “scheduled or cancelled” in the recent past, the government has informed Parliament.

In a written response to a query in the Lok Sabha on March 20, Minister of State for External Affairs Kirti Vardhan Singh also said high-level visits are planned in advance, taking into account national interest, foreign policy priorities and security assessment.

The question by TMC MP Mala Roy and the response were uploaded on the Lok Sabha website on Monday.

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) was asked whether it is true that the visit of the Israeli prime minister to India was “cancelled due to security reasons”.

Singh said high-level visits are planned in advance, taking into account national interest, foreign policy priorities and security assessment.

“No visit of the Prime Minister of Israel to India was scheduled or cancelled in the

recent past,” he said. The query came amid in the backdrop of the ongoing West Asia conflict.

She had also asked about Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s recent official visit to Israel.

“At the invitation of the Prime Minister of Israel, Mr. Benjamin Netanyahu, Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi paid a State visit to Israel on February 25-26, 2026. The visit was finalised in early January 2026,” Singh said.

During the visit, the two leaders agreed to “further strengthen cooperation”, including in science and technology, innovation, research, critical and emerging technology, cyber security, agriculture, water management, entrepreneurship, defence, trade, economy and people-to-people exchanges, the MEA said.

The leaders decided to elevate the bilateral relationship to a “Special Strategic Partnership for Peace, Innovation & Prosperity,” he said.

During the visit, 16 agreements, memoranda of understanding and protocols were also exchanged, Singh added.

Rising cyber crimes against women: Parl Panel seeks awareness drive, AI monitoring, stronger punishment

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: Expressing concern at the rising incidents of cyber crimes against women, the Parliamentary Committee on Empowerment of Women, on Monday, recommended that the Centre should launch a nationwide programme on cyber safety awareness, improve investigation and have a comprehensive gender-sensitive cyber crime law to curb online harassment.

The Fourth Report of the Committee, namely, Cyber Crimes & Cyber Safety of Women, was laid in Lok Sabha by the Chairperson of the Committee, BJP member D. Purandeswari, which pointed to the lacunae in awareness, implementation, and support systems for victims and called

for an integrated response by several ministries and State governments.

The Committee said that the country needs a campaign to teach people, especially women and children, about the hazards of the internet and how to stay safe online. They think the Ministry of Home Affairs and the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology should work together to create programs that teach people about safety. These programs should be available in schools, colleges and community centres.

They also think it would be an idea to have a National Cyber Safety Week every year to remind people about online safety. The Committee is worried that it takes a long time to investigate cyber crimes. They

think the government should set up labs to help solve these crimes and send special vans to collect evidence. They also think each state should have an expert to help the police with cases involving women.

The Committee is concerned about technologies like artificial intelligence being used to harass women online. They think the government should use tools to find and remove harmful content from the internet.

The Committee recommended that social media platforms should remove harmful content from their sites. The parliamentary panel also thinks that victims of cyber crimes should get help on time. They should have access to counsellors and special centres where they can get

support.

As per the standing committee report, the government should consider creating a stringent law that deals specifically with cyber crimes against women. This law should take into account the needs of women and girls who are victims of online harassment. It should also make sure that people who commit these crimes are punished. The Committee believes that this will make the internet a safer place for everyone, women and children.

The government should further consider counselling, training and other forms of support. As per the panel, providing a woman or a girl to recover from the trauma of being a victim of a cyber-crime is essential. They should

be able to feel safe and be able to use the internet without fear of being harassed or hurt.

It also suggested the creation of regional rehabilitation centres to provide long-term mental health support, digital literacy training and assistance for women whose education or livelihood has been affected due to cyber victimisation.

The Committee further recommended that the government examine the need for a comprehensive and gender-sensitive cybercrime legislation that harmonises existing laws while addressing new-age digital offences, saying such a framework would improve enforcement, boost victim confidence and act as a stronger deterrent against online crimes targeting women.

TMC flags ‘Undeclared Emergency’, protests delay in CAPF Bill introduction

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Trinamool Congress (TMC) has raised serious concerns about the current functioning of the Union Government, accusing it of operating under an ‘undeclared emergency.’ On Monday, TMC leaders criticised the government for failing to focus on parliamentary proceedings, citing a recent incident in which a scheduled CAPF Bill could not be introduced in the Rajya Sabha on time. Party sources revealed that the delay sparked sharp protests in both Houses, highlighting a troubling lack of coordination and respect for parliamentary rules.

TMC members even staged a brief walkout during Zero Hour, alleging that the Home Ministry is more preoccupied with outside administrative

actions than with legislative work inside Parliament. They questioned why crucial business was being postponed without clear explanations, a sign of growing frustration.

The party emphasised that these delays are becoming a pattern, undermining Parliament’s effective functioning. They also voiced concerns over government moves to push through significant legislative and constitutional changes—especially regarding delimitation and women’s reservation—without proper consultation or waiting for the latest Census data.

According to Trinamool Congress, any attempt to delink women’s reservation from Census data or to alter parliamentary seat allocations without a broad political consensus raises serious constitutional red

flags. They argue such decisions require transparent debate in Parliament, not informal talks behind closed doors. The party warned that unilateral actions on representation could have lasting political ramifications.

While reaffirming their support for women’s representation, TMC leaders insisted that the implementation of reservations must follow constitutional procedures and involve comprehensive political discussions. As reports suggest the government might push key Bills and constitutional issues at short notice, opposition parties, including TMC, are set to keep a close watch.

To date, the government has not responded publicly to these allegations, but tensions are evidently rising as Parliament gears up for a busy legislative week.

From Page 1 Trump halts

strikes targeting oil and gas facilities and other civilian infrastructure in Gulf Arab nations. The conflict has killed more than 2,000 people, shaken the global economy, sent oil prices surging, and endangered some of the world’s busiest air corridors.

The latest threatened attacks could have cut electricity to wide swaths of people in Iran and around the Gulf and knocked out desalination plants that provide many desert nations with drinking water. There are also increasing concerns about the consequences of any strikes on nuclear facilities.

Trump said over the weekend that the US would “obliterate” Iran’s power plants unless the country releases its stranglehold on the Strait of Hormuz within 48 hours — a deadline that would have expired late Monday Washington time.

But on Monday morning, Trump wrote on his Truth Social site that the US and Iran have had “very good and productive conversations” that could yield “a complete and total resolution” in the war.

Trump added that the suspension of his threat to attack power plants was “subject to the success of the ongoing meetings and discussions.”

Trump did not elaborate on the negotiations that had taken place, and the state-owned IRAN newspaper reported that Iran’s Foreign Ministry denied that there had been any.

“Remarks by the US president are part of efforts to reduce energy prices and buy time to implement his military plans”, the newspaper said.

Earlier, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said he spoke by phone with his Turkish

counterpart, Hakan Fidan. Turkiye has been an intermediary before in negotiations between Tehran and Washington.

President Abdel-Fattah el-Sissi also said Monday that Egypt has delivered “clear messages” to Iran focusing on de-escalating the conflict, according to his office.

Iran’s paramilitary Revolutionary Guard promised retaliation if Trump made good on his threat, saying Iran would hit power plants in all areas that supply electricity to American bases, “as well as the economic, industrial and energy infrastructures in which Americans have shares”.

Iran’s chokehold on the Strait of Hormuz has wreaked havoc on energy markets, pushed up prices of food and other goods well beyond the Middle East and sent shock waves throughout the global economy.

“No country will be immune to the effects of this crisis if it continues to go in this direction,” said Fatih Birol, the head of the Paris-based International Energy Agency.

Oil prices were stubbornly high in early trading on Monday, but plunged after Trump’s announcement.

Israel launched new attacks Monday on the Iranian capital, saying it had “begun a wide-scale wave of strikes” on infrastructure targets in Tehran without immediately elaborating. Explosions were heard in multiple locations in the afternoon.

India braces

We have faced such challenges before as well by staying united during the Coronavirus pandemic. We must remain very careful and alert. Some people will try to spread rumours to take advantage of the situation. We must not allow such people to succeed,” he said.

“All agencies responsible for

ensuring law and order have been put on alert, including coastal security, border security, and cyber security,” the Prime Minister added.

The Prime Minister made another COVID-19 mention while speaking about food security.

“A big question is how the war will impact farming? The country’s farmers have filled our granaries, so we have adequate food supplies. It is also our attempt to ensure a smooth harvest in the kharif season. In the past, too, our government did not let global problems burden the farmers,” he said.

“Following the Covid pandemic and subsequent wars, fertiliser prices soared in the international market, leading to severe shortages. Despite these challenges, the central government made every possible effort to prevent a crisis in India. While a bag of urea costs Rs 3,000 internationally, our government provided it to farmers for only Rs 300. To make this possible, the government spent more than Rs 12 lakh crore in subsidies,” he said.

In his statement, PM Modi addressed concerns related to the impact on fuel, fertilisers, national security and other areas in India as well on its nationals residing in the West Asia region, detailing steps taken by the government to ensure that “ordinary families face as little trouble as possible”, and said a unanimous voice should go out to the world from India’s Parliament on this crisis.

Reaffirming India’s unwavering commitment to humanity and peace, the prime minister said the dialogue and diplomacy remain the only path to resolution and every Indian effort is directed at de-escalation and the cessation of hostilities.

Informing the House that he has engaged with all relevant West Asian leaders and urged them to reduce tensions and end the conflict, Modi emphasised that attacks on commer-

cial ships and obstruction of international waterways like the Strait of Hormuz, through which 20 per cent of the world’s energy is transported, are “wholly unacceptable”.

On India’s diplomatic response to the West Asia conflict, he said India’s stand has been clear from the very beginning, when the US and Israel attacked Iran and the latter retaliated by targeting its Gulf neighbours and Israel, “one of expressing deep concern, advocating de-escalation, and opposing attacks on civilians and on energy and transport infrastructure”.

“India, through diplomacy, is making continuous efforts for the safe passage of Indian ships even amidst the war environment. Due to such efforts, several of our ships that were stuck in the Strait of Hormuz have also arrived in India in recent days,” he said.

He said all security agencies have been placed on alert and that security across all domains, coastal, border, cyber, and strategic installations, is being further strengthened.

This region is important to India for yet another reason, as nearly one crore Indians live and work in the Gulf countries and among the commercial ships that sail in these seas, the number of Indian crew members is also very high, he said.

He informed the House that India has expanded its energy import sources from 27 countries to 41 countries over the past 11 years, thereby reducing dependence on any single region.

Emphasising the foresight of this approach, Modi said in today’s circumstances, the steps taken over the past decade regarding energy security have become even more relevant.

Modi said India has more than 5.3 million metric tonnes of strategic petroleum reserves, and the country is also working on arrangements for more than 6.5 million metric tonnes

of storage.

Apart from this, he said, there are reserves held by the domestic oil companies.

“In the last 11 years, our refining capacity has increased significantly, and the government is in constant touch with suppliers from different countries. The effort is to ensure that oil and gas supplies continue from wherever possible,” he said.

Highlighting the scale of the evacuation effort, the Prime Minister said more than 3,75,000 Indians have safely returned to India since the war began, including approximately 1,000 Indians from Iran alone, of whom over 700 are young medical students.

Addressing the broader economic ramifications, Modi acknowledged that energy is the backbone of the modern economy and that West Asia is a major source for global energy needs, making the current crisis a challenge for economies worldwide.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Centre plans

opposition parties to build consensus. Union Home Minister Amit Shah has already held meetings with leaders from parties including BJD, YSRCP, NCP (SP), Shiv Sena (UBT) and AIMIM, and is expected to engage with representatives from Congress, TMC, DMK and SP.

According to participants in these discussions, one key proposal is to increase the number of Lok Sabha and state assembly seats by about 50 percent, using the 2011 Census as the basis while keeping the proportional representation of states unchanged. This approach is seen as a way to address concerns from southern states that have opposed any redistribution of seats based on population growth.

An opposition MP who attended the meeting said the plan would retain the current share of representation across states while expanding the total number of seats. “We were told that the increase would not alter the relative share of states, which addresses long-standing concerns,” the MP said, requesting anonymity.

The expansion would have a notable impact on large states. For example, Uttar Pradesh’s representation in the Lok Sabha could rise from 80 to around 120 seats under the proposed formula. At the same time, one-third of the expanded House, or 273 seats, would be reserved for women.

Discussions have also touched on the method of allocating reserved seats. One option under consideration is a lottery system, where every third seat would be designated for women. However, it remains unclear whether such reservations would rotate between constituencies or remain fixed over time.

The government is weighing whether to introduce the amendment in the current session or convene a special session of Parliament if more time is required to secure agreement. Sources said the timing will depend on the outcome of ongoing consultations with political parties.

The push for implementation has also gained traction in the opposition. Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge recently wrote to Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju seeking an all-party meeting to discuss the roadmap and modalities for enforcing the law. Kharge has also convened a meeting of floor leaders from the INDIA bloc to deliberate on the issue.

If the proposed changes are enacted, they would mark a significant step toward operationalising the long-pending provision for women’s reservation, while reshaping the size

and composition of legislative bodies across the country.

Bengal SIR

The total number of voters in the state, as per the final electoral roll published on February 28, stood at 7,04,59,284, while over 60 lakh voters were placed under judicial review. The earlier draft roll had included 7,08,16,630 names.

The Election Commission on Monday removed 73 Returning Officers (ROs). Most of them are Sub-Divisional Officers (SDOs).

The state comprises 294 Assembly constituencies, and typically, there is one RO assigned to each Assembly segment. Of these, 73 have been removed, the majority of whom are Sub-Divisional Officers (SDOs).

According to the directive issued by the poll body, new SDOs have been appointed in Tufanganj (Cooch Behar), Jalpaiguri, Malda Sadar, Lalbagh (Murshidabad), Barrackpore, Bidhannagar, Barasat, Canning, Baruipur, Alipore, Howrah Sadar, Hooghly Sadar, Tamluk, Kanthi, Haldia, Egga, Ghatol, Durgapur, and Asansol.

Last Wednesday, the Commission issued a directive announcing the appointment of new District Magistrates in 11 districts of the state. The list included Cooch Behar, Jalpaiguri, North Dinajpur, Malda, Murshidabad, Nadia, East Burdwan, the two 24-Parganas districts, Darjeeling, and Alipurduar.

According to the CEO’s office, the SIR exercise in Bengal was announced on October 27 last year, when the electorate stood at 7,66,37,529. Following the enumeration phase, a draft roll was published on December 16, which recorded the deletion of 58,20,899 names, bringing the total down to 7,08,16,630.

PM URGED TO MAKE STATEMENT ON LPG CRISIS

Cong wants India to lead West Asia peace talks

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Congress on Monday suggested that India lead peace talks in West Asia, and also called on Prime Minister Narendra Modi to inform citizens about the steps being taken to tackle LPG shortage and rising inflation in the country.

Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra said Prime Minister Modi should have spoken earlier.

"We don't have any expectations. I want to hear what he has to say. There are many issues. The fallout of the war on our country is huge... LPG and many other issues. He should have spoken much earlier," she told reporters in the Parliament House complex.

Meanwhile, Prime Minister Modi on Monday afternoon addressed the Lok Sabha on the West Asia crisis, and termed the prevailing situation "worrisome" as it is having a very

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Prime Minister Modi on Monday afternoon addressed the Lok Sabha on the West Asia crisis
- » He termed the prevailing situation 'worrisome' as it is having a very adverse impact on the global economy and the livelihoods of people



» Congress whip in the Lok Sabha, Manickam Tagore, criticised Modi for the 'delay' in addressing the issue

adverse impact on the global economy and the livelihoods of people.

Earlier, Congress MP Rajiv Shukla said the party expects efforts towards ending the conflict.

"The war is directly harming India. It must stop. We are facing a shortage of cooking gas, while diesel prices may also increase... It has already gone up by Rs 21.

"Our foreign policy was neu-

tral earlier. We were not aligned with anyone, so everyone stood with us. Now, by moving closer to Israel, that balance seems to have been affected. We should maintain good relations with all countries, including Iran, as we did earlier.

"Also, cylinders were provided to households under the Ujjwala scheme, but today many of them are lying empty. What is the benefit of the scheme? People are left with no option but to

return to 'chulhas', as gas is not available," Shukla said.

Congress MP Tariq Anwar said the prime minister should have addressed the issue earlier.

"After a long time, the prime minister has realised this issue and is addressing the Parliament, but he should have taken this step much earlier. There are high expectations from India, both from within and outside, especially since we call ourselves a neutral country and say we are not part of any bloc.

"Our country's foreign policy is clear. According to that policy, whatever is happening there (West Asia) should be condemned, and efforts should be made to find a middle path," Anwar said.

On Sunday evening, Modi chaired a meeting of the Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS) to review the situation arising out of the West Asia conflict, and make a detailed assessment on the availability

of critical items, including food, energy and fuel.

Congress MP Ujjwal Raman Singh said the government must explain the outcome of the high-level meeting and reassure the people of the country.

"Look, while the meeting did take place, people do not know what its outcome was. Parliament is in session – he (Modi) should reassure the people as to how, in the coming days, relief will be provided from the LPG crisis and rising inflation. The government must answer," Singh told reporters.

Congress whip in the Lok Sabha, Manickam Tagore, criticised Modi for the "delay" in addressing the issue.

"After 14 days of silence and after 14 days of election campaign in Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Bengal and Assam, the prime minister has found time to speak about the energy crisis now.

"There is no clear-cut plan. By this time, the LPG shortage

has increased. The commercial price of LPG has gone up by 40 per cent. Airfares are going to increase. What was the outcome of the (CCS) meeting? Only tea, biscuits and discussions," Tagore said.

Congress MP Manish Tiwari warned that the escalating hostilities in West Asia could disrupt global supply chains and impact essential commodities.

"There has been an escalation since Sunday to an unprecedented level. Iranians have ostensibly attempted to hit the Israeli nuclear research reactor. President (Donald) Trump has issued a warning which is going to expire this evening. So, the conflict has perhaps entered its most dangerous phase," Tiwari said.

The Chandigarh MP also claimed that around 3,000 ships are currently idling in the Persian Gulf and the Gulf of Oman, indicating a major disruption in maritime movement.

LOK SABHA DEBATE

Congress, BJP trade charges on petrol price, corporate tax

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Congress on Monday accused the government of refraining from hiking petrol prices as it had the upcoming Assembly polls in sight, a charge rejected by the BJP, which said the government should instead be praised for diversifying its energy sources.

Initiating a debate on the Finance Bill in the Lok Sabha, Congress MP Amar Singh also targeted the government, saying its corporate tax collection is much lower than its income tax collection.

He said even though corporate taxes are lower, high net-worth individuals were investing abroad and not in India.

Singh also alleged that the upcoming five Assembly elections were preventing the Central government from hiking petroleum prices. The global crude prices have gone up due to the conflict in the Middle East, driving up petrol and diesel prices in many countries.

Hitting back, BJP's Nishikant Dubey said the government should be commended for not hiking prices of petrol and diesel but the Congress was instead questioning it.

Recalling Prime Minister Narendra Modi's statement made in the House earlier in the day, Dubey said that earlier India was procuring oil from 21 countries, but the figure now stands at 41.

The BJP leader said the government has worked for years to ensure energy security, a move which should be appreciated.

CLOSER LOOK

- » Congress claimed that the upcoming five Assembly elections were preventing the Central government from hiking petrol prices
- » Hitting back, BJP's Nishikant Dubey said the government should be commended for not hiking prices of petrol and diesel but the Congress was instead questioning it

He claimed that during previous Congress governments, the Benami Transactions Act and minimum alternate tax were deliberately not implemented to either appease the corporates or to browbeat them into submission.

Participating in the debate, DMK MP Arun Nehru said the government doesn't follow the Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management Bill but asks states to have fiscal discipline. "The Centre has no locus standi if they don't follow the FRBM so that more money is passed to the states."

The House should also know about the status of India's Free Trade Agreements -- the trade volume has increased, but so has the trade deficit, he said.

"The ASEAN FTA has a trade deficit of 10 billion, as of today. The UAE FTA has a trade deficit of USD 26.7 billion, Japan FTA, in 2011, has a trade deficit of 10.8 billion, and South Korea has a trade deficit of 14.72 billion," he pointed out.

ELECTORAL DEBUT IN STATE POLLS

Assam Cong chief Gogoi files nomination from Jorhat seat



CPI(M), CPI(ML) and the All Party Hill Leaders Conference (APHLC).

JORHAT: Assam Congress chief Gaurav Gogoi on Monday filed his nomination papers from Jorhat Assembly seat, making his electoral debut in the state polls.

Gogoi, who is also the deputy leader of the opposition in the Lok Sabha, visited religious places of all communities before starting his rally from Jorhat stadium.

The procession, which saw participation from a large number of people, concluded at the district commissioner's office after around three hours.

Congress is part of the six-party opposition alliance comprising the Rajiwar Dal, Assam Jatiyatabadi Party (AJP),

"During the last few years, politics in the state has stooped to a very low level, for which we feel ashamed when we are in other parts of the country," he said.

He urged people to take "collective responsibility" to help cleanse society and politics.

"A Congress government will also ensure that all women will get the benefits of the various schemes without having to attend any party meeting or rallies," he said.

Gogoi alleged that the BJP was insulting women by forcing beneficiaries to attend rallies and meetings organised by the party.

MPOST

2027 ASSEMBLY POLLS IN SIGHT

UP: BJP plans political appointments to placate cadre

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: Facing growing discontent among party workers over lack of representation in the Yogi Adityanath government, the Bharatiya Janata Party has initiated the process of appointing chairpersons and members in state-run corporations, boards and commissions. The move is being seen as a crucial organisational step with an eye on the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections.

The exercise comes at a time when the party is already holding meetings to constitute district committees region-wise. Alongside this, the focus has now shifted to finalising the state unit and accommodating workers through political appointments.

A key meeting of the state core committee was held on

INSIGHT

- » There has been broad agreement that workers who could not be accommodated in the party organisation or those likely to be dropped should be adjusted in corporations, boards and commissions'

- » The strategy is aimed at addressing grievances within the cadre while ensuring that experienced workers remain engaged in governance structures

was broad agreement that workers who could not be accommodated in the party organisation or those likely to be dropped should be adjusted in corporations, boards and commissions. The strategy is aimed at addressing grievances within the cadre while ensuring that experienced workers remain engaged in governance structures.

Political analyst Manoj Bhadra described the move as significant but overdue. "This is a crucial step. BJP workers have increasingly felt deprived of their due share in power despite working on the ground. If the party wants to remain electorally strong in a state like Uttar Pradesh, it has to continuously reward and recognise its cadre," he said, adding that such appointments often serve as an important bridge between organisation and government.

Nation Briefs

SC DISPOSES OF PLEA CHALLENGING SONAM WANGCHUK'S DETENTION

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday disposed of a plea filed by Gitanjali J Angmo, wife of climate activist Sonam Wangchuk, against the latter's detention under the National Security Act (NSA). A bench of Justices Aravind Kumar and PB Varale noted that the Centre revoked its order of Wangchuk's detention on March 14. The apex court said there was nothing left in the matter.

UPSC TO RELEASE PROVISIONAL ANSWER KEY AFTER PRELIMS: CENTRE

NEW DELHI: The Union Public Service Commission has formulated guidelines to release the provisional answer key on its website after conducting the civil services preliminary examination, the Centre said in the Rajya Sabha. The Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) conducts the civil services examination annually in three stages – preliminary, main and interview – to select officers for the Indian Administrative Service (IAS), Indian Foreign Service (IFS) and the Indian Police Service (IPS), among others. In compliance with a Supreme Court judgement, the UPSC has formulated guidelines to release the provisional answer key on its official website after conducting the preliminary examination, Union Minister of State for Personnel, Jitendra Singh, said in a written reply in the Rajya Sabha. The process, which will be implemented from the 2026 civil services (preliminary) examination onwards, will apply to all structured examinations conducted by the UPSC, Singh said.

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The rejection rate of Right to Information (RTI) applications has come down to 3.26 per cent in 2024-25 from 7.21 per cent in 2013-14, the Centre has said.

The data on RTI applications received, replied and rejected along with the reasons of rejection, in respect of public authorities in the central government, is available in the annual report of the Central Information Commission (CIC), for the respective years, Union Minister of State for Personnel Jitendra Singh said in a written reply to the Rajya Sabha.

It can be accessed at <https://cic.gov.in/circular-reports->

The data on RTI applications received, replied and rejected along with the reasons of rejection is available in the annual report of the CIC

conventions, he said.

"The rejection rate of RTI applications, in percentage, has come down to 3.26 per cent in the year 2024-25 from 7.21 per cent in the year 2013-14," he said.

Assessment and review to evaluate the effectiveness of the RTI Act framework is an ongoing process, Singh said.

Guidelines have been issued by the government on conducting third-party transparency audit of proactive/suo-moto disclosures undertaken by the concerned public authorities, he said.

The CIC monitors the progress of the transparency audit and pursues with all public authorities to undertake the audit, the minister said.

If an applicant does not receive the reply in response to an RTI application within the prescribed time or is aggrieved by a decision of the public information officer (PIO), the applicant may prefer an appeal before the first appellate authority and a second appeal lies before the CIC, he said.

MoS Education says NEP does not impose one language on any state

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Union Minister of State for Education Jayant Chaudhary on Monday said the National Education Policy (NEP) does not impose one language, including Hindi, on any state, rather it "explicitly promotes multilingualism".

Responding to supplementary questions in Lok Sabha during the Question Hour, the minister noted that while Tamil Nadu has expressed some objection to the NEP 2020, the central government has released Rs 538 crore to the state under the Samagra Shiksha, a flagship central school education programme.

"It is up to the state to follow established procedure and protocol in terms of expenditure, in terms of provision of UC (utilisation certificate) for further release," Chaudhary said.

The minister said there was "absolutely no imposition of any language."

"The three languages, as proposed in the NEP, align with the two-language formula... There is complete flexibility. There is no imposition of any language, including Hindi. It is up to the state to implement in toto."

The minister said paragraph 4.13 of the NEP explicitly promotes multilingualism, citing clear benefits for learning capacity and outcomes from early exposure to multiple languages.

It mandates states to develop school capacity for teaching three languages, ensuring proficiency in at least two languages native to India by age 15, with the third language left to local demand.

"So it is up to the states to really implement it," he explained.

Under the Samagra Shiksha, the government provides support for the appointment of teachers of languages, he said, adding that this was a new component added in the Samagra Shiksha 2.0.

On the release of central funds on education, Chaudhary said, "Tamil Nadu has certain reservations which they have expressed from time to time. Largely, they have brought it down to... diluted the NEP to a two-language formula and that is the basis of their objection."

"Tamil Nadu had earlier indicated it would sign the MoU for PM-SHRI, but the agreement remains unsigned. Let me remind the House that PM SHRI schools are exemplary institutions meant to demonstrate leadership and showcase the best elements of the NEP across school levels.

India nominates Living Root Bridges of Meghalaya for UNESCO inscription

UNESCO tag sought for 'Ancient Buddhist Site, Sarnath' in UP: Govt in Lok Sabha

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India has nominated 'Jingkieng Jri/ Lyu Charai Cultural Landscape', the Living Root Bridges of Meghalaya that signify harmony between humans and nature, for inscription into the UNESCO World Heritage List for the 2026-27 cycle, the government informed Parliament on Monday.

In a written response to a query in the Lok Sabha, Union Culture Minister Gajendra Singh Shekhawat also said the country has sent a proposal to the World Heritage Centre, seeking a UNESCO tag for the 'Ancient Buddhist Site, Sarnath' in Uttar Pradesh for the 2025-26 cycle.

The Culture ministry was asked for details about the number of UNESCO World Heritage sites in the country and whether the government has sent any proposals for the inclusion of new sites in the World Heritage List.

"Yes, sir. The government has sent the following proposals to the World Heritage Centre for consideration for inclusion in the World Heritage List: Ancient

KEY POINTS

- » Locally known as Jingkieng Jri, LRB are Ficus-based rural connectivity and livelihood solutions within the dense subtropical moist broadleaf forest eco-region of Meghalaya
- » Grown by indigenous Khasi tribal communities, these structural ecosystems have performed in extreme



climatic conditions for centuries and encapsulate a profound harmony between humans and nature

- » The underlying knowledge and skills have evolved through generations and continue to be practised today

Buddhist Site, Sarnath (2025-26), Jingkieng Jri/ Lyu Charai Cultural Landscape (2026-27)," he said.

Locally known as Jingkieng Jri, Living Root Bridges (LRB) are Ficus-based rural connectivity and livelihood solutions within the dense subtropical moist broadleaf forest eco-region of Meghalaya in the eastern extension of the Indian Peninsular Plateau, according to its description on UNESCO's website.

Grown by indigenous Khasi tribal communities, these structural ecosystems have performed in extreme climatic conditions for centuries and encapsulate a profound harmony between humans and nature, it said.

The underlying knowledge and skills have evolved through generations and continue to be practised today, affirming their exceptional value and relevance.

TAMIL NADU ELECTIONS

NDA seat-sharing deal: AIADMK gives 27 seats to BJP and 18 to PMK

MPOST BUREAU

CHENNAI: The AIADMK-led NDA in Tamil Nadu on Monday finalised seat-sharing arrangement for key constituents of the alliance for the April 23 Assembly polls, with the Dravidian party allotting 27 seats for BJP, 18 for PMK and 11 for AMMK.

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K Palaniswami, addressing a crowded press conference at party headquarters Puratchi Thalaivar MGR Maaligai, here, said talks continued with other allies as well and it will be concluded by tonight.

The names of constituencies to be contested by alliance parties will be identified soon, he said, adding the seat-sharing talks were cordial.

Elections to 234 Assembly seats in Tamil Nadu will be held on April 23. NDA's other constituents include former union minister GK Vasan-led Tamil Maanila Congress (Moopanar) and IJK.

Asked about the number of seats to be contested by AIADMK, Palaniswami said talks continued with some parties and following its conclusion the information would be shared.

In the presence of leaders of alliance parties, including senior BJP leader Piyush Goyal, PMK top leader Anbumani Ramadoss and AMMK chief TTV Dhinakaran, Palaniswami described the alliance it leads as one marked by "bonding," and called it a "victorious" combine.

He expressed confidence that the alliance would go on to win at least 210 Assembly constituencies out of the total 234.



Union Minister and BJP Tamil Nadu election in-charge Piyush Goyal along with AIADMK General Secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami during a press conference in Chennai, Monday

HIGHLIGHTS

- ▶ AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K Palaniswami said talks continued with other allies as well and it will be concluded by tonight
- ▶ Elections to 234 Assembly seats in Tamil Nadu will be held on April 23

"The alliance will win and AIADMK will form the government," he asserted.

Ridiculing a "protracted, delayed" seat-sharing exercise involving a "war of words" between the DMK and Congress, he alleged the CPI(M), which got six seats in 2021 was now struggling to get five Assembly seats.

"Piyush Goyal, Nainar Nagenthiran, L. Murugan, Anbumani Ramadoss, TTV Dhinakaran came in the morning, it (seat-sharing) was decided in the afternoon and the decision is being announced in the evening; see how quickly it has hap-

pened. The AIADMK's goal is to dislodge the DMK from the seat of power. The media did not criticise the deadlock in seat-sharing talks in the DMK front," he said.

Hitting back at DMK's criticism aimed at him for his Delhi visit to meet Union Home Minister Amit Shah in connection with seat sharing, he wondered why DMK MP Kanimozhi met Congress leader Rahul Gandhi in the national capital recently. It has become a wont for Chief Minister M K Stalin to spread defamatory content targeting the NDA leaders if they visited Delhi, he alleged.

"Delhi visit is for sharing our opinions, to discuss Assembly polls related matters, the CM fears whenever we go to Delhi."

Targeting the DMK for blaming the AIADMK over alliance-related matters, he fired salvos at the ruling party for allying with the Congress party which imposed the infamous Emergency (1975-77) and also invoked the MISA against detainees during that period.

APEX COURT 'UNHAPPY' OVER AGENCIES' 'RELUCTANCE'

Conduct fair probe against ADAG firms: SC to CBI, ED

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday expressed displeasure over the "reluctance" shown by the CBI and the ED in probing the alleged large-scale banking fraud involving the Anil Dhirubhai Ambani Group and its firms, and directed them to conduct a "fair, dispassionate, transparent, and time-bound" investigation into the matter.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi took note of the sub-missions of Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) and the Enforcement Directorate (ED), and directed all concerned financial institutions to "render full cooperation to the ED".

Hearing a PIL filed by former bureaucrat E A S Sarma seeking a court-monitored



investigation into alleged loan frauds exceeding Rs 40,000 crore by Anil Dhirubhai Ambani Group (ADAG) firms led by Anil Ambani, the bench permitted the central probe agencies to approach it in case there is any reluctance on the part of other government bodies in extending cooperation to them.

At the outset, Mehta informed the bench that an SIT, in pursuance of an earlier order, had been constituted comprising senior ED officers and financial experts from the

The SC directed them to conduct a 'fair, dispassionate, transparent, and time-bound' investigation into the matter

banking sector.

He said the probe agencies, so far, attached assets worth Rs 15,000 crore and also arrested four persons, including a few senior officials.

On the other hand, lawyer Prashant Bhushan, appearing for Sarma, referred to a SEBI report and said it has been highlighted that there was a scheme devised to siphon off money and yet the CBI has not made any arrests so far.

"Arrests have been made. We cannot make random arrests," the solicitor general said.

Mann pays tribute to Bhagat Singh, calls for upholding martyrs' ideals

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Paying tributes to Bhagat Singh on Shaheed Diwas, Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann on Monday said the day serves as a reminder of the supreme sacrifice made by the nation's martyrs and urged citizens to uphold their ideals.

Recalling the martyrdom of Rajguru and Sukhdev along with Bhagat Singh, the Chief Minister said their sacrifice continues to inspire generations to stand against injustice, oppression and tyranny. He stressed that the occasion should not only be about remembrance but also about carrying forward their fearless vision and commitment to nation-building.

Mann reaffirmed his government's resolve to honour the



martyrs by working towards a progressive and inclusive Punjab rooted in their ideals. He also raised the issue of the continued denial of the Bharat Ratna to these revolutionaries, stating that the country's trajectory might have been different under such courageous leadership.

Highlighting the importance of education, the Chief Minister said it is the most effective tool to eradicate poverty and social evils. "No freebie can

No freebie can eliminate poverty, but education can transform lives and uplift society

eliminate poverty, but education can transform lives and uplift society," he said, adding that the state government has prioritised reforms in the education sector to empower people.

Emphasising democratic values, Mann said the right to vote is a legacy of the martyrs' sacrifice and must be exercised responsibly. He cautioned people against selling their votes, calling it a betrayal of the ideals for which the freedom fighters laid down their lives.

MP CM felicitates UPSC achievers, hails rising success

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav on Monday felicitated and interacted with candidates from the state who cleared the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) 2025 examination, stating that their growing success reflects a changing and aspirational Madhya Pradesh.

In the UPSC 2025 examination, a total of 61 candidates from Madhya Pradesh qualified, with two securing positions in the top 10—Ishan Bhatnagar at Rank 5 and Pakshal Secretary at Rank 8. This marks the highest number of selections from the state, which ranked third in the country this year, after Uttar Pradesh and Bihar.

Addressing a Higher Education Department programme in Bhopal, the Chief Minister termed MP's rising UPSC success a matter of pride, congratulating candidates and saying their achievement reflects determination and will help shape a developed, self-reliant India by 2047.

"By the time India marks 100 years of Independence, you will be at the helm of administration. Your decisions and innovations will lay the foundation of a developed Madhya Pradesh," Yadav said, adding that success also brings responsibility towards public welfare.

The Chief Minister released the digital version of a booklet on selected candidates. A short film showcasing their journeys was screened, and the candidates were honoured with trophies.



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Ex-minister Pawaiya takes charge as MP Finance Commission chief

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: Former minister Jaibhan Singh Pawaiya on Monday assumed charge as Chairman of the Sixth Madhya Pradesh State Finance Commission at the state secretariat in Bhopal. After taking charge, Pawaiya met Chief Minister Mohan Yadav. Deputy Chief Ministers Jagdish Devda and Rajendra Shukla were present when Pawaiya took charge.

Speaking to Millennium Post, Pawaiya said the Commission would undertake field studies to assess the financial health of urban and panchayat institutions, identify new revenue sources, and examine regional imbalances in development. "My focus will be on transparency and quality in



development works," he said.

A prominent right-wing leader, Pawaiya has previously served as a Member of Parliament from Gwalior and has also held the Higher Education portfolio as a minister in the state government. He has also served as the national convenor of the Bajrang Dal.

Congratulating him,

the Deputy Chief Ministers expressed confidence that under his leadership, the Commission would play a crucial role in strengthening Panchayati Raj Institutions and urban local bodies.

The State Finance Commission, constituted under the 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments, is set up every five years under Articles 243(I) and 243(Y) to review the financial position of local bodies.

As the sixth such panel in MP, the Commission will assess the fiscal health of panchayats and urban local bodies, recommend measures to augment their resources, and suggest principles for the distribution of taxes and grants, playing a key role in strengthening grassroots governance.

NANGAL 'SWADESHI MELA AND YOUTH CONFERENCE'

Youth must lead the way to realise martyrs' dreams: Saini

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini said that March 23 holds unparalleled significance in India's history. It is not merely a day of remembrance, but a day of resolve, when Shaheed-e-Azam Bhagat Singh, Rajguru and Sukhdev laid down their lives, elevating the nation's pride to new heights. He said the martyrdom of these immortal heroes continues to ignite the spirit of patriotism in every Indian even today.

Chief Minister Saini was addressing the 'Swadeshi Mela and Youth Conference' held in Nangal, Punjab, on Monday. He said this event is not just a programme, but a living resolve to build the India envisioned by our martyrs. He congratulated the Centre for Economic Policy Research and Swadeshi Jagran Manch for this inspiring initiative.

The Chief Minister said that the nature of revolution has changed in today's times. Revolution no longer comes through swords, but through ideas, determination, and positive efforts. He emphasised that today's revolution can be



Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini addresses the gathering during the 'Swadeshi Mela - Yuva Sammelan' organised at Nangal, Punjab on Monday

achieved through public awareness against drug abuse, providing youth with self-employment, and promoting the adoption of indigenous products.

He stated that 'Swadeshi' is the strong foundation of an Aatmanirbhar Bharat. When citizens give priority to local products, they directly strengthen the country's economy and bring stability to the lives of millions of artisans and small entrepreneurs. The principle of Swadeshi empowers individuals to stand on their own feet. Swadeshi is not just a word but an economic philosophy. He said that 'Vocal for Local' is not merely a slogan, but a campaign

for nation-building. This is not just an exhibition of products, but a celebration of our indigenous spirit, and the message of Swadeshi must reach every household.

Advising youth against the blind race to go abroad, the Chief Minister cautioned that illegal and risky routes such as the 'donkey route' pose serious threats to life and often shatter families' dreams. He said that India offers immense opportunities, and young people can achieve success within the country through their talent.

Expressing serious concern over the problem of drug abuse, the Chief Minister said

that the brave land of Punjab, once known for its rich culture and prosperity, is now being targeted by drug traffickers. Drug addiction is a social curse that weakens individuals as well as the nation. He urged youth to stay away from drugs and to spread awareness in society to eradicate this menace. He highlighted yoga, sports, and a disciplined lifestyle as effective measures to combat drug addiction.

The Chief Minister said: "Shaheed Diwas inspires us to remain committed to our duties and to work continuously for the unity, integrity, and prosperity of the nation." He called

Shaheed Diwas inspires us to remain committed to our duties and to work continuously for the unity, integrity, and prosperity of the nation

upon the youth present to take a collective pledge to adopt Swadeshi, fight against drug abuse, and actively contribute to the country's development.

Highlighting Haryana's participation, he said that the state's cultural heritage, tourism, environmental conservation efforts, and dairy products are major attractions at the fair, reflecting the state's progress and prosperity.

The Chief Minister concluded by stating that the Swadeshi Mela and Youth Conference in Nangal serves as a powerful platform uniting patriotism, self-reliance, and youth power. He congratulated the organizers for the successful event and expressed confidence that this initiative will provide new direction and energy to youth in nation-building.

Cold storage collapse kills four in Prayagraj

MPOST BUREAU

PRAYAGRAJ: Four labourers were killed, and 12 were injured after being trapped under the debris following the collapse of a cold storage facility on Monday afternoon here, an official said.

District Magistrate Manish Kumar Verma said, "12 labourers were injured in the incident and are receiving treatment at SRN Hospital. Four labourers died."

He said that teams from the district administration, police, SDRF, and the fire brigade are engaged in relief and rescue operations, working to clear the debris from the site and search for any trapped individuals.

DCP (Ganga Nagar) Kuldeep Gunawat said that the cold storage facility, located in the Phaphamau police station area, suddenly crumbled and collapsed this afternoon. The incident triggered panic in the area as ammonia gas began leaking from the facility.

He said that fire brigade teams are also active at the scene, working to contain the gas leak.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi, in a post on X, expressed

the CBI and the ED that the probe be completed most dispassionately and independently so that it is taken to a logical conclusion in a time-bound manner.

"The solicitor general assured that no stone shall be left unturned to unearth the truth. The solicitor general has pointed to the second status report by the ED, where details have been sought from financial institutions. We allow the prayer in its entirety," the bench ordered.

Senior advocate Mukul Rohatgi, appearing for Anil Ambani, said that due to the pendency of the PIL, the lending banks are not willing to have a dialogue with him to settle the dues.

"Due to the pendency of the case, they are hesitant," Rohatgi said.

The bench said it has not stopped anyone from having any consultations.

BJP pushed Haryana 'backwards': Hooda

CHANDIGARH: Former Haryana Chief Minister and Leader of the Opposition Bhupinder Singh Hooda on Monday alleged that the BJP government has pushed the state backwards across key sectors, citing multiple national reports and data indicators.

Addressing a press conference along with party MLAs, Hooda claimed Haryana has emerged as the "most unsafe state" as per the Centre's Social Progress Index, while the ranking of the state police has dropped from 8th to 14th in the India Justice Report over the past five years. He further alleged that corruption cases have surged by 187 per cent in three years, placing Haryana sixth nationally, according to National Crime Records Bureau data.

Hooda also flagged concerns in education, noting that no uni-



versity from Haryana featured in the top 100 of the National Institutional Ranking Framework. He added that the state ranks 16th in the Happiness Index and 14th in the SDG rankings released by NITI Aayog.

Raising economic concerns, Hooda said Haryana's industrial sector has declined by over 12 per cent in five years, with 1,446 factories shutting down or relocating. He also cited data from the Centre for Monitoring Indian Economy, claiming youth unemployment in the state is nearly 37 per cent, the highest in the country.

MPOST



EDITORIAL
INFLATION
METRICS

India's inflation numbers have always carried more weight than most economic indicators. They shape interest rates, influence government spending, determine wage revisions, and quietly affect the daily lives of millions. Yet, the way inflation is measured has long struggled to keep pace with how Indians actually spend their money. The decision to revise the Consumer Price Index (CPI) base year, along with the move to incorporate e-commerce price tracking, is therefore not just a technical adjustment—it is a recognition that the economy has changed faster than its statistical mirror. If executed well, these changes could make inflation data more credible, more representative, and far more relevant to policy.

The existing CPI framework is anchored in consumption patterns that are increasingly dated. Over the past decade, India has undergone a quiet but profound transformation in how households allocate their spending. Digital payments have surged, online retail has expanded into smaller towns, and services—from food delivery to digital subscriptions—have become embedded in everyday consumption. Yet, the current CPI basket does not fully capture these shifts. It continues to rely heavily on traditional retail price collection and consumption weights that underrepresent emerging categories. Updating the base year is meant to correct this distortion by recalibrating the basket to reflect contemporary spending habits. In principle, this should bring inflation measurement closer to lived reality.

The introduction of e-commerce price tracking marks an even more consequential shift. Online platforms have altered pricing dynamics in ways that traditional surveys struggle to capture. Discounts, flash sales, algorithm-driven pricing, and regional price variations mean that the "price" of a product is no longer static or uniform. For many consumers, particularly in urban and semi-urban India, the price they actually pay increasingly comes from digital marketplaces rather than physical stores. By incorporating e-commerce data, statisticians are attempting to bridge this gap between recorded prices and real transaction prices. This is not a trivial change. It acknowledges that the marketplace itself has evolved, and that inflation measurement must evolve with it.

However, the promise of better measurement also comes with complications. E-commerce prices are volatile, often influenced by promotional strategies rather than underlying cost structures. A festive sale can temporarily depress prices, while dynamic pricing algorithms can create rapid fluctuations within days or even hours. Integrating such data into a stable, policy-relevant inflation index requires careful smoothing and methodological clarity. There is also the question of representativeness. While online retail has expanded rapidly, a large share of India's population still relies on local kirana stores and informal markets. An overcorrection towards digital prices could risk skewing the index in the opposite direction, making it less reflective of rural and lower-income consumption patterns. The challenge, therefore, lies in achieving balance—capturing new consumption realities without losing sight of persistent ones.

Beyond methodology, the broader implication of these changes lies in how inflation is interpreted and acted upon. A more accurate CPI could alter the trajectory of monetary policy. If inflation is measured more precisely—and perhaps differently—it could influence how the Reserve Bank of India calibrates interest rates. Fiscal policy, too, could be affected, particularly in areas such as subsidy design and social welfare adjustments that rely on inflation benchmarks. For businesses, more reliable data could improve pricing strategies and investment decisions. But perhaps the most important impact is on public trust. Inflation is not just a number; it is a perception. When official data diverges too sharply from what people experience in their daily expenses, credibility erodes. Updating the CPI framework is, in that sense, as much about restoring trust as it is about refining statistics.

In a rapidly digitising and diversifying economy, measurement cannot remain static. India's move to revise its CPI base year and incorporate e-commerce pricing is a necessary step towards aligning economic data with economic reality. Yet, it is only a step. The success of this transition will depend on execution—on how transparently methodologies are designed, how inclusively data sources are chosen, and how carefully the balance between old and new consumption patterns is maintained. Inflation measurement, at its core, is about capturing the rhythm of everyday life. As that rhythm changes, so must the instruments used to track it. The real test will be whether these changes make inflation not just more precise on paper, but more meaningful to the people whose lives it seeks to measure.

GREEN
THOUGHTS



PRAVEEN GARG & PAWAN
JAI SINGH RATHORE

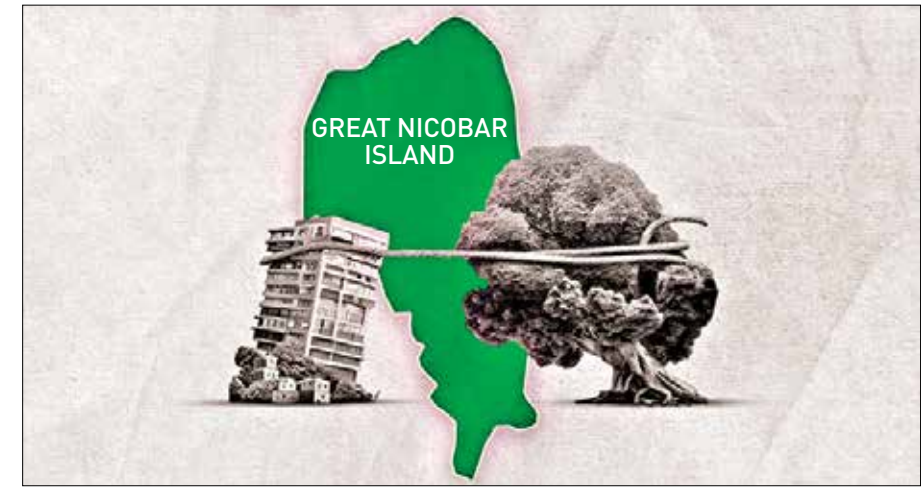
MR GARG IS THE
PRESIDENT AND
MR RATHORE
IS A RESEARCH
ASSOCIATE,
BOTH AT MOBIUS
FOUNDATION

The National
Green Tribunal's
ruling reflects
a broader
shift—where
environmental
governance
must increasingly
accommodate
national security
and economic
imperatives

The UK-based think tank Chatham House, in a recent article, observed that "we are on the verge of a 'multiplex' order, in which 're-globalization' is led by Asia and Global South nations." Similar assessments of the end of unipolarity have been expressed by John Mearsheimer of the University of Chicago, who remarked: "My bottom line is that the unipolar moment [was] really a wonderful time. ... But it's gone away, and we actually live in very dangerous times." Recent empirical evidence supports this view. The risk analytics firm Verisk Maplecroft reports that conflict-affected territory expanded by 89 per cent globally between 2021 and 2025. The Geopolitical Risk (GPR) Index has also remained elevated in recent years, reflecting recurring geopolitical crises. Similarly, according to the latest estimates of the global Black-Rock Geopolitical Risk Indicator, which aims to capture overall market attention to geopolitical risks, there is a very high likelihood of a prolonged regional war in the Middle East, which would lead to serious disruptions to energy infrastructure and increase volatility.

Against this evolving geopolitical environment, India has intensified efforts to strengthen its strategic position in the Indo-Pacific region through the development of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands. These islands provide India with a natural strategic vantage point in the eastern Indian Ocean. Located close to the entrance of the Strait of Malacca, they overlook a significant portion of global maritime trade routes, including vital crude oil shipping lanes. Their geographical position at the intersection of the Indian Ocean, the South China Sea, and the Pacific Ocean underscores their importance within India's broader eastward and Indo-Pacific strategic orientation.

Within this strategic framework, the Great Nicobar Mega Project, a ₹80,000-crore green-field infrastructure initiative, has been proposed on Great Nicobar Island. The project aims to transform the island into a major maritime, logistics, and urban hub. Its key components include a container trans-shipment ter-



Great Nicobar is not just a project—it is a test of how India balances power with prudence

minal, an international airport, a gas-solar hybrid power plant, and a large coastal township designed to support long-term economic development and maritime logistics.

Legal Challenges & The NGT

The project has nevertheless faced criticism from environmental activists. Much of Great Nicobar Island falls within the Great Nicobar Biosphere Reserve and forms part of a globally significant biodiversity hotspot. Critics have therefore argued that the scale of development is ecologically risky and legally questionable. In the first round of litigation, the forest clearance granted by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC) for the diversion of 130.75 square kilometres of forest land was challenged. The National Green Tribunal (NGT), in its order dated 03.04.2023, held that the diversion complied with the provisions of the National Forest Policy, 1988, and further noted that the project area does not fall within the boundaries of any National Park, Wildlife Sanctuary, or Eco-Sensitive Zone, contrary to the claims advanced by the appellants.

In a second round of litigation, the environmental clearance granted to the project in 2022 was challenged. The appellants argued that the project encroached upon the Coastal Regulation Zone (CRZ), an important nesting habitat for leatherback turtles. However, the Expert Appraisal Committee noted that portions of the proj-

ect "falling under CRZ would be excluded from the revised layout of the master plan." The appellants also raised concerns regarding the presence of coral formations in the area. A study conducted by the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) concluded that only scattered coral formations exist in the region and that these could be translocated if necessary. Another issue raised by the appellants was that the Environmental Impact Assessment required data from three seasons, whereas the Ministry had relied on a single-season dataset. The Tribunal accepted the submission of the Additional Solicitor General (ASG) that such additional data was unnecessary because the region does not contain high-erosion coastal sites.

After considering these issues, the Tribunal accepted the findings of the relevant expert bodies. In its judgment, it stated that "adequate safeguards have been provided in the EC... and, considering the strategic importance of the Project and taking into account the other relevant considerations, we do not find any good ground to interfere."

Legal Principles

From a legal standpoint, the Tribunal's task was to determine whether the statutory procedures governing environmental and forest clearances had been followed. It concluded that the applicable procedures had indeed been complied with. Despite this, critics have argued that tribunals should not rely extensively on government submissions and

must instead apply independent technical assessment when adjudicating such challenges.

However, the administrative law doctrine of agency deference provides support for the Tribunal's approach. Under this principle, courts and tribunals often accord significant weight to the interpretations and decisions of executive agencies when those decisions fall within the agencies' specialised domain of expertise. In the Great Nicobar case, the Tribunal recognised that institutions such as the High-Powered Committee of the MoEFCC, the Expert Appraisal Committee, and the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) possess specialised scientific and regulatory expertise relevant to the issues under consideration.

The logic underlying the doctrine of agency deference is that the agency responsible for formulating and implementing regulatory frameworks is often best positioned to interpret and apply them. Judicial review, therefore, requires a careful balance between oversight by courts and respect for the expertise of administrative institutions. In this case, that balance appears to have been maintained.

This approach also aligns with the evolving environmental jurisprudence of the Supreme Court of India. In its landmark decision in *M.K. Ranjitsinh v. Union of India*, the Court emphasised the need to reconcile competing environmental priorities. It held that, when considering the goal of conservation vis-à-

vis development projects, "it is necessary to adopt a holistic approach which does not sacrifice either of the two goals at the altar of the other." The reasoning of the Tribunal in the present case reflects this holistic approach, where environmental protection is harmonised with institutional competence and broader strategic considerations.

International Approaches

Comparative jurisprudence from other jurisdictions reveals similar reasoning. In *R (HS2 Action Alliance Ltd) v. Secretary of State for Transport*, the Supreme Court of the United Kingdom allowed the government to proceed with the High Speed 2 railway project despite unresolved environmental assessment concerns, emphasising the limits of judicial intervention in major policy decisions. Likewise, in *Winter v. Natural Resources Defense Council*, the Supreme Court of the United States held that national security interests outweighed certain environmental concerns.

Similar outcomes are also visible in civil law jurisdictions. In *Association Coordination Interrégionale Stop THT v. France*, French administrative courts upheld the construction of high-voltage transmission lines deemed essential for national energy security after determining that environmental impact procedures had been satisfied and the infrastructure had been declared a public utility. German courts adopted a comparable approach in litigation concerning the Gorleben Nuclear Waste Repository, where an extensive review was conducted, but federal authorities ultimately retained broad planning discretion.

Viewed in this broader perspective, the judgment of the National Green Tribunal demonstrates India's effort to pursue a model of environmentally conscious development that accommodates both ecological protection and strategic imperatives. It reflects an attempt to ensure that environmental governance evolves alongside changing geopolitical realities while maintaining the institutional balance between expert regulatory bodies, tribunals, and courts.

Views expressed are personal

Breaking The Import Trap

As global energy markets grow unstable, India's expanding biofuel capacity offers a strategic pathway to reduce import dependence, strengthen resilience and achieve long-term energy security

The global energy system is no longer stable—it is fragmented. Geopolitical tensions, particularly in the Middle East, along with sanctions and supply-chain disruptions, have transformed oil and gas markets into arenas of strategic contestation. For India, which imports over 85 per cent of its crude oil and more than half of its LPG, this volatility directly translates into inflationary pressures, fiscal strain, and external vulnerability.

Yet, within this disruption lies a strategic opportunity. India's biofuel sector—spanning ethanol, compressed biogas (CBG), and biomass—has reached a critical inflexion point. The challenge now is not technological feasibility, but policy direction and scale.

A Success Story Creating a New Challenge

India's ethanol blending programme stands out as one of its most successful energy transitions. Blending has risen from about 1.5 per cent in 2014 to 20 per cent in 2025—achieved ahead of schedule. Ethanol production capacity has expanded to roughly 16-17 billion litres annually.

However, success has created a new challenge. Ethanol production capacity in the country is now estimated at around 17-18 billion litres, while demand for E20 blending is only about 10-11 billion litres. This surplus highlights a structural imbalance—India has built supply faster than demand. **CBG: High Potential, Limited Scale**

Compressed biogas presents a parallel opportunity. India has over 130 operational



India must move beyond targets and scale biofuels into a core pillar of its energy security and economic strategy

CBG plants with a combined output of around 900+ tonnes per day. Yet, this remains small compared to the country's LPG consumption of 31-32 million tonnes annually, more than half of which is imported.

CBG can serve as an immediate substitute for LPG in commercial and industrial applications—but policy support and infrastructure remain inadequate.

The Brazil Lesson: Clarity Drives Investment

Brazil's ethanol success is rooted in policy certainty. With blending levels of 27-30 per cent and widespread adoption of flex-fuel vehicles, Brazil created a stable, long-term roadmap that aligned farmers, fuel suppliers, and automakers.

This predictability enabled sustained investment across the value chain. India must now adopt a similar roadmap to avoid underutilization of its growing biofuel capacity. **Countering the Narrative:**

Ethanol's Strategic Value

It is also important to acknowledge that India's ethanol programme has not evolved without resistance. At various stages, vested interests—ranging from segments of the fossil fuel ecosystem to sections of the food and environmental lobby—have sought to cast doubts on ethanol's viability, raising concerns around food security, water use, and efficiency.

While some of these concerns merit careful policy calibration, the broader narrative has often been disproportionately negative, overlooking the tangible benefits already delivered. Today, with global oil markets under stress, the strategic value of ethanol is unmistakable. Achieving 20 per cent blending has effectively translated into significant savings in crude oil imports—shielding India from external shocks, reducing foreign exchange outflows, and stabilising domestic

fuel prices. In the current geopolitical environment, this is not just an energy policy success; it is a strategic buffer for the Indian economy.

A 10-Point Biofuel Agenda

To build on this momentum, India needs a coherent and forward-looking strategy:

- **Mandate LPG substitution with CBG (20-40 per cent)**
Focus on commercial and industrial users to create immediate demand.
- **Build decentralised CBG infrastructure**
Support compression, storage, and last-mile distribution systems.
- **Introduce green production incentives for CBG**
Reward environmental performance to improve viability.
- **Strengthen carbon markets**
Enable biofuels to generate tradable carbon credits.
- **Shift ethanol policy from supply to demand**
Expand use beyond petrol blending into multiple sectors.

► **Announce a roadmap beyond E20 (toward E27)**
Provide long-term policy certainty.

► **Accelerate flex-fuel vehicles (FFVs)**
Offer fiscal incentives and promote retrofit solutions.

► **Scale advanced biofuels (2G ethanol, SAF, DME)**
Leverage agricultural residues and alternative pathways.

► **Promote ethanol and CBG for cooking energy**
Reduce LPG imports and expand clean energy access.

► **Mainstream solid biofuels**
Promote pellets, briquettes, and clean cookstoves. **From Vulnerability to Strategic Autonomy**

India's biofuel journey has already delivered measurable gains—reduced fuel imports, lower emissions, and increased rural incomes. But the next phase requires a shift from incremental progress to strategic intent.

Without expanding demand, surplus ethanol will remain underutilised. Without scaling CBG, import dependence on LPG will persist. Without policy alignment, investments will slow.

In a world defined by energy insecurity, biofuels offer India a rare pathway to resilience—built on domestic resources and decentralised production. A clear, long-term roadmap—on the lines of Brazil—can transform today's progress into enduring strategic strength.

The choice is clear: India can either remain vulnerable to global shocks or leverage biofuels to build true energy independence.

Views expressed are personal

IRAN CALLS TALKS FAKE

Trump claims contact with Iran’s ‘top, respected leader’, signals ongoing talks

WASHINGTON: President Donald Trump on Monday refused to name the Iranian leader the US is in talks with to end the three-week-old war, asserting that the interlocutor was a “top person” who is “most respected” in that country.

Speaking to reporters at the Palm Beach International Airport in Florida, Trump made it clear that the US was not in talks with the “second” Supreme Leader, a reference to Ayatollah Khamenei’s son Mojtaba Khamenei.

“A top person ... We are dealing with a man who I believe is the most respected and the leader,” Trump said as he headed for Memphis after spending the weekend at his Mar-a-Lago resort.

“We have not heard from the son,” he said, referring to Mojtaba Khamenei. “Every once in a while you will see a statement made (from Khamenei) but we don’t know if he’s living,” Trump said, adding that the US military has wiped out the Iranian leadership.

According to reports, Iran has denied being in talks with



A thick plume of smoke from a US-Israeli strike on an oil facility

AP/PTI

the US, but admitted that some countries in the region were making efforts to reduce tensions.

Axios news website quoted a US source as saying that Turkiye, Egypt, and Pakistan have been passing messages between the US and Iran over the past two days.

The foreign ministers of the three countries held separate

talks with White House envoy Steve Witkoff and Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi, the US source told Axios.

The president said Steve Witkoff, the US Special Envoy for the Middle East, and Jared Kushner spoke with their Iranian counterparts on Sunday.

However, Trump declined to say to whom Witkoff was speaking, saying he did not

want them to be killed.

“Nobody wants that job right now. Nobody’s exactly looking forward to being the head of that particular country, but perhaps we’ll be able to solve that problem,” he said.

Starting February 28, the US and Israel launched a joint attack on Iran, which killed Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei.

In Short

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» Axios news website quoted a US source as saying that Turkiye, Egypt, and Pakistan have been passing messages between the US and Iran over the past two days

The joint strikes came after days of build-up with US President Donald Trump ramping up the pressure on Tehran to agree to a new deal on its nuclear programme.

Iran’s retaliation escalated the war to the entire Gulf region. Turkey’s Foreign Ministry declined to comment Monday on whether the country had relayed messages between Iran and the U.S.

AGENCIES

Ukraine claims ‘irrefutable’ proof of Russia intel to Iran

‘Russia is using its own signals intelligence’

KYIV: Ukraine’s military intelligence has “irrefutable” evidence that Russia continues to provide intelligence to Iran, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on Monday after meeting the head of military intelligence. The statement adds to ongoing tensions between Kyiv and Moscow, while also raising concerns about the broader geopolitical alignments involving Iran.

In a post on X, Zelenskyy said that Russia is actively leveraging its intelligence capabilities and sharing them beyond its borders. “Russia is using its own signals intelligence and electronic intelligence capabilities, as well as part of the data obtained through cooperation with partners in the Middle East,” he noted, without providing further operational details. His remarks followed a briefing with Ukraine’s military intelligence leadership, where the latest assessments of Russian activities were reportedly discussed.

Ukraine has repeatedly accused Russia of strengthening its ties with Iran, particularly in the context of military cooperation and technology



People look at residential buildings damaged by an Iranian missile

The statement adds to ongoing tensions between Kyiv and Moscow

exchange. These claims come amid wider allegations that Iran has been supplying drones and other military equipment to Russia for use in its ongoing war in Ukraine, although both Moscow and Tehran have consistently denied the extent of such cooperation.

The Kremlin, meanwhile, has dismissed recent reports suggesting deeper collaboration between the two coun-

tries. Last week, it rejected a Wall Street Journal report that claimed Russia was sharing satellite imagery and advanced drone technology with Iran. Calling the report “fake news,” Russian officials denied any such transfer of sensitive military data or technology. The exchange of accusations highlights the increasingly complex web of alliances and rivalries shaping the conflict. Ukraine’s claims point to what it sees as a growing axis of cooperation between Russia and Iran, particularly in areas related to surveillance, drone warfare, and intelligence gathering. Such cooperation could have significant implications.

AGENCIES

Denmark heads to parliamentary polls amid Trump shadow



An election advertisement for PM Mette Frederiksen

REUTERS

COPENHAGEN: Danish Prime Minister Mette Frederiksen’s Social Democrats are headed for their weakest result in more than a century in Tuesday’s parliamentary election, yet she is favoured to stay in power after a vote shadowed by US President Donald Trump’s push to take control of Greenland.

Trump’s repeated calls to annex Greenland, a semi-autonomous Danish territory, have injected a rare geopolitical charge into the campaign ahead of the election, even as voters remain primarily focused on welfare, inequality and the cost of living. Opinion polls indicate that Frederiksen received a small boost when Trump’s Greenland rhetoric intensified earlier this year, particularly after the U.S. president refused to rule out the use of military force.

But the Greenland issue has since moved to a less heated diplomatic track and has been overtaken by domestic concerns over the cost of living, Frederiksen’s proposal for a wealth tax on the rich, and ongoing debates about immigration policy.

Frederiksen, who has led Denmark since 2019, is seeking a third term, though her grand coalition government, the first to bridge the left-right divide in more than 40 years, is projected to lose its parliamentary majority.

Frederiksen herself has made clear she sees the election as a test of leadership as much as policy, promoting herself as a safe pair of hands at a time of war in Ukraine and the Middle East and to handle Trump’s pressure. “To a large degree, this election is about Mette Frederiksen,” said Hans Engell, a veteran political analyst.

AGENCIES

COLLIDES AT LANDING IN NEW YORK AIRPORT

Pilots killed as Air Canada flight hits fire truck

NEW YORK: Two pilots were killed after an Air Canada regional jet collided with a fire truck on a runway during landing at New York’s LaGuardia Airport late Sunday night, officials said.

The collision crushed the nose of the aircraft, while 39 passengers and crew members were taken to area hospitals, some with serious injuries. Most have since been released from treatment, authorities said Monday.

Two Port Authority employees who were travelling in the fire truck also suffered injuries that were not believed to be life-threatening, said Kathryn Garcia, executive director of the Port Authority of New York and New Jersey, which operates the airport.

The two deceased individ-



An Air Canada Jet on the runway at LaGuardia Airport after collision

AP

uals were the pilot and copilot of the aircraft. Both were based out of Canada, Garcia said during a news conference early Monday.

The airport will remain closed until at least 2 pm Monday to facilitate the investigation, which is being led by the National Transportation Safety

Board (NTSB).

The fire truck was travelling across the runway to respond to a separate incident aboard a United Airlines flight, whose pilot had reported “an issue with odour,” said Garcia, who deferred additional questions about the sequence of events leading up to the crash to the

39 passengers, crew members were taken to area hospitals

NTSB.

There were 72 passengers and four crew members aboard the aircraft, a Jazz Aviation flight operating on behalf of Air Canada, according to a statement from the airline. The flight originated at Montreal-Pierre Elliott Trudeau International Airport, the major airport serving Montreal.

Photos and videos from the scene showed severe damage to the front of the aircraft, with cables and debris hanging from a mangled cockpit.

AGENCIES

N Korea to cancel summit with Japan unless it drops ‘anachronistic’ ways

SEOUL: The powerful sister of North Korean leader Kim Jong Un said Monday a summit between her brother and Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi won’t happen if Japan sticks to “its anachronistic” approach.

Kim Yo Jong’s statement came after Takaichi told reporters last week that she had informed US President Donald Trump during a summit in Washington that she had “a very strong desire” to meet Kim Jong Un. “But this is not the one

‘Japan should first be determined to break with its anachronistic practice’

that comes true, as wanted or decided by Japan,” Kim Yo Jong said. “In order for the top leaders of the two countries to meet each other, Japan should first be determined to break with

its anachronistic practice and habit.”

Kim Yo Jong, who is also a senior official, didn’t explicitly say what Japan’s “anachronistic practice and habit” are. However, in 2024, she said in a statement that North Korea’s acceptance of a reported offer for a meeting by one of Takaichi’s predecessors would depend on Japan tolerating the North’s nuclear weapons program and ignoring its past abductions of Japanese nationals.

AGENCIES

Israeli settlers smash cars, set fires in West Bank as 4 Palestinians killed

RAMALLAH: At least 10 Palestinians were injured in attacks in the occupied West Bank by Israeli settlers, who rampaged through nearby villages after holding a funeral for a settler killed in a car crash a night earlier.

The Palestinian Red Crescent Society said the wounded in Deir al-Hatab included a 45-year-old man shot in the foot and a woman suffering from smoke inhalation. Videos obtained by The Associated Press show cars and homes set

ablaze as army flares lit up the sky near the village east of Nablus and next to the Israeli settlement of Elon Moreh.

The arson and assaults in four Nablus-area villages on Sunday came a day after the official Palestinian news agency WAFA reported simultaneous attacks in at least six communities overnight -- the latest spates of violence in the occupied West Bank. Sunday night’s rampage came after mourners in the settlement of Elon Moreh held a funeral for Yehuda Sher-

man, an 18-year-old Israeli settler. Authorities said he was killed in a collision with a Palestinian vehicle in an area north of the villages attacked. Police said they were investigating the settlers’ claims that the collision was deliberate. Israel’s military did not respond to questions about Sunday night’s attacks.

The violence came as Israel’s government presses ahead with new settlements in the occupied West Bank and attacks by settlers -- including arsons, shootings and beatings.

AGENCIES

China ‘sincerely pleased’ with Pakistan’s achievements

BEIJING: Chinese President Xi Jinping on Monday praised Pakistan for “safeguarding” its sovereignty and territorial integrity, saying Beijing is “sincerely pleased” with Islamabad’s social development achievements.

Xi made the remarks in a message to his counterpart Asif Ali Zardari on Pakistan Day.

For a long time, the government and people of Pakistan have steadfastly safeguarded national sovereignty, independence, territorial integrity and national dignity, Xi said.

He added that they have also overcome various risks and challenges, advanced national development and made contributions to regional peace, stability, and development.

“As a close friend, China is sincerely pleased with Pakistan’s development achievements,” Xi said, adding Beijing attaches “great importance” to the development of bilateral ties. He said this year marks the start of China’s 15th Five-Year Plan and the 75th anniversary of diplomatic ties between China and Pakistan.

AGENCIES

Eyes in the sky, radars on the ground: How the US tracks Iran’s threats

US and its allies have built a layered system to watch skies day and night

OXFORD (US): The global price of oil continues to skyrocket as Iran’s missiles and drones hit vital infrastructure in Arab Gulf states. Billion-dollar American radar systems have also been targeted and destroyed across the Middle East by Iran, seemingly degrading US defenses.

US military presence near Iran includes dozens of locations and tens of thousands of troops in harm’s way. This raises the question: If a missile is launched from Iran toward a US military base in the region, how do service members know in time to stay safe?

The United States and its allies have built a layered system to watch the skies day and night. This system uses satellites in space, radar on the ground, ships at sea and aircraft in the air. It also depends on well-trained military members from US Space Command who make quick decisions with the data. As a former US Air Force officer and now aerospace and



US satellites can rapidly detect ballistic missile launches

AP

national security law professor at the University of Mississippi, I’ve studied the vast network of alliances and systems that make this happen.

Together, these tools form a missile defense network that can spot danger early and give warnings. The fastest way to spot a missile is from space. US satellites, like the US Space Force’s Space-Based Infra-

red System, circle high above Earth. These billion-dollar satellites, the crown jewels of missile defense, can spot the bright heat from a missile launch almost instantly.

When a missile is fired, it creates a strong enough heat signal to be seen in space. The satellites detect this heat using sensitive, infrared sensors and send an alert within seconds.

Summary

» The US uses both short and long-range radars together. One powerful, long-range radar is the AN/FPS-132 Upgraded Early Warning Radar

» It can see missiles from over 3,000 miles away and track them as they travel. Another key system is the US Army’s AN/TPY-2 Surveillance Transportable Radar

This early warning is critical. It gives the military on the ground or at sea time to get defense systems ready.

The warning signal from space is then received on the ground by systems known as the US Space Force’s Joint Tactical Ground Stations. The signal is sent from space using secure satellite communications, received by these ground

stations, and then quickly distributed to other parts of the missile defense network.

But satellites cannot do everything to detect and track missiles. They need help from systems on Earth. After a missile is launched, ground-based radars take over from the initial satellite signal. Radars work by sending out radio waves. When those waves hit an object, like a missile, they bounce back. The radar then uses that information to track where the object is and where it is going.

The US uses both short and long-range radars together. One powerful, long-range radar is the AN/FPS-132 Upgraded Early Warning Radar. It can see missiles from over 3,000 miles away and track them as they travel. Another key system is the US Army’s AN/TPY-2 Surveillance Transportable Radar. This radar has a range of almost 2,000 miles and looks more closely at the missile to provide more information about the threat.

AGENCIES

World Briefs

FRENCH EX-PM JOSPIN, ARCHITECT OF 35-HOUR WEEK, DIES AT 88

PARIS: French former Prime Minister Lionel Jospin, who gave France its 35-hour work week and then withdrew from politics after leading France’s Socialist Party to an earth-shaking presidential election defeat against far-right firebrand Jean-Marie Le Pen, has died. He was 88. His death was confirmed by the current prime minister, Sebastian Lecornu, after the national news agency, Agence France-Presse, reported that Jospin died on Sunday, citing his family. Lecornu said in a post on X that Jospin “served France with constancy, rigour and a sense of responsibility” and that “his actions, guided by a certain vision of social progress and republican values, leave a lasting mark and a model of commitment.”

SLOVENIA’S PRESIDENT URGES TALKS ON FUTURE GOVERNMENT AFTER POLLS

LJUBLJANA: Slovenia’s president on Monday urged the country’s political parties to start talks on forming a new government as soon as possible after a parliamentary election on the weekend in the European Union country ended with no clear winner and the main players practically tied. Prime Minister Robert Golob’s liberal Freedom Movement won 29 seats in the 90-member assembly while the opposition right-wing Slovenian Democratic Party, or SDS, won 28, according to preliminary results of 99.85 per cent of votes counted by the state election authorities.

FACES FIRST MAJOR SETBACK AS PM

Italian voters reject judicial reform in setback for Meloni

ROME: Italian voters rejected a judicial reform backed by conservative Premier Giorgia Meloni, delivering a stinging setback to the right-wing government one year ahead of national elections.

The “No” camp won around 54 per cent of the vote against the government-backed “Yes” campaign, which secured about 46 per cent, according to almost final Interior Ministry data.

Turnout over the two-day ballot, which began on Sunday, was considerably higher than expected at almost 59 per cent following a polarising



Giorgia Meloni casts her ballot on Monday

campaign. The vote galvanised the centre-left opposition while exposing fractures within the right-wing coalition that supports Meloni.

The defeat of the referendum risks weakening Meloni's leadership both at home and abroad. It may also complicate her efforts to defend her con-

Turnout over the two-day ballot, which began Sunday, was considerably higher than expected at almost 59%

troversial alignment with US President Donald Trump and his increasingly unpopular war on Iran.

The referendum centred on long-debated reforms aimed at reshaping the structure of Italy's judiciary. A key measure included separating the career paths of judges and prosecutors, preventing them from switching roles.

Another major change concerned the High Judicial Council, which oversees magistrates' appointments and disciplinary matters. The reform proposed splitting it into three separate chambers and altering how members are chosen, replacing internal elections with selections by lottery from eligible judges and prosecutors.

बिहार पुलिस भवन निर्माण निगम

(बिहार सरकार का उपक्रम)
CIN) U45200BR1974GC001126
प्रधान कार्यालय- कोटिल्य नगर, विहिारसहासुरा-5, थाना हवाई अड्डा, पटना-800014.
मोबाईल नं० : 9471006801 वेबसाईट : www.bpbcc.bihar.gov.
अलकालीन ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या- 42 /SBD / 2025-26

1 विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता :

मुख्य अभियन्ता, बिहार पुलिस भवन निर्माण निगम, मुख्यालय, पटना

2. निविदा आमंत्रित करने की तिथि :

दि०- 19-03-2026

3. निविदा डाउनलोड करने की तिथि :

दि०- 18-05-2026 से 18-06-2026 तक

4. निविदा अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय :

दि०- 19-06-2026 को 17.00 बजे तक

5. प्री बीड मीटिंग की तिथि, समय एवं स्थान :

दि०- 01-06-2026 को 15.00 बजे।
मुख्य अभियन्ता, बिहार पुलिस भवन निर्माण निगम, मुख्यालय, पटना के कार्यालय कक्ष में।

6. (क) तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :

दिनांक- 22-06-2026 को 16:00 बजे

(ख) तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :

तकनीकी बीड का निष्पादन सक्षम प्राधिकार से होने के पश्चात्।

(ग) परिमाण-विपन्न का मूल्य, विधिवत रूप में अग्रघन तिथि, समय एवं स्थान :

कंठिका-21 के अनुसार

7. निविदा पत्र बिक्री का स्थान :

www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर

8. निविदा की वेबसाइट अवधि :

180 दिन

9. कार्य का विवरण :-

क्र.सं.	कार्य का नाम	कराई अंतिम, विपन्न मा. ति. दि. कार्य 90	परिमाण विपन्न की राशि (लाख रु. में)	अग्रघन की राशि (रु. में)	निविदा कागजात का मूल्य (रु. में)	बीड प्रोसेसिंग चार्ज सेवा कर सहित	कराई समाप्ति की अवधि
1	कोटहर जिलानगर 02 सुनिटे के अंतर्गत अग्निशमन, बारसोई के भवन (G+3 Structure), Generator Set 125 KVA, Rain water Harvesting, Fire Hydrant/ Under Ground RCC Tank, का निर्माण कार्य।	पूर्णांग	70515607	1410320	10000	As per eproc 2	12 माह
2	कोटहर जिलानगर पुलिस केंद्र, कोटहर में 38 वक्ता के 03 मॉडल ट, मिंग ब्लाकसम (G+1) भवन, फर्नीचर एवं आवास्तु संरचना सहित के निर्माण कार्य।	पूर्णांग	43537757	870760	10000	As per eproc 2	12 माह
3	पूर्णांग जिलानगर पुलिस केंद्र, पूर्णांग में 38 वक्ता के 03 मॉडल ट, मिंग ब्लाकसम (G+1) भवन, फर्नीचर एवं आवास्तु संरचना सहित के निर्माण कार्य।	पूर्णांग	43537757	870760	10000	As per eproc 2	12 माह
4	पटना जिलानगर विपन्न थाना में मॉडल थाना भवन (G+3 Structure) का विद्युत्करण सहित निर्माण कार्य।	पटना	58974766	1179500	10000	As per eproc 2	12 माह
5	पटना जिलानगर पुलिस केंद्र, पटना में 38 वक्ता के 03 मॉडल ट, मिंग ब्लाकसम (G+1) भवन, फर्नीचर एवं आवास्तु संरचना सहित के निर्माण कार्य।	पटना	43537757	870760	10000	As per eproc 2	12 माह
6	बक्सर जिलानगर बिहार सेन पुलिस (BSAP) दूरबीन के बदलदिकारी का निर्माण कार्य।	पटना	24033271	480670	10000	As per eproc 2	12 माह
7	जलनाबाद जिलानगर यातायात थाना (G+4) का विद्युत्करण सहित निर्माण कार्य।	पटना	85801893	1716040	10000	As per eproc 2	12 माह
10	इस निविदा की अन्य विस्तृत जानकारी एवं आवश्यक शर्तें अधोहस्ताक्षरी के कार्यालय के सूचना पत्र एवं वेबसाईट www.bpbcc.co.in पर देखा जा सकता है तथा ई-निविदा-पत्र www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in से प्राप्त किया जा सकता है।						

ह० / -

मुख्य अभियन्ता, पटना

वित्त सूचना www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

नरो से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (FIU) Uttarakhand Jal Sansthan

INDRAPRASTH COLONY, LANE NO-3, NATHANPUR, DEHRADUN
Email. eewbfiu@gmail.com, Website: ujs.uk.gov.in

Letter No. 1643 /E-Tender Notice/2025-26

Dated 23.03.2026

CORRIGENDUM

Tender Notice No 1615/E-Tender Notice/2025-26, Dated 17.03.2026

The tender time Reschedule (Key Dates) is as follows: -

1 Date of Online Publication	27.03.2026 at 11:00 Hrs
2 Document download: Start Date	27.03.2026 From 17:00 Hrs.
3 Document download: End Date	15.04.2026 Upto 17:00 Hrs.
4 Pre-Bid Meeting	04.04.2026 at 13:00 Hrs.
5 Bid Submission: Start Date	08.04.2026 From 10:00 Hrs.
6 Bid Submission: End Date	15.04.2026 Upto 17:00 Hrs.
7 Date of Offline submission of documents (Cost of bidding document, Bid Security, Original Affidavits & all the Supporting Documents in support of qualification)	16.04.2026 Upto 17:00 Hrs.
8 Date of opening of technical bid	18.04.2026 at 13:00 Hrs.
9 Date of opening of Financial Bid	Later on.

“जल संवय-जीवन संवय”

Executive Engineer (FIU)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Nitish Kumar S/o Mahgu Bishwas R/o WZ-107, 80 Gaj, Tilak Nagar, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 225/2020, U/S 188/269/270 IPC, PS Tilak Nagar, West Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Nitish Kumar** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Nitish Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Nitish Kumar** the said accused of **FIR No. 225/2020, U/S 188/269/270 IPC, PS Tilak Nagar, West Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.05.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vikas Madaan
Judicial Magistrate First Class -07,
West Distt., Room No. 289,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/3729/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

UJVN Limited

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dharadun-248006
Telephones: 0185-2763608, Fax: 0185-2763608
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 | Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No.: 234

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Date: 23.03.2026

Office of the Executive Engineer, PCM(GV), Mayapur, Haridwar invites sealed & separate tenders from interested bidders. Brief summary of tenders are given below:-

1. **Tender Notice Reference:-**
NIT No.- 21/2025-26/EE/PCM(GV)/Mayapur:- Annual M&R Work of Type-II Residences at Chilla Colony for the year 2026-27.
NIT No.- 22/2025-26/EE/PCM(GV)/Mayapur:- Annual M&R Work of Type-III & IV Residences at Chilla Colony for the year 2026-27.

2. **Estimated Value of Tenders:-** Rs. 19,93,482.78 & Rs. 19,98,695.30 respectively, excluding GST.

3. **Date of availability of bid document on website:-** 23.03.2026 from 11:00 Hrs.

4. **Last Date for Submission of Tender:-** 13.04.2026 upto 13:00 Hrs.

For eligibility criteria and full and further details kindly visit our website. The tender can be downloaded from our website i.e. <http://ujvnl.com> and tender cost shall be paid at the time of submission of the tender.

Executive Engineer, PCM (GV),
Mayapur, Haridwar

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय, रॉंची

सर्वसाधारण के लिए सूचना

अज्ञात बिशित पुरुष का शव उम्र करीब-62 वर्ष, उंचाई-5 फिट 4 इंच, रंग-साँवला, पहनावा-काला बेंट पहनाया-सीना में तील का निशान।
उपरोक्त अज्ञात बिशित पुरुष का शव तुपुदाना ओपीओ अन्तर्गत हरदाग चौक हनुमान मन्दिर के नजदीक रोड के किनारे से बरामद किया गया है। जिसके संबंध धर्मा(तुपुदाना ओपीओ) थाना यूओडी कांड सं०-03 / 26, दिनांक-22.02.2026 दर्ज किया गया है। इनकी पहचान हेतु जनता का सहयोग अपेक्षित है।
अतः सभी जनसाधारण से अनुरोध है कि यदि आपको इस अज्ञात बिशित पुरुष के शव के बारे में जानकारी हो तो वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक के कार्यालय रॉंची में या संबंधित थाना या निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर संपर्क कर इसकी सूचना दें।
पुलिस उपधीक्षक हटिया, रॉंची -9431706143
थाना प्रभारी तुपुदाना ओपीओ, रॉंची -9431706167

वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, रॉंची

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No.: JHS-N-W-24-26 Date: 20.03.2026

E-TENDERING NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/ Jhansi, DRM's Office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of President of India invite open Tender through VGLJ-DHO- (E-Tendering) for the following works.

E-Tender No.	Approx Cost	Earnest Money
JHS-N-W-24-26	Rs. 7784355.18/-	Rs. 155700/-

Description of work: Provision of S&T work in connection with VGLJ-DHO-TSR(P)-70.576 Tkm

Cost of Tender Form: Nil

Opening of tender: 13.04.2026, Time 15:00

Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance: 12 Months

* Tender on line can be submitted upto 15:00 hrs on 13.04.2026. * For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in (NORTH CENTRAL RLY/JHANSI DIVISION-S AND T) 643/26 (ADM)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPNOCR

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Office of the Principal Chief Materials Manager
Headquarters Office, Baroda House, New Delhi-110001,
Mail ID: salenr365@gmail.com

e-AUCTION NOTICE NO. 'April-2026'

No. 117-S/Sale/Auction Programme/2026-27 Dated. 23.03.2026

E-Auction will be conducted for disposal of Ferrous Scrap, Non Ferrous Scrap, Other Misc Scrap, Condemned Loco, Coaches and Wagons, Scrap Rail and other scrap P. Way material etc, Used lead Acid Batteries/Used Oil/Refused Oil etc will be sold only to recyclers registered with State Pollution Control Board. Auction programme is as under.

e-AUCTION DATES FOR 'April-2026'

S. No.	Depot/Division Auction Conducting Unit	Auction Starting Time	1 st round date	2 nd round date	3 rd round date	4 th round date	5 th round date
1	Alambagh/ Lucknow 0522-2451257	10:30 AM	9	13	16	20	23
2	Shakurbasti 011-27015387	10:30 AM	10	17	21	24	27
3	Jagadhari 01732-252388	10:30 AM	9	13	16	20	23
4	Sr.DMM/LKO 0522-2234756	10:30 AM	10	17	22	24	27
5	Sr.DMM/FZR 01632-244154	10:30 AM	13	17	22	27	29
6	Sr.DMM/UMB 0171-2611203	10:30 AM	10	16	20	23	28
7	Sr.DMM/MB 0591-2413141	10:30 AM	9	16	20	23	28
8	Sr.DMM/DLI 011-23365311	10:30 AM	8	13	21	24	28

1. The details of item to be sold in auction will be available in catalogue at www.ireps.gov.in. 2. The intending purchasers may inspect the scrap material before the auction during working hours at nominated locations. 3. To participate in e-auction, purchasers need to get themselves registered with ireps. The details on last sold rates in auctions are available at www.railnet.gov.in. 4. For further details regarding registration and other conditions of e-auction, please visit Railway website www.ireps.gov.in

Dy. Chief Material Manager/S&P

961/26

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (CIVIL) AU & PC, CSPGCL,
Shed No. 2, Dangania, Raipur-492013 Phone No. 0771-2576320 & 0771-2576324, website: www.cspc.co.in E-mail- cecivil.aupc@gmail.com

No. 03-15/W/ 1747

Raipur, date 17.03.2026

SHORT TERM E-TENDER NOTICE

Online bids are invited through CSPCL e-bidding system (SAP SRM) from eligible bidders fulfilling the eligibility criteria as mentioned below and having experience in Govt./Public Sector Undertaking/Local bodies/Power Generating Companies in India only for the following work :-

Sl. No.	Tender Specification No.	Description	NIT value i/c GST (Rs.)	EMD (Rs.)	Completion period (incl. Rainy season)	Rfx No.
1	CEC/AU&PC /HTPS-KW/ W/2025/131	Utilization of ash in eco-friendly manner by filling in various low lying area and abandoned quarry from ash dyke Dindolbhata/Silo of 1x500 MW Extn., HTPS, CSPGCL, Korba West.	419.30 Lacs	4,20,000/-	02 Months	81000 50110

Cost of tender form is Rs. 1180/- (Rs.1000/- + 18% GST). The due date & time for submission of bids, Tender Cost & EMD is 30.03.2026 (up to 15:00 Hrs) and bid opening date (Techno commercial bids) is 02.04.2026 (up to 16:00) Hrs respectively. The tender document can be viewed and downloaded online from our e-bidding portal <https://ebidding.cspcl.co.in>: 50724/ irj /portal.

Note:- (i) The L-1 bidder shall be decided on overall cost to company basis including GST. (ii) In case, the rate quoted by the bidder is on abnormally lower side, a performance guarantee @5% of contract value i/c GST in addition to Security Deposit shall have to be deposited by the bidder.(iii) Maintenance period for the work shall be 12 (Twelve) Months.(iv) Subletting of contract will not be allowed.

//Save Electricity// samvad 47275/2

Chief Engineer (Civil) AU & PC, CSPGCL, Raipur

NORTHERN RAILWAY

(E-Auction Notice)

Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/PS, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites bids through e-Auction through IREPS (<https://ireps.gov.in/>) for the allotment of under mention contracts at following Railway stations/locations:-

S E-Catalogue N No.	Date & Time of bidding	Railway Stations/Locations/Lots
Parking-09-2026	08.04.2026 at 11:00 Hrs	Parking cum Access Control Rights at Hazrat Nizamuddin Railway Station = Total 01 Site

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen <https://ireps.gov.in/>

All contractors who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfill following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids:

1. Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module -Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module. 2. Payment of One Time Registration Fee 3. Current Account in State Bank of India 4. Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account 5. Lien Marking of Funds 6. Updation of Turnover Details 7. Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender /E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query

Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi 110055. Email: pkg.delhidivision@gmail.com Tel: 011-23743084

No. 23AC/393/E-Auction/PKG/2026 Dated: 23.03.2026

980/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

STATE BANK OF INDIA

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE

BRANCH OFFICE: HOME LOAN CENTRE, A1/24, JANAKPURI, NEW DELHI-110058

NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION SALE ON 24.04.2026 FOR MOVABLE PROPERTY

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Movable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described movable property hypothecated / charged to the Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorized Officer State Bank of India, the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "As is Where is", "As is What is" and Whatever there is" on 24.04.2026, for recovery of bank due to the secured creditor as under :-

Interested bidder may deposit Pre-Bid EMD with BAANKNET before the close of e-Auction. Credit of Pre-Bid EMD shall be given to the bidder only after receipt of payment in BAANKNET's Bank Account and up-dation of such information in the e-auction website. This may take some time as per banking process and hence bidders, in their own interest, are advised to submit the pre-bid EMD amount well in advance to avoid any last minute problem.

Date / Time of E-Auction on 24.04.2026 for 6 Hours from 10:00 AM to 06:00 PM with unlimited extrn. of 10 minute each.

S. No.	Name of the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s)	Outstanding Dues for Recovery of which Property /ies is/are being Sold	Vehicle Description	Reserve Price (Rs.) (below which property could not be sold) Earnest Money (EMD) 10% of the Reserve Price Bid Increment Amount	Name of the Authorised Officer
1.	MR. BRIJ MOHAN PAHWA Car Loan A/c. No. 41874817932 G-37, First Floor, Kirti Nagar, West Delhi-110015	Rs. 6,36,546.00 as on 09.09.2025 plus future Interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: HONDA AMAZE RDE VXC4T Vehicle No.: DL10CV3066 Engine No.: L12B47817574 Chassis No.: MAKDF569DP4401129	₹ 5,00,000.00 ₹ 50,000.00 ₹ 10,000.00 * GST Inclusive	Mr. Kapil Muni Yadav (Chief Manager) HLC, A1/24, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058. Tel-011-79681631 Mr. Sandeep Mobile: 9315052074
2.	MR. MD. NAZIM SAFI Car Loan A/c. No. 41536153861 1144 Block D, DDA Flat, Pocket 3, Bindapur, New Delhi-110059.	Rs. 5,51,333.00 as on 08.10.2025 plus future Interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: KIGER RTX PETROL MT 1.0 Vehicle No.: DL10CV7028 Engine No.: B4DA417E197659 Chassis No.: MEEHBC000N9072818	₹ 3,75,000.00 ₹ 37,500.00 ₹ 10,000.00 * GST Inclusive	Mr. Kapil Muni Yadav (Chief Manager) HLC, A1/24, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058. Tel-011-79681631 Mr. Sandeep Mobile: 9315052074
3.	MR. RAJIV PANDEY Car Loan A/c. No. 41728424815 House No. 2103/A, 2nd Floor, Street No.13 Prem Nagar, New Delhi-110008.	Rs. 3,00,760.00 as on 19.02.2026 plus future Interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: BALENO DELTA CNG 1.2L 5MT Vehicle No.: DL10CV0553 Engine No.: K12NP4213827 Chassis No.: MBHHWB13SPB389932	₹ 3,60,000.00 ₹ 36,000.00 ₹ 10,000.00 *GST as applicable	Mr. Kapil Muni Yadav (Chief Manager) HLC, A1/24, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058. Tel-011-79681631 Mr. Hemant Mobile: 9034545090
4.	MS. RITU RITU Car Loan A/c. No. 43386792654 House No. 5, Kharsa No. 79/12, Behind Biswa Choti Manta Mandir, Sheela Colony, Gurgaon.	Rs. 16,01,239.00 as on 19.02.2026 plus future Interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: HONDA ELEVATE ZX CVT (I-VTEC) Vehicle No.: HR26FN2954 Engine No.: L15ZD2238269 Chassis No.: MAKDG587CR4016150	₹ 10,35,000.00 ₹ 1,03,500.00 ₹ 10,000.00 *GST as applicable	Mr. Kapil Muni Yadav (Chief Manager) HLC, A1/24, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058. Tel-011-79681631 Mr. Hemant Mobile: 9034545090
5.	MS. SHALINI SINGH Car Loan A/c. No. 42453415611 WZ-31, Palam Extn. Part-2, Nasirpur Road, New Delhi-110045.	Rs. 8,94,318.00 as on 23.03.2026 plus future Interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: GRAND VITARA SMART HYBRID SIGMA Vehicle No.: DL9C8D3779 Engine No.: K15CN7252546 Chassis No.: MBJTYKL15PK184990	₹ 6,85,000.00 ₹ 68,500.00 ₹ 10,000.00 *GST as applicable	Mr. Kapil Muni Yadav (Chief Manager) HLC, A1/24, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058. Tel-011-79681631 Mr. Hemant Mobile: 9034545090
6.	MR. SOURABH ANAND Car Loan A/c. No. 37997804866 4006, Gali No.106, Sant Nagar, Burari, Delhi-110084	Rs. 4,85,116.00 as on 19.02.2026 plus future Interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: MARUTI SUZUKI LXI Vehicle No.: DL6CR5692 Engine No.: K12MN7277320 Chassis No.: MBHC2C638JP207443	₹ 1,35,000.00 ₹ 13,500.00 ₹ 10,000.00 *GST as applicable	Mr. Kapil Muni Yadav (Chief Manager) HLC, A1/24, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058. Tel-011-79681631 Mr. Arun Mishra Mobile: 9795324241

Last Date of EMD Deposit on or before 24.04.2026 upto 9:00 A.M.

Account/ Wallet in which EMD is to be remitted : Bidder's own wallet Registered with BAANKNET on its e-auction site: <https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing> by means of NEFT/RTGS. EMD of Reserve Price to be transferred by bidders by means of challan generated on his/her/their bidder account maintained with BAANKNET on its e-auction site: <https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing> by means of NEFT from his/her/their bank. For any assistance, please call BAANKNET HELPDESK: +91 8291220220, support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com and/or Authorized Officer.

TERMS AND CONDITIONS OF THE E-AUCTION ARE AS UNDER:

(1) E-Auction is being held on "As is where is", "as is what is basis" and "whatever there is basis" and will be conducted "On Line". The auction will be conducted through the Bank's approved service provider BAANKNET at their web portal: <https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing>

(2) Bank shall reserve the right to cancel/postpone the auction.

(3) The Vehicle are available for inspection during banking hours on 22.04.2026 from 11:00 AM to 17:00 Hrs for Sl. No.1 to Sl. No.5 at Shriram Mall, Faridabad, and for Sl. No.6 at F-1, NBCC Complex, East Kirti Nagar, Delhi. Contact Person for Sl. No. 1 and Sl. No. 2 - Mr. Sandeep Mobile: 9315052074, Moneycure (Resolution Agent) & Contact Person for Sl. No. 3 & Sl. No. 4 and Sl. No. 5 - Mr. Hemant Kumar Mobile: 9034545090, M/s. Sural Legal Solutions Pvt. Ltd. (Resolution Agent) and For Sl. No. 6 - Mr. Arun Mishra Mobile: 97953242421, DSA Associates (Resolution Agent).

(4) Successful bidder to pay GST as applicable on the successful bid amount, viz sale value.

(5) To the best of knowledge and information of the Authorized Officer there is no encumbrance on the property/ies. However the intending bidder should make their own independent inquiries regarding the encumbrances, title of the property/ies put on auction and claims/ights/dues/affecting the property prior to submitting their bid.

The e-Auction Advertisement does not constitute and will not be deemed to constitute any commitment or any representation of the Bank. The property is being sold with all the existing and future encumbrances whether known or unknown to the bank. The Authorized Officer shall not be responsible in any way for any third party claims/rights/dues.

(6) The Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) of the successful bidder shall be retained towards part sale consideration and the EMD of the unsuccessful bidders shall be refunded. The Earnest Money Deposit shall not bear any interest. The successful bidder shall have to deposit 25% of the sale price, immediately on acceptance of bid price by the Authorized Officer and the balance of the sale price on or before 15th day of the sale. Default in deposit of amount by the successful bidder would entail forfeiture of the whole money already deposited and property shall be put to the e-auction and the defaulting bidder shall have no claim/right in respect of property/ amount.

(7) For detailed terms and conditions of the sale please refer to the link at the Bank's Service Provider's web portal: <https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing> & e-auction website: <https://BAANKNET.com>

Place: New Delhi Date: 23.03.2026

Authorized Officer, State Bank of India, Home Loan Centre, Janakpuri, New Delhi

millenniumpost

Sensex plunges 1,836 pts, Nifty sinks to 22,512 on boiling crude

Since the conflict began, the BSE benchmark Sensex has tumbled 8,590.8 points or 10.56% and the NSE Nifty lost 2,666 points or 10.58%

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Equity benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty plummeted on Monday, in tandem with an extremely weak trend in global markets as the war in the Middle East showed no signs of a slowdown.

Rising crude oil prices due to the war, which has entered its fourth week, relentless foreign fund outflows and weakness in the rupee have also made investors risk-averse.

The 30-share BSE Sensex dived 1,836.57 points, or 2.46 per cent, to settle at 72,696.39. During the day, it plunged 1,974.52 points, or 2.64 per cent, to 72,558.44.

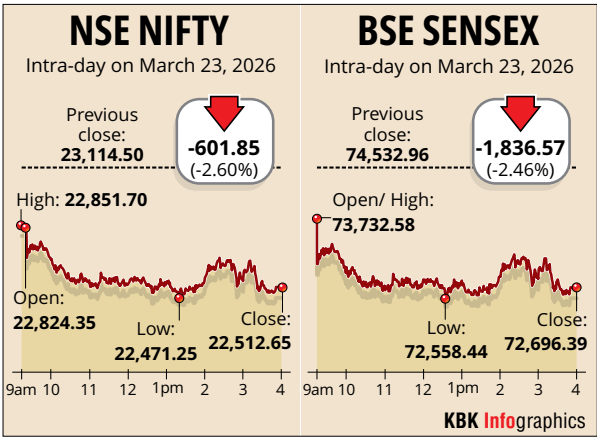
The 50-share NSE Nifty tanked 601.85 points, or 2.60 per cent, to end at 22,512.65.

From the 30-Sensex firms, Titan tumbled the most by 6.24 per cent. Trent, UltraTech Cement, Bharat Electronics, InterGlobe Aviation, Tata Steel, and HDFC Bank were also among the major laggards.

HCL Tech, Power Grid, Infosys, and Tech Mahindra were the winners.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 0.97 per cent to \$113.3 per barrel.

The BSE MidCap Select



The market capitalisation of BSE-listed companies eroded by Rs 48.29 lakh crore (Rs 48,29,041.45 crore) to Rs 415 lakh crore (Rs 4,15,21,629.82 crore) since then

Highlights

- » The BSE MidCap Select index tanked 3.82%, and SmallCap Select index plunged 3.66%
- » A total of 3,798 stocks declined, 635 advanced and 123 remained unchanged on the BSE
- » Consumer durables tumbled 4.91%, metal (4.76%), realty (4.75%), services (4.70%), BSE PSU Bank (4.39%), MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt (4.37%), commodities (4.35%), industrials (4.05%) and capital goods (3.99%)

Rupee closes flat at 93.53 against dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee breached the 94-level against the US dollar for first time on Monday, before closing flat at 93.53, amid a correction in global crude prices.

At the interbank foreign exchange, the local unit opened at 93.84 and breached the 94-mark against the US dollar for the first time in intraday trade. However, the unit recovered all lost ground to settle unchanged at 93.53.

The rupee went past the 93-mark against the greenback on Friday after crashing 64 paise to settle at 93.53.

The dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading 0.14 per cent higher at 99.78. India's forex reserves dropped \$7.052 billion to \$709.759 billion during the week ended March 13, the RBI said on Friday.

No proposal for complete loan waiver for farmers: Sitharaman

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: There is no proposal of a complete loan waiver for farmers under consideration with the central government, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman informed Parliament on Monday.

However, she said, the government has taken several measures to strengthen the economic conditions of the farmers, including timely and adequate credit through Kisan Credit Card (KCC), wherein crop loan up to Rs 3 lakh is provided at subsidised interest rates under the Modified Interest Subvention Scheme (MISS), with additional incentives for timely repayment.

Besides, the government has enhanced collateral free short-term agricultural loans, including loans for allied activities, from Rs 1.60 lakh to Rs 2.00 lakh and ensuring adequate flow of credit from the banking system to the priority sectors of the economy, including agriculture, under Priority Sector Lending guidelines issued by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), she said in a reply to the Lok Sabha.

Additionally, the government has launched crop insurance and direct cash transfer to landholding farmers through Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN), etc.

Replying to another question, Sitharaman said the exemption in respect of disability pension received by members of the armed forces, who are invalided out of service on account of a disability attributable to, or



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman

'The govt has also enhanced collateral free short-term agricultural loans, including loans for allied activities, from Rs 1.60 lakh to Rs 2.00 lakh'

aggravated by military service, has existed since the framework under the Income-Tax Act, 1922, as provided vide Notification No. 878-F (Income Tax) dated March 21, 1922.

When the Income-tax Act, 1961, came into force, she said, the exemption continued through the repeal and savings provisions.

"With the enactment of the Income-tax Act, 2025, the earlier enactments pertaining to the Income-tax Act, 1922, and related savings provisions ceased to operate. Therefore, in the absence of an express provision in the new Act, the exemption would have lapsed," the minister said.

The present provision

Key Points

- » However, she said, the govt has taken several measures to strengthen the economic conditions of the farmers, including timely and adequate credit through KCC
- » Under this crop loan up to Rs 3 lakh is provided at subsidised interest rates under the Modified Interest Subvention Scheme
- » Additionally, the government has launched crop insurance and direct cash transfer to landholding farmers through PM-KISAN

has been included to ensure the continuation of the same exemption that existed earlier, including its scope and conditions, she noted.

The finance minister emphasised that there is no discontinuation of the said tax exemption. "On the contrary, the Finance Bill, 2026, proposes to explicitly provide for a specific exemption in respect of disability pensions under the Income-tax Act, 2025," she said.

As of January 31, 2026, the number of armed forces personnel retired from service with disability is 1,47,263, while the number of armed forces personnel receiving disability pension who have been invalided out is 89,598 persons, she said.

RBI injects ₹79,256 cr into banking system via VRR auction



MUMBAI: The RBI on Monday infused Rs 79,256 crore transient liquidity into the banking system through overnight variable rate (VRR) auction.

The RBI injected the funds at cut-off and weighted average rates of 5.26 per cent, the central bank said in a release.

The liquidity injected was much lower than the notified amount of Rs 1 lakh crore, despite the sharp drop in surplus liquidity in the banking system due to advance tax payments.

Currently, liquidity in the banking system is estimated to be in deficit of about Rs 65,395.64 crore as on March 23.

On March 17, the central bank had infused Rs 25,101 crore transient liquidity in the banking system through a three-day VRR auction.

On March 17, the RBI injected Rs 48,014 crore liquidity in to the banking system via seven-day VRR.

Prior to this, the RBI infused Rs 3.50 lakh crore of durable liquidity into the banking system through open market purchase (OMO) of government securities since January 2026.

No proposal under consideration on merger of public sector banks, says MoS Finance

NEW DELHI: There is no proposal under consideration before the government on the merger or consolidation of public sector banks (PSBs) at present, Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary said on Monday.

Chaudhary, in a written reply to the Lok Sabha, said the amalgamation of PSBs helped create stronger competitive banks with economies of scale and scope while enabling the realisation of wide-ranging synergies.

Leveraging networks, better access to low-cost deposits, increased ability to support larger ticket-size lending, and competitive operations by virtue of greater financial capacity have provided the amalgamated banks a substantial rise in customer base, market reach

'The amalgamation of PSBs helped create stronger competitive banks with economies of scale and scope while enabling the realisation of wide-ranging synergies'

and operational efficiency, he added.

Synergy was also gained due to increased scope of operations and improvement in cost efficiency, with the adoption of best practices and digitisation, he said.

The amalgamation of PSBs, as envisaged, has contributed

to improving operational efficiency and financial soundness of banks through streamlining of operations and reduction in costs, thereby resulting in increasing consolidated business of banks, the minister noted.

Quoting Reserve Bank of India data, he said the consolidated total business of Bank of Baroda (BoB), in which Vijaya Bank and Dena Bank were amalgamated with effect from April 1, 2019, grew from Rs 16.1 lakh crore in March 2019 to Rs 27.0 lakh crore in March 2025.

Punjab National Bank (PNB), in which Oriental Bank of Commerce and United Bank of India were amalgamated with effect from April 1, 2020, grew from Rs 18.3 lakh crore in March 2020 to Rs 26.8 lakh

crore in March 2025.

The business of Union Bank of India (UBI), in which Andhra Bank and Corporation Bank were amalgamated with effect from April 1, 2020, grew from Rs 15.3 lakh crore in March 2020 to Rs 22.9 lakh crore in March 2025, while Canara Bank, in which Syndicate Bank was amalgamated with effect from April 1, 2020, expanded from Rs 15.7 lakh

crore in March 2020 to Rs 25.3 lakh crore in March 2025, he said.

The total business of Indian Bank, in which Allahabad Bank was amalgamated with effect from April 1, 2020, increased from Rs 8.6 lakh crore in March 2020 to Rs 13.3 lakh crore in March 2025, Chaudhary added.

India wins global PIARC Award for rural infra, digital governance

NEW DELHI/CHAMBÉRY (France): India has secured a major global recognition in rural infrastructure and digital governance at the 17th World Congress of the PIARC held in Chambéry, France.

A research paper titled "Development and Implementation of Performance-Based Assessment Matrix for Economy in Rural Roads Maintenance Management in PMGSY in India" by Pradeep Agrawal won the PIARC Prize in the Low- and Middle-Income Countries category, placing India among six global awardees.

The Congress witnessed

participation from over 2,000 delegates and experts from more than 60 countries, underscoring the significance of the achievement.

The award recognises India's work under the Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY) in transforming rural road maintenance through digital governance.

The e-MARG platform enables performance-based payments linked to actual road conditions using geotagged evidence and real-time monitoring.

The paper, part of Agrawal's PhD research under Dr. Gurendra Nath Bhardwaj

of NIIT University, received strong appreciation from global experts, many of whom showed interest in replicating the model.

Agrawal, former Director (Projects), NRIDA, said, "This recognition reflects India's commitment to transparent, technology-driven and citizen-centric governance... delivering measurable outcomes for society."

The achievement highlights the success of flagship initiatives under Narendra Modi and Shivraj Singh Chouhan, supported by the Ministry of Rural Development and state agencies.

HZL, Tata Steel partner to boost use of low-carbon zinc in steel making

NEW DELHI: Vedanta group firm Hindustan Zinc Ltd (HZL) on Monday said it has partnered with Tata Steel to expand the use of its low-carbon zinc solution, EcoZen, in steel manufacturing.

The partnership highlights both firms' resolve to weave climate priorities into their core operations and sourcing strategies.

"Hindustan Zinc... has strengthened its longstanding association with Tata Steel to expand the integration of EcoZen, its lowcarbon zinc solution into sustainable steel manufacturing," Hindustan Zinc said in a filing to the BSE.

EcoZen is produced using



renewable energy and has a verified carbon footprint of less than one tonne of CO₂ equivalent per tonne of zinc — about 75 per cent lower than the global industry average.

By significantly reducing emissions at the raw material stage, EcoZen enables down-

stream industries to lower value-chain emissions and advance their decarbonisation goals.

"Our partnership with Tata Steel is a significant milestone in scaling up the adoption of low-carbon zinc and reinforcing greener supply chains across India's industrial ecosystem," Hindustan Zinc CEO Arun Misra said.

Zinc plays an important role in galvanising steel to protect against corrosion and extend service life, making it indispensable across sectors such as infrastructure, automotive, renewable energy, electronics, and energy storage.

RBI purchases net \$2.526 billion from spot market in January

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) purchased net \$2.526 billion of forex from the spot currency market in January, according to the central bank's monthly bulletin released on Monday.

The purchase of US dollars by the central bank came in January after seven straight months of net dollar sales.

Last time, the central bank bought dollars worth \$1.764 billion from the spot currency market in May 2025.

The Reserve Bank of India's monthly bulletin data showed that the central bank net sold \$10.02 billion in December, \$9.710 billion in November, \$11.877 billion in October, \$7.910 billion in September, \$7.695 billion in August, \$2.540 billion in July, and \$3.661 billion in June.

On a gross basis, the Reserve Bank purchased \$27.999 billion in January and sold \$25.473 billion, as per the latest bulletin.

The rupee appreciated against the US dollar in the first week of February amid foreign portfolio inflows and the announcement of the interim India-US trade deal, and remained broadly stable thereafter. In March so far (up to March 20), the rupee came under renewed depreciation pressures amidst elevated global market volatility due to the West Asia conflict.

ASSOCHAM reaffirms India's commitment to BIMSTEC regional co-op vision

Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India (ASSOCHAM), the India Secretariat for the BIMSTEC Business Council under the Ministry of External Affairs, has revitalised the council's India secretariat by launching its leadership framework

NEW DELHI: Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India has reinforced India's commitment to BIMSTEC, aligning with its "Neighbourhood First" and "Act East" policies to strengthen regional cooperation in the Bay of Bengal region.

India, a founding member, has played a proactive role in advancing connectivity, trade facilitation, energy cooperation and capacity building among member states, while supporting institutional strengthening, including the BIMSTEC Secretariat.



ASSOCHAM, the India Secretariat for the BIMSTEC

Business Council under the Ministry of External Affairs,

CLOSER LOOK
» 'BIMSTEC represents a \$5 trillion opportunity. The time is ripe to unlock this potential through deeper trade integration'
» ASSOCHAM said it will support the formation of the BIMSTEC Chamber of Commerce and Industry

has revitalised the council's India secretariat by launching

its leadership framework.

Tribhuvan Darbari, India Chair, BIMSTEC Business Council, said, "BIMSTEC represents a \$5 trillion opportunity. The time is ripe to unlock this potential through deeper trade integration, stronger supply chains, and seamless connectivity. The real opportunity within BIMSTEC lies in converting policy alignment into business outcomes... ASSOCHAM will focus on creating a robust platform for industry-government engagement."

Nirmal K Minda, President, ASSOCHAM, empha-

sised the chamber's vision to strengthen connectivity, empower MSMEs, and unlock investment and innovation opportunities across member nations.

Indra Mani Pandey, Secretary General, BIMSTEC, said, "We need to create dependency regionally rather than depending on the global supply chains... We can deal with such challenges working together."

Saurabh Sanyal, Secretary General, ASSOCHAM, added, "This marks not just an institutional milestone, but a last-

ing commitment to businesses across seven nations."

Diplomats from Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar, Sri Lanka & Thailand participated in the deliberations.

ASSOCHAM said it will support the formation of the BIMSTEC Chamber of Commerce and Industry and work with member nations to boost trade, connectivity, MSME internationalisation, and collaboration in fintech, agri-tech, renewable energy and blue economy ahead of BIMSTEC's 30-year milestone in 2027.

India’s strategic oil reserves about two-thirds full: Minister

India has built strategic underground crude oil storage facilities at — Visakhapatnam in Andhra, and Mangaluru and Padur in Karnataka

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India’s strategic oil reserves, designed to provide cover for about 9.5 days of supplies during disruptions or price shocks, are currently sitting at only two-thirds capacity, the Rajya Sabha was informed on Monday.

India, the world’s third-largest energy consumer and heavily dependent on imports for about 88 per cent of its crude oil needs, has built strategic underground storage facilities with a total capacity of 5.33 million tonnes across three locations — Visakhapatnam in Andhra Pradesh, and Mangaluru and Padur in Karnataka — to store crude oil.

“Quantity of the crude available in the caverns varies depending on market conditions,” Minister of State for Petroleum and Natural Gas Suresh Gopi said in a written reply in the Upper House. “Currently, ISPRL has around 3.372 million tonnes of crude stock available, which is around 64 per cent of the total storage capacity.” Indian Strategic Petroleum Reserve Ltd (ISPRL) is the special purpose vehicle that established strategic petroleum reserves (SPR) facilities with a



total capacity of 5.33 million tonnes of crude oil at three locations, which can act as a buffer for short-term supply shocks. “The actual reserve is a dynamic number depending on the stocks and actual consumption, both of which are not static,” he said. The stockpile has been in focus since the break-out of war in the Middle East snapped the supply of crude oil, natural gas and LPG from the Gulf countries to India. India spent \$110 billion in the first 11 months of the current fiscal year on importing about 226 million tonnes (or 88.7 per cent of oil

needs). Half of this came from countries like Saudi Arabia, Iraq and the UAE, which use a narrow sealane of the Strait of Hormuz for shipping the oil and gas. Besides, \$12.4 billion was spent on importing half of the natural gas consumed in the country from April 2025 to February 2026. Also, 60 per cent of its LPG came from overseas. As much as 85-95 per cent of LPG and 30 per cent of the gas came through the strait. While the disruption in crude oil has been partially offset through alternative sources, such as Russia, West Africa, the US and Latin

Highlights

» ‘Quantity of the crude available in the caverns varies depending on market conditions’

» ‘Currently, ISPRL has around 3.372 mn tonnes of crude stock available, which is around 64% of total storage capacity’

» ‘The actual reserve is a dynamic number depending on stocks & actual consumption, both of which are not static’

America, gas and LPG supplies to industrial and commercial users have been curtailed. Gopi said in July 2021, the government had approved the establishment of two additional commercial-cum-strategic petroleum reserve facilities with a total storage capacity of 6.5 million tonnes, -- Chandikhol (4 million tonnes) in Odisha and Padur (2.5 million tonnes) in Karnataka. “Work for construction at Padur has been awarded on October 1, 2025,” he said. In July 2021, the government also approved the commercial-

ization of Phase -I SPRs under which an agreement was signed between Abu Dhabi National Oil Company (ADNOC) of the UAE, and ISPRL, permitting ADNOC to use Cavern-A with 750,000 tonnes capacity at Mangalore. “The current total national capacity for storage of crude oil and petroleum products is 74 days, which includes the capacity of storage facilities of the oil marketing companies (OMCs),” he said. “The actual reserve is a dynamic number depending on the stocks and actual consumption, both of which are not static.” Gopi said to ensure the security of crude supplies and to mitigate the risk of dependence on crude oil from a single region, oil and gas public sector enterprises (PSEs), which are Board-ran entities, source crude oil from diverse sources depending on their technical and commercial considerations. “Currently, these PSEs import crude oil from 41 countries, including new suppliers like the USA, Nigeria, Angola, Canada, Columbia, Brazil and Mexico in addition to traditional suppliers in the Middle East such as Iraq, Saudi Arabia, UAE, Kuwait and Qatar,” he added.

Two Indian LPG tankers safely sail through Strait of Hormuz

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: On Monday, the government assured everyone that India’s fuel supply remains stable, even though the Strait of Hormuz is closed. Many countries are now trying to save energy because the conflict in West Asia is affecting oil and gas supplies. Officials informed that two Indian ships, Jag Vasant and Pine Gas, safely passed through the Strait of Hormuz on Monday evening.

Together, they are carrying about 92,613 metric tonnes of LPG and are expected to reach India between March 26 and 28. There are 33 sailors on one ship and 27 on the other, officials said.

All Indian sailors in the area are safe, the centre assured further. Currently, 22 Indian ships with about 600 sailors are in the western Persian Gulf region, and 547 sailors have already returned to India.

Senior government officials briefed on the status of fuel supply, shipping and the safety of people, here in the national capital. They said that all refineries in India are working well and have crude oil. There is enough petrol, diesel and LPG available in the country. India is producing more LPG than before.

There are no fuel shortages at outlets. People have been told repeatedly to be restrained from panic booking. The government also emphasised the importance of natural gas for transportation and household use. A controlled gas supply is provided to commercial and industrial

locations. Connections have been requested from city gas companies. In the first three weeks of March, more than 3.5 lakh connections were made. To lower demand, commercial establishments have been asked to switch from LPG to gas.

Centre is also closely monitoring LPG supplies, and officials have informed that the cylinder deliveries are at a normal pace. More commercial LPGs have been provided to states to support the food and hospitality sectors, officials added further.

Additional kerosene has also been given to states. Besides, state governments have been ordered by the centre to prevent hoarding and black-marketing. District administrations have also been asked to conduct inspections. So far, many people have also been arrested.

Officials also confirmed that Indian ports are operating as usual. Extra storage has been built to handle any disturbance, and there is no congestion. The central government prioritises the safety of the local populace.

Meanwhile, Prime Minister Narendra Modi has discussed the situation with foreign leaders. PM Modi emphasised the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz shipping lines, according to the government reports.

On the other hand, the External Affairs Ministry is helping stranded Indians, students and sailors. Since February 28, around 3.75 lakh passengers have returned to India. Special travel arrangements are being made for Indi-

ans in Iran, Israel and other affected countries.

Meanwhile, reportedly, many countries across the world are taking measures to save energy. They are introducing fuel rationing, public holidays and work-from-home rules to reduce consumption. In South Asia, Sri Lanka has started fuel rationing again. Bangladesh has imposed power cuts. Shut educational institutions. Pakistan has moved to a four-day work week. Reduced fuel use. Bhutan and the Philippines have started work-from-home systems. Restricted non-essential travel.

Some Asian countries are also facing shortages. Myanmar has imposed even rules on private vehicles. Cambodia has seen fuel station closures. Laos has ordered working and rotational shifts to reduce commuting.

African countries are also taking various measures. Egypt is closing malls and government offices early to conserve electricity. Kenya is introducing fuel rationing. South Africa is controlling the allocation of petroleum products to prevent panic buying.

In Oceania, New Zealand is considering car-free day policies. They have released fuel from reserves. High jet fuel prices have already forced flight cancellations. European countries like Slovakia and Slovenia are limiting diesel sales to prevent hoarding.

However, officials claimed that India has managed to maintain supplies so far.

I-T dept slaps ₹4,009.64 cr tax under Black Money Act in FY2026 till Dec

During fiscal 2024-25, Rs 4,556.64 crore tax was imposed

NEW DELHI: The income tax department has imposed Rs 4,009.64 crore tax on undisclosed foreign income and assets under the Black Money (Undisclosed Foreign Income and Assets) and Imposition of Tax, 2015 in the nine months of the current fiscal till December 2025.

During the fiscal 2024-25, Rs 4,556.64 crore tax was imposed.

The information was provided by Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary in a written reply to the Lok Sabha on Monday.

Whenever, any credible information relating to undisclosed foreign income and assets is received, the same is investigated and appropri-



ate action is taken under the various Acts administered by the Income-tax Department, including the Income-tax Act, 1961 and the Black Money (Undisclosed Foreign Income and Assets) and Imposition of Tax, 2015, the minister said. He also informed that the total undisclosed foreign income and assets, amounting to Rs 14,636 crore, have

been assessed to tax under the Black Money (Undisclosed Foreign Income and Assets) and Imposition of Tax, 2015, for cases identified under Panama, Paradise and Pandora Paper leaks.

“Till December 31, 2025, 1,368 assessments have been completed under the Black Money (Undisclosed Foreign Income and Assets) and Imposition of Tax Act, 2015, raising tax and penalty demand of over Rs 41,257.08 crore and total 167 prosecution complaints have been filed,” Chaudhary added.

The minister also said there is no official estimation regarding the amount of undisclosed domestic/ foreign income and assets.

Lok Sabha refers Corporate Laws (Amendment) Bill to JPC for analysis and recommendations

NEW DELHI: The Lok Sabha on Monday referred the Corporate Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026, to a joint parliamentary committee comprising members from both Houses of Parliament for a detailed analysis and recommendations. The decision was taken following a voice vote after Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman suggested it.

Earlier, after the Bill was introduced in Lok Sabha, opposition members Manish Tewari (Congress), Saugata Roy (Trinamool Congress) and T Sumathy (DMK) strongly opposed it, alleging that the legislation sought to dilute the provisions of law under which companies mandatorily have to pay 2 per cent of their profits towards corporate social responsibility (CSR).

The finance minister strongly refuted the allega-

The decision was taken following a voice vote after Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman suggested it

tions and said that the Bill has been introduced after two years of deliberations. She said the apprehensions of the members were unfounded as the Bill seeks to amend only the criteria of net profits, not the entire clause related to CSR.

Sitharaman then suggested to Speaker Om Birla that the Bill be sent to a joint parliamentary committee (JPC) for extensive deliberations and proper suggestions. At this, Tewari said that since a parliamentary

standing committee on corporate affairs is already in place, the Bill should be sent to that panel rather than constituting a new JPC.

Intervening the Congress MP, Home Minister Amit Shah said that none of the opposition members talked about referring the legislation to a parliamentary committee, and now, when the finance minister herself has sought it, they were arguing as to which panel the Bill should be sent.

Speaker Birla then put the proposal of the finance minister to a vote, and it was approved with a voice vote by the House, sending the Bill to a JPC for which the members will be selected later. The Corporate Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026, aims to amend the Limited Liability Partnership (LLP) Act, 2008, and the Companies Act to

facilitate ease of doing business and address the gaps identified by the Company Law Committee in its 2022 report.

The Union Cabinet had already okayed the proposed Bill, aimed at further easing the compliance burden on businesses and advancing the government’s agenda of decriminalising minor corporate offences.

The proposed amendments are expected to rationalise penalties, shift several minor procedural lapses from criminal liability to monetary penalties, and streamline regulatory processes to promote ease of doing business. The reforms are also aimed at improving the overall corporate compliance framework while reducing litigation and encouraging a more facilitative regulatory environment for companies and LLPs.

Govt says 11 airlines exited in 10 yrs due to fin stress, other internal issues

NEW DELHI: As many as 11 airlines exited the market in the last 10 years due to financial stress, non-availability of aircraft and other internal issues, according to the government.

Minister of State for Civil Aviation Murlidhar Mohol said Rajya Sabha on Monday that the aviation sector is deregulated, and airlines operate based on commercial considerations.

“Since 2016, a total of 11 airlines have exited the market due to reasons such as financial stress, non-availability of aircraft and other internal issues. Further, AirAsia (India) Pvt. Ltd. (now AIX Connect Pvt. Ltd.) has merged with Air India

Express Ltd., and Tata SIA Airlines Ltd. (Vistara) has merged into Air India Ltd,” he said in a written reply.

To a query on the total outstanding dues of failed airlines to airports, employees, and creditors, Mohol said Kingfisher Airlines had Rs 380.51 crore dues towards the Airports Authority of India (AAI) and the claim has been lodged before the official Liquidator at Bengaluru.

Kingfisher Airlines had stopped operations in 2012. The dues of TruJet towards AAI is Rs 0.03 crore while there are no dues of Jet Airways and Go First.

Centre asks states to prevent small coal retailers from profiteering

“There is no coal shortage and there is no scope for an increase in domestic coal prices,” says Coal Minister

NEW DELHI: The Centre has directed states to prevent small coal retailers from profiteering from the West Asia crisis, as global energy disruptions threaten to ripple into domestic fuel markets.

Talking with reporters on the sidelines of an event here, Coal and Mines Minister G Kishan Reddy said, “Our secretary (coal) has talked to Chief Secretaries of all states. I have written letters to Chief Ministers yesterday. There is no coal shortage and there is no scope for an increase in domestic coal

prices.”

The minister further said that if coal prices increase, it is the responsibility of the state governments to take action.

“We have asked states to keep an eye on coal prices and not let the retailers of coal profit from the ongoing crisis..

The Prime Minister has clearly instructed that coal prices should not increase, and therefore the government has taken proactive measures.

“No decision has been taken on increasing coal prices. Coal prices should not

increase,” the coal minister explained.

The minister also said that there is no shortage of coal in the country and that sufficient dry fuel is available to meet demand.

“We are producing more coal than the current demand,” Reddy said.

For the second year in a row, the country has produced one billion tonnes of coal, the minister said, adding that at some places the coal production had to be slowed as there is no space for storage.

Sebi clears conflict of interest & disclosure framework for top officials

Additionally, the Chairman and Whole Time Members (WTMs) are to be brought within the definition of “insider”

MUMBAI: The board of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) on Monday approved key recommendations of a high-level committee to strengthen conflict-of-interest norms, including mandatory public disclosure of assets and liabilities by its chairman and senior officials.

The panel, chaired by Pratyush Sinha, proposed that the chairman and Whole Time Members (WTMs) be brought under the definition of “insider”, and adhere to stricter disclosure and trading norms. All board members and employees will be required

to make initial, annual, event-based and exit disclosures covering assets, liabilities, trading activities, family relationships and other interests.

Sebi said immovable property details of the chairman, WTMs and senior officials will be publicly disclosed, in line with norms for government service officers, while detailed asset declarations will also be submitted internally. However, part-time members are exempt from these requirements due to their limited role.

The board also approved creation of a digital system to manage conflict-of-interest

CLOSER LOOK

- » All board members and employees will be required to make initial, annual, event-based and exit disclosures covering assets, liabilities, trading activities, family relationships and other interests
- » Sebi said immovable property details of the chairman, WTMs and senior officials will be publicly disclosed, in line with norms for government service officers
- » While detailed asset declarations will also be submitted internally. However, part-time members are exempt from these requirements due to their limited role

disclosures, alongside a whistle-blower mechanism and training programmes to pro-

mote ethical conduct. A formal recusal framework will be introduced to record and pro-

cess cases involving potential conflicts.

In addition, uniform restrictions on investments and trading in equity and related instruments will apply to the chairman and WTMs, similar to existing rules for employees.

Officials must choose from options such as liquidating, freezing, or selling investments under a pre-approved plan upon assuming office.

The committee recommended that investments in equity, including unlisted entities, be either liquidated or frozen during tenure.

Officials must also disclose

any negotiations for future employment.

Some recommendations will be referred to the central government, including proposals for separate regulations governing board members’ conflicts.

The approved measures will be incorporated into Sebi’s existing code and service regulations.

The review was initiated in 2025 following conflict-of-interest allegations involving former Sebi chairperson Madhabi Puri Buch, which were denied by all parties concerned.

Sebi board clears easing fund settlement norms for foreign portfolio investors

MUMBAI: The board of markets regulator Sebi on Monday approved a wide-ranging proposal, including easing fund settlement norms for foreign portfolio investors, and changes to regulatory frameworks for market intermediaries. The committee was chaired by former Chief Vigilance Commissioner Pratyush Sinha.

The board also approved ease-of-doing-business proposals related to real estate investment trusts, infrastructure investment trusts (InvITs) and alternative investment funds (AIFs). It has cleared a proposal



to provide flexibility to AIFs in winding up a scheme.

Also, it proposed to overhaul “fit and proper person” criteria for market intermediaries, which includes removing automatic disqualification triggered by the filing of FIRs, complaints, or charge sheets in economic offence cases.

Axar feels the impact

‘Don’t like it’: Patel questions all-rounder’s role with Impact Player rule

NEW DELHI: An all-rounder himself, Axar Patel on Monday became the latest Indian cricketer to criticise the Impact Player rule in the IPL with a blunt “I don’t like it” response before insisting that it hurts the growth of his tribe.

Rohit Sharma and Hardik Pandya have spoken against the Impact Player rule, which allows teams to substitute anyone in the playing XI with one of the five listed substitutes at any point of the match. It was introduced in 2023 and will stay until at least 2027.

In 2024, Rohit had said that he was not a fan of the strategic rule saying it hampered the development of all-rounders in Indian cricket while the following season, Hardik said it had become to difficult pick an all-rounder in the side unless he was equally good with both bat and ball.

Responding to a query seeking his views on the rule, the Indian T20 vice-captain too weighed in on the subject ahead of his second season as Delhi Capitals captain.

“I don’t like this rule as I am all-rounder myself (laughs). Earlier we used to pick all-rounder for this role (batting and bowling). Now team management goes with a particular batter or bowler, they say why



Delhi Capitals' captain Axar Patel and coach Hemang Badani during a press conference on Monday

do we need an all-rounder?”

“Being an all-rounder myself I don’t like it but at the same time rules are rules. We have to follow them. But personally I don’t like it,” said Axar.

Axar bowled only 204 balls in the last IPL season compared to 264 balls a season earlier. He said it was not because of the Impact Player rule, but a finger injury that had bothered him leading up to the IPL.

“I did not bowl a lot. It wasn’t because of Impact Player. After the Champions Trophy, my spinning finger

“Being an all-rounder myself I don’t like it but at the same time rules are rules. We have to follow them

Axar Patel

got cut. After that it got worse because of the seam of the ball. Later, it developed into

Capitals waiting on Starc

NEW DELHI: Cricket Australia is yet to grant a No Objection Certificate (NOC) to Mitchell Starc for his IPL stint with Delhi Capitals, the franchise said on Monday, but remains hopeful the lead pacer will join the squad before their tournament opener on April 1.

In a media interaction, Delhi Capitals Axar Patel, cricket director Venugopal Rao and head coach Hemang Badani fielded multiple questions on the availability of their pace spearhead. Starc had taken 14 wickets in 11 games last season.

“We are waiting to get the NOC from Cricket Australia. Once we get that, we will know when he will join us,” said Badani. “We are in constant touch with CA. He has been bowling, he had a bowled few days back. Unless Cricket Australia signs off on him that he is fit to play, there is little a franchise can do,” said the coach.

AGENCIES

a deep cut, I was not able to apply pressure and rotation on the ball.

“That is why I was bowling only when required and nursing my finger. After seven games, it became better and I bowled frequently,” said Axar who has been tasked to take Delhi Capitals to their maiden IPL title.

In a matter of 18 months, Axar has become a two-time world champion in the shortest format.

An unprecedented title defence earlier this month has fuelled comparisons with the

invincible Australian team of 2000s though its roaring success came in the ODI format. Some have dubbed the current Indian side as the greatest T20 unit ever.

However, Axar said he doesn’t believe in comparing teams from different eras.

“It all started post 2022, we started playing this brand of cricket and took some tough calls. If this Indian team wants to dominate, we have to continue playing a fearless brand of cricket, change as per the requirement of the game at that time.”

AGENCIES



Mayank Yadav has endured a series of injuries

AFP

Mayank had clocked the fastest delivery by an Indian in IPL 2024

the NCA, Bumrah bhaiya was also there. I have a very good bonding with him. He is like a teacher to me. He also had the same surgery, the same scenario,” he said.

“Bumrah bhaiya shared his experience of how to come back after surgery and what things to pay attention to. He told me how the body will be during recovery, how it will react. Sometimes it will feel good, sometimes not. Whenever we talk on call or mes-

sages, he shares his experience as much as possible,” added Mayank.

On discovering his ability to bowl at high speed, Mayank said he realised it only when IPL trainers measured his pace with a speed gun. “When I came to the IPL for the first time, our trainers used to measure our bowling speed with a speed gun. At that time, I came to know that I have this talent, I have this gift. So now I have to respect it,” said Mayank.

“With fast bowling, things are always a little dicey whether you can do it or not. There is a lot of stress on the body, physically and mentally.”

Mayank said he had always wanted to bowl express pace since childhood.

AGENCIES

Hardik, Sukhjeet, in fray for HI award

NEW DELHI: Star Indian midfielder Hardik Singh, forwards Sukhjeet Singh and Sanjay, and defender Abhishek are in contention for the Hockey India Balbir Singh Sr Player-of-the-Year award for 2025.

In the women’s category, Salima Tete, Navneet Kaur, Lalremiami and Savita have been nominated for the top honour.

The awards ceremony, scheduled to be held here on Friday, will also throw spotlight on emerging talent through the Jugraj Singh Award for Upcoming Player-of-the-Year (U-21 men).

AGENCIES

ASIA CUP

Archers look to conquer Asia sans star power



Rishabh Yadav will lead men's compound section

FILE

BANGKOK: India will kick-start the new international archery season with a fresh-faced squad at the Asia Cup Stage 1, banking on a blend of exciting teenagers and returning veterans instead of established stars in the tournament beginning here on Tuesday.

The team will be without Deepika Kumari, Ankita Bhakat, Dhiraj Bommadevara, Tarundeep Rai, Jyothi Surekha Vennam and Abhishek Verma as the Indian think-tank wants to use the continental opener to test bench strength ahead of a packed season culminating in the Asian Games in Japan come September-October.

The top Indian archers, however, will be back in action with the World Cup’s first two legs in Puebla (Mexico) and Shanghai April on wards.

Despite the absence of its marquee archers, the overall champions would be firm favourites. In the last year’s opening leg, India topped the tally with eight medals, including five gold. The team will look to maintain its dominance on the Asia Cup circuit which has been given a miss by the world heavyweights South Korea.

In Korea’s, India’s main rivals would be China and Bangladesh.

The top Indian archers, however, will be back in action with the World Cup’s first two legs in Mexico and Shanghai

In recurve men’s section Australia’s Ryan Tyack is the top-ranked archer with a ranking of world No.27, while the women’s section has Russian-born neutral athlete Nurinisso Makhmudova (No. 45) as the highest ranked archer.

The spotlight will firmly be on the formidable Indian men’s compound unit, spearheaded by world No.4 Rishabh Yadav alongside Asian Games gold medalist Prathamesh Jawkar and the seasoned Rajat Chauhan.

They will look to defend the title. Last year, Kushal Dalal was the individual champion. He, along with Manav Jadhao and Ganesh Thirimuru, had won the team gold.

Yadav, one of India’s most consistent performers, will be keen to build on his historic World Championships gold in the team event last year.

AGENCIES

‘Not scared of penalties: Humpy backs pulling out of Candidates

SYDNEY: Indian chess great Koneru Humpy stood firm on her decision to pull out of the Candidates tournament in Cyprus later this month, saying one cannot be “surrounded by warships” and still play peacefully, while asserting she is “not scared” of penalties and is not playing for monetary benefits.

Humpy, the two-time World Rapid champion and one of four Indians set to compete in the Candidates in Cyprus from March 28, pulled out of the prestigious event citing safety concerns amid the ongoing Gulf conflict, given the island’s proximity to the volatile region.

Earlier this month, a drone strike on a UK base heightened fears in the region, prompting Humpy to pull out. She has since been replaced by Ukrainian Grandmaster Anna Muzychuk. “You can’t play surrounded by warships, which is guarding the island (Cyprus). If a foreigner like me and being a woman, if I have to travel and that too for such an important tournament, how can I play peacefully?” Humpy said on Monday.

With her late withdrawal, Humpy is the only one among the 16 contestants -- eight in the Open and eight in the



“You can’t play surrounded by warships, which is guarding the island (Cyprus)

Koneru Humpy

women’s section -- to pull out, and while there could be a hefty financial penalty, she said she is not scared.

“See, that’s the point. That is why they (international chess federation FIDE) keep these things (penalties) so that players will not speak out the facts. No, I’m not scared about it. I’m not playing just for money or monetary benefits. I just enjoy

the sport,” Humpy said, adding that she had put in three months of strenuous preparation for the event, even being unable to spend quality time with her daughter.

“The past three months, I have been only working for this tournament. I haven’t spent quality time with my daughter also. So, if a player like me is skipping the tournament, it’s not fun for me to skip such an important tournament. I’m losing a lot of things.”

She said the event could have been postponed by a month or moved to another location without making a significant difference.

“They could host the tournament anywhere in the world. Or, if they were particular about holding it in Cyprus, they could have waited for the situation to settle down. They could wait for another month or so. The tensions would ease and there wouldn’t be any hazards,” said the stalwart, who qualified for the Candidates after finishing runner-up at the Women’s World Cup last year.

On whether she spoke to Viswanathan Anand, vice-president of FIDE, in this regard, Humpy said a conversation did take place but did not disclose the details.

AGENCIES

Swiatek parts with coach after Miami shock

FLORIDA: Wimbledon champion Iga Swiatek has parted company with her coach after her shock first round elimination at the Miami Open, she said on Monday.

In a post on Instagram, the world No. 3 announced her split from Wim Fissette, who she had worked with since 2024 and claimed her first Wimbledon title with last year.

Swiatek, who has won six Grand Slam titles, said shed “decided to take a different path.”

“I’m grateful for his support, experience, and everything we achieved together — including one of my biggest dreams in sport.”

AGENCIES

The 24-year-old from Poland was beaten in three sets by world No. 50 Magda Linette in Miami last week. The defeat ended her run of 73 straight opening-round wins on tour.

“Miami was challenging for me. I feel disappointment, bitterness and responsibility for my performance on the court of course,” she said.

Swiatek said the rest of her team would remain unchanged. “I know there are many questions, but I’ll let you know what’s next at the right time. I’m taking a moment to take care of myself, process this experience, and prepare for a new chapter,” she said.

AGENCIES

SOUTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Follow us on @SCRRailwayIndia
Details of the Tender Notices of S.C. Railway can be seen on our website - www.scr.indianrailways.gov.in

NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER
CEC/ISC & CEC/ISC Construction Organisation, S.C.Railway, Secunderabad, respectively, invites e-tender on behalf of the President of India for the following works:

S. No.: 1, NIT No.: EPC-06-CAO-C-SC-2026 Date: 10/03/2026, **Name of work:** South Central Railway (Construction Organisation) - Engineering, Procurement and Construction (EPC) Contract for (A) Construction of Important bridge No.57 of size 53x61.0m (minimum clear span) over river Krishna with standard RDSO Open Web Girder superstructure (for single line) for 25t axle loading with Well foundation (Foundation, SubStructure including Bed Blocks for two Tracks) including protection works, Track works, over Open Web Girder portion and, (B) Construction of Station building, CPM Camp Office, Platform Works, Approach Track works etc., at Kothapalli halt station and Earth Work in formation for a length of 1033mts on Errupalem end & 534m on Namburu End of Important bridge including construction of Minor and Major Bridges between Amaravati and Parilata stations in connection with Errupalem-Namburu (Via Amaravati) New BG Line in Guntur Division of South Central Railway of Andhra Pradesh state. **Details: Estimated Cost Rs.: 565.83,62,681.09 EMD Rs.: 20000000.00 Completion Period:** 33 (Thirty Three) Months, **Date of Opening:** 15/05/2026 15:00hrs.

S. No.: 2, NIT No.: PMS-03-CAO-C-SC-2026 Date: 13/03/2026, **Name of work:** SCR Construction Organization -Appointment of Authority Engineer for providing project Management services (PMS) for a period of 60 months for the projects of 1.Quadrupling (Laying of New 3rd & 4th Lines) between Wadi & Secunderabad (Sanatnagar) stations (173Kms) in Secunderabad Division of South Central Railway in the States of Telangana and Karnataka. 2.Laying of 3rd & 4th line between Yadadri and Kazipet stations (77.958 Kms) and 4th line between Ghatkesar and Yadadri Stations (32.448 kms) in Secunderabad Division of South Central Railway in the State of Telangana. **Details: Estimated Cost Rs.: 88.35,54,800.00 EMD Rs.: 45,67,800.00 Completion Period:** 60 (Sixty) Months **Date of Opening:** 15/04/2026 15:00hrs.

1. For bid document and other details, please login to website <https://ireps.gov.in>.
2. Tenderers can submit their offers online during tender submission period which is the Fifteen days period prior to closing of tender.
3. Tenderers should watch for any corrigenda (issued online only) up to the date of commencement of the tender submission period.

A2745 Chief Admin.Officer/Const/ Secunderabad

For further tender conditions / details and for downloading the tender documents, Please visit website at <https://www.ireps.gov.in> or www.scr.indianrailways.gov.in

LONDON: The first major domestic trophy of the season is Manchester City’s. And after a dominant 2-0 win against Arsenal in the English League Cup final on Sunday, it may not be the last.

Manchester-born Nico O’Reilly sealed victory with both goals in the second half at Wembley Stadium. The win could also have delivered a psychological blow in the race for the Premier League title as Pep Guardiola aims to chase down Arsenal’s nine-point lead at the top of the standings.

“(It’s an) unbelievable feeling to win a final and to beat this team. We know how good they are,” O’Reilly told Sky Sports. “We need to build on it now, it’ll give us momentum.”

This was serial trophy-winner Guardiola flexing his muscles. It was his 16th major



Manchester City's Nico O'Reilly starred with a brace

AP

trophy as City manager and a record fifth League Cup. He has won 34 career titles as a manager including his time at Barcelona and Bayern Munich.

And, once again, he was

stamping out Arsenal manager Mikel Arteta’s own ambitions, having twice beaten his former assistant to the league title in recent years.

“I’m really pleased because I

The win could also have delivered a psychological blow in the race for the Premier League title as Pep aims to chase them down

know the opponent we played. Mikel created a team that is almost unbeatable,” Guardiola said. “Every time you win a title it looks more difficult than in the past. It is really difficult for many reasons.”

Arsenal remain favorite to be crowned league champion

this season for the first time since 2004, given its big lead. But with second-place City having a game in hand and the teams still to play each other in Manchester at the Etihad Stadium, the picture could look very different in the coming weeks.

Real edge Atletico
MADRID: The cheers were back for Vinicius Junior at the Santiago Bernabeu after the Real Madrid forward scored twice in a 3-2 win over Atletico Madrid on Sunday, keeping his team in the thick of the La Liga title race.

Vinicius had to endure jeers from Madrid’s fans earlier this season following the firing of coach Xabi Alonso and some embarrassing losses. But as the results have improved, so has Vinicius’ reception from Madrid’s supporters.

AGENCIES

Gattuso: ‘No alibis’ for WC playoffs as Chiesa sent home

ROME: Coach Gennaro Gattuso acknowledged that only “someone without blood running through their veins” wouldn’t feel nervous as Italy attempt to avoid failing to qualify for a third consecutive World Cup.

Gattuso is still just as feisty and gritty as when he played on the Italy team that won the country’s fourth World Cup in 2006.

Ahead of Thursday’s playoff match against Northern Ireland, he also suggested he sent home talented winger Federico Chiesa in what could amount to a definitive break with the standout player of the European Championship trophy run five years ago.

“It’s undeniable that there’s nervousness,” Gattuso said Monday. “Only someone without blood running through their veins wouldn’t feel it. But we need to do a good job of transmitting a lot of positivity.”

Positivity, however, is not what describes Italy’s performances in the playoffs for the previous two World Cups, when the Azzurri were eliminated by Sweden and North Macedonia, respectively. Italy are in jeopardy at the same stage for the coming World Cup in North America after two losses to Norway in qualifying. The Azzurri need to beat Northern Ireland at home in Bergamo and then Wales or Bosnia and Herzegovina away next week to avoid going at least 16 years without even playing a match at soccer’s biggest event.

AGENCIES

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tender No.: PRYJ-Sig-430-2025-26

Date: 18.03.2026

E-Tender Notice

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Co-ordination/ North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite **E-TENDER** on prescribed form for the following works up to **15.00 hrs. on 10.04.2026**. The details of the Tender is as under:-

Tender No.: PRYJ-Sig-430-2025-26

Name of work: Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract of Multi Section Digital Axle Counter of Siemens - Make in the section of Sr.DSTE/ALJN of Prayagraj Division for 24 Months.

Approx Cost of work: ₹ 5984222.40/- (Rs. Fifty Nine Lakhs Eighty Four Thousand Two Hundred Twenty Two & Forty Paise Only). **Bid Security/ Earnest Money:** ₹ 119700.00, **Completion Period:** 24 Months, **Date of Closing of tender:** 10.04.2026, **2. Availability of tender form:** Tender forms are available on www.irops.gov.in 21 days prior to date of opening of the tender. **3. Earnest Money to be deposited:** The prescribed amount of Earnest Money above must be deposited along with the tender form. The tenderer(s) should note that, Tenders without earnest money shall be summarily rejected. **4. Time & place of opening of tender:** Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj on or after pre-determined date at **15.30 hours**. In case tender opening date happens to be holiday, tenders will be opened on the next working day. **5. Validity of offer:** 60 days from the date of opening. **6. Right of Railway to deal with tender:** Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/ modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. **650/26 FA**

 North central railways  @CPRONCR  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Pankaj Rawal @ Teetu, S/o Jagdish Rawal, R/o Aali Gaon, Peer Mohalla, Sarita Vihar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 408/2022, U/s 25/54/59 A Act, P.S. Okhla Industrial Area, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Pankaj Rawal @ Teetu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Pankaj Rawal @ Teetu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Pankaj Rawal @ Teetu** accused of **FIR No. 408/2022, U/s 25/54/59 A Act, P.S. Okhla Industrial Area, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.04.2026**.

By Order - Ms. Akansha Gautam
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02, South East
DP/3797/SE/2026 Room No. 513, Saket Courts, New Delhi

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Letter No:- DRM/C/AGRA/NFR/E-AUCTION

Dated : 20.03.2026

E-Auction Notice

On Behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager-North Central Railway-Agra invites E-Auction as per category given as under:-

Category : ADVT Catalogue No. : ADVT-AGRA-RKM-OSN-38-26-1

Asset Details : Commercial publicity via Glow sign/Board at Platform & Concourse Area of Raja ki Mandi Railway station zone Ist.

E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date : 06.04.2026 Time : 11:00

E-Auction End Date and Time : Date : 06.04.2026 Time : 11:30

Category : Misc-Static-Services Catalogue No. : MSS-AGRA-MTJ-EVC-25-25-1

Asset Details : EV Charging station at circulating area of Mathura Jn. railway station.

E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date : 06.04.2026 Time : 11:00

E-Auction End Date and Time : Date : 06.04.2026 Time : 11:30

Category : Misc-Static-Services Catalogue No. : MSS-AGRA-AGC-EVC-24-24-2

Asset Details : EV Charging station at circulating area of Agra cantt. railway station.

E-Auction Start Date and Time : Date : 06.04.2026 Time : 11:10

E-Auction End Date and Time : Date : 06.04.2026 Time : 11:40

Note : Prospective bidders are requested to visit E-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website (www.irops.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. **640/26 (C)**

 North central railways  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in  @ CPRONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Hansraj S/o Site Ram R/o A-123, South Anarkali Near Krishna Nagar, New Delhi** have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 204/2025 U/s 305(A)/331 Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita** has been registered at **PS: Okhla Ind. Area, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said **Hansraj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the **Hansraj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Hansraj** under **FIR No. 204/2025 U/s 305(A)/331 Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita** registered at **PS: Okhla Ind. Area, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.04.2026**.

By Order
Akansha Gautam
Ld. JMFC, Room No. 513
DP/3722/SE/2026 (South East)] 2nd Floor, Saket Courts, Delhi

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tender Notice No. : JHS-NW-23-26

Date : 20.03.2026

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi for and on behalf of President of India invite open Tender through on Line (**E-Tendering**) for the following works.

E-Tender No. : JHS-NW-23-26 Approx Cost : Rs. 8017403.84/-

Description of work : Shifting of existing Telephone Exchange and OFC equipment to new temporary construction office at PF-01 and shifting of temporary Telephone Exchange and OFC equipment to new permanent building regarding Station redevelopment work at Gwalior station.

Earnest Money : Rs. 160400/- Cost of Tender Form : NIL.

Opening of tender : 13.04.2026 Time : 15:00

Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance : 09 Months

* Tender on line can be submitted upto 15:00 hrs on 13.04.2026 * For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.irops.gov.in (NORTH CENTRAL RLY/JHANSI DIVISION-S AND T) **644/26 (AS)**

 @CPRONCR  North central railways  @CPRONCR  @CPRONCR  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Aakash @ Guddu S/o Munna Parsad R/o A-5, Gali No. 16, Bazar Road, Dass Garden, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence Case FIR No. 867/23 U/s 25 Arms Act at P.S. Ranhola, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Aakash @ Guddu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Aakash @ Guddu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Aakash @ Guddu** accused of FIR No. 867/23 u/s 25 Arms Act at P.S. Ranhola, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **30.05.2026**.

By Order: Sh. Ankit Karan Singh,
Metropolitan Magistrate-08, (West)
Room No. 30, Ground Floor,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/3786/OD/2026

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to **Sammaan Capital Limited** (formerly known as **Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.**) [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] ("Secured Creditor"), the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 10.04.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M., for recovery of Rs. 49,56,449/- (Rupees Forty Nine Lakh Sixty Six Thousand Four Hundred Forty Nine only) pending towards Loan Account No. HHLNOD00400973, by way of outstanding principal arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 13.03.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w.e.f. 14.03.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from **IRSHAD SAIFI and SHAHEEN SAIFI**.

The Reserve Price of the Immovable Property will be Rs. 49,50,000/- (Rupees Forty Nine Lakh Fifty Thousand only) and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 4,95,000/- (Rupees Four Lakh Ninety Five Thousand only) i.e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

UNIT NO - G - 505, ADMEASURING 1350 SQ. FEET 5TH FLOOR, TOWER - G (DAPFODIL - 2), FORTUNE RESIDENCY, KHASRA NO. 1123 AND 1116, VILLAGE NOORNAGAR, AT RAJ NAGAR EXTENSION, GHAZIABAD - 201010, UTTAR PRADESH, ALONG WITH ONE STILL CAR PARKING.

For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionbazaar.com.

sd/-
AUTHORISED OFFICER
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED (Formerly known as INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)

Date : 16.03.2026
Place : GHAZIABAD

**UJVN Limited**
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharan Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2673508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website: www.ujvn.com

दिनांक: 23/03/2026

Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer (E&M-SHP), UJVN Ltd., Dharchula District Pithoragarh, invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

Tender No: 08/EE (E&M-SHP)/Dharchula/2025-26

Name of work: "Preventive Maintenance, Up Keeping and Monitoring of 33 KV power evacuation/Overhead Transmission line for 12 Months of 2x2.5 MW Surging Stage -II SHP to 33/11 KV Substation Darati (UPLC) at Tehsil Munseyari in District Pithoragarh".

Estimated cost : ₹ 11,80,812/- GST extra

Date of availability of bid document on website: 23.03.2026, 18:00 hrs.

Last date for submission of tender : 15.04.2026 up to 11:00 hrs

For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "<http://uktenders.gov.in>"

Executive Engineer (E&M-SHP)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

Clix Capital Services Pvt. Ltd. (Clix)
Registered Office: WZ/14, 1st Floor, West Patel Nagar, Delhi, 110008

POSSESSION NOTICE
(Appendix IV Rule 8(1))

Whereas the Authorized officer of CLIX CAPITAL SERVICES PVT. LTD. (Clix), a Non-Banking Financial Company duly incorporated and registered under the Companies Act, 1956, having its Registered Office at: WZ/14, 1st Floor, West Patel Nagar, Delhi, 110008, under the provisions of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 OF 2002) (hereinafter referred to as "Act") and in exercise of the powers conferred under Section 13(2) of the Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rule, 2002 issued a Demand Notice to the below described borrower and co-borrowers to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrower/Guarantor having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under sub-section (4) of Section 13 of Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 as per under mentioned Date. The borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of "CLIX" and interest other charges thereon. The attention of the Borrower is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured asset.

Name & Address Of Borrower/Co-Borrower : 1.MS. ANCHAL SHARMA D/O RAMESH CHANDAR SHARMA, 2. MS. SHARLA SHARMA W/O RAMESH CHANDER SHARMA, BOTH RD - HOUSE NO. 143 GROUND/FIRST FLOOR, E-BLOCK, YADAV NAGAR DELHI-110042, ALSO AT: FLAT NO. SF-3 SECOND FRONT SIDE, WITH ROOF RIGHTS, PLOT NO. A-47, KHASRA NO. 1278, SITUATED AT RESIDENTIAL COLONY, S.L.F., VED VIHAR, HADBAST VILLAGE SADULLABAD, PARGANA LONI TEHSIL & DISST., GHAZIABAD, U.P. SR NO. 1 ALSO AT: RD G-2/16 AND 2ND FLOOR, SECTOR-16, CHHINI NORTH WEST DELHI-110039, SR NO. 2 ALSO AT: HOUSE NO. 27, NATAN PANI, MUNGESHI PUR, QUTABAGARI, NORTH WEST DELHI, DELHI-110039

Demand Notice Dated : 11-Nov-2025, Date of Possession : 18.03.2026
Amount of Demand Notice : Rs.19,72,622.06/- as on 10.11.2025

Details Of Property : "ALL THAT PIECE AND PARCELS OF THE FLAT NO. SF-3 SECOND FRONT SIDE WITH ROOF RIGHTS, PLOT NO. A-47, KHASRA NO. 1278, SITUATED AT RESIDENTIAL COLONY, S.L.F., VED VIHAR HADBAST VILLAGE SADULLABAD PARGANA LONI TEHSIL & DISST., GHAZIABAD, U.P. (AREA MEASURING 65.03 SQ. MTR.) EAST: PLOT NO. A-48 WEST: PLOT NO. ROAD 9 MTR., WIDE NORTH: PLOT NO. A-46 SOUTH: PLOT NO. A-46."

Date : 18.03.2026, Place : Ghaziabad Authorised Officer, Clix Capital Services Pvt. Ltd.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Vimal Kumar S/o Shri Mahendra Singh R/o H. No. 149,150 Bharampuri, Ranhona, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 544/2018 U/s 287/388 IPC, PS Nihal Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Vimal Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Vimal Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Vimal Kumar** in **FIR No. 544/2018 U/s 287/388 IPC, PS Nihal Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.04.2026**.

By order
Ms Komal Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
West District, Room No. 292
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/2665/OD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Surdev Singh, S/o Kashmeera Singh R/o Plot No.11, Nilothi Extn., Top Floor, Delhi** also at **WZ-197, 2nd Floor, Gali No.1, Krishana Puri, Tilak Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.676/2023 U/s 325/341 IPC, P.S. Moti Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Surdev Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Surdev Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Surdev Singh has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Surdev Singh** of **FIR No.676/2023 U/s 325/341 IPC, P.S. Moti Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.05.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Anshul Singhal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04 (West)
Room No.268, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/3496/WD/2026

Clix Capital Services Pvt. Ltd. (Clix)
Registered Office: WZ/14, 1st Floor, West Patel Nagar, Delhi, 110008

POSSESSION NOTICE
(Appendix IV Rule 8(1))

Whereas the Authorized officer of CLIX CAPITAL SERVICES PVT. LTD. (Clix), a Non-Banking Financial Company duly incorporated and registered under the Companies Act, 1956, having its Registered Office at: WZ/14, 1st Floor, West Patel Nagar, Delhi, 110008, under the provisions of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 OF 2002) (hereinafter referred to as "Act") and in exercise of the powers conferred under Section 13(2) of the Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rule, 2002 issued a Demand Notice to the below described borrower and co-borrowers to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrower/Guarantor having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under sub-section (4) of Section 13 of Act read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 as per under mentioned Date. The borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of "CLIX" and interest other charges thereon. The attention of the Borrower is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured asset.

Name & Address Of Borrower/Co-Borrower : 1.Gaurav Sharma S/O Ved Prakash Sharma, 2.Manpreet Sharma W/O Gaurav Sharma, Both At - H.No.-814 Sec -28 & Sec-29 Faridabad, Haryana-121008, SR No. 1 Also At: Laxmi Traders Through Its Proprietor Gaurav Sharma, Khewat No.44 Gadda Colony, Master Road Near Sector 20 By Pass Pull Nihar Pur Faridabad Haryana

Demand Notice Dated : 10-Dec-2025, Date of Possession : 19.03.2026
Amount of Demand Notice : Rs. 80,02,864.22/- as on 09-12-2025

Details Of Property : "All The Part And Pieces Of The Plot Area Measuring 200 Sq. Yds. Adjoining SRI, X-60 Fl. (Area Measuring 100 Sq. Yds. Out Of Plot No. 23, And Plot No. 24, Area 100 Sq. Yds.), Forming Part Of Kharsa No. 2085/1930/323 Min, Khatauni No. 24/32, Total Area Measuring 1 Bigha 13 Biswassa I.E. 4991 Sq. Yards Approx. To The Extent Of 4598 Sq. Yards And Kharsa No. 1930/322, 1930/322/2 Min, Khewat No. 8/46 Min, Situated Within The Revenue Estate Of Faridabad, 16/5, Mathura Road, Tehsil & District Faridabad. The Above Said Plot Area Measuring 200 Sq. Yds. Is Bounded As In East-Plot No. 23-22 (Subhash Chand Aggarwal), In West-Plot No. 25 (Gyanendra Bhowari), North-Other Property & In South-East Road (Hereafter Called The Said Property) And With All Rights Of Whatsoever Kind To Said Property I.E. Mr. Gaurav Sharma (Aadhaar No. 6778 3088 5435) Son Of Sh. Ved Prakash Sharma."

Date : 19.03.2026, Place : Faridabad Authorised Officer, Clix Capital Services Pvt. Ltd.

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Limited
(A Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)
(ISO 9001 : 2015 Certified)
1st Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ring Road No.1, Tebbandha, Raipur(C.G.) - 492006
CIN : U45303CT1981SO00183, PAN : AACSC6188N, GST Reg No.22AACSC628N9ZV
Phone : 0771-4621000, Fax : 0771-2583794
Website : www.csidc.in Email : csidc@csidc.org or csidc@nic.in rajeev@chgoem.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (1st call)
(Through e-Procurement Portal Only)

No.: 40/CSIDC/EE Division/12025-26/Raipur, dated: 20/03/2026

Online tenders are invited in Form-B (Item rate basis) from "A" class Electrical license contractors' Registered in D & Above class in new registration system "Unified Registration System- (e-Registration)" with Chhattisgarh P.W.D website <https://cproc.csstatc.gov.in> at appropriate class, for the following works:-

S.No	Name of Work	Class of Contractor Eligible to Tender	Time allowed including rainy season	Estimated Cost (INR Lacs)	EMD (INR Rs.)	Cost of Tender Doc. (INR) including GST 18%
1	External Electrification Works for Shifting of HT (11 KV) Line at Industrial Area Village- Niyaman Dist. - Jagadpallur (C G)	Registered in D class in new registration system "Unified Registration System- (e-Registration)"	02 Months	15.93 Lacs	12000/-	885/-

The tender document and other details can be downloaded from the web portal (website) <https://cproc.csstatc.gov.in> from 20/03/2026 and shall be submitted online only. Amendment in tender, if any, will only be uploaded on the website and shall not be published in any newspaper

NOTE: 1) The interested tenders for online submission of tender may contact CG eProc Helpdesk Operated by Mjunction Services Limited , they may reach Helpdesk using 18002582502 (from 9 AM to 11 PM) (therein press 2 for CG e-Proc) or you can email them at Helpdesk.cproc@cgswan.gov.in

2) Tenderer may contact to E.E., Div-I, CSIDC, Udyog Bhawan in working hours to clear their doubt if any before online submission of the tender

Executive Engineer
Division-I
samvad 47277/3

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to **Sammaan Capital Limited** (formerly known as **Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.**) [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] ("Secured Creditor"), the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 27.04.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M., for recovery of Rs. 76,92,172/- (Rupees Seventy Six Lakh Ninety Two Thousand One Hundred Seventy Two only) pending towards Loan Account No. HHLRHN00413437, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 13.03.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w.e.f. 14.03.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from **PARDEEP KUMAR KAPOOR, ARCHANA KAPOOR and NAVEEN KAPOOR @ NAVEEN KUMAR KAPOOR**.

The Reserve Price of the Immovable Property will be Rs. 2,31,00,000/- (Rupees Two Crore Thirty One Lakh only) and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 23,10,000/- (Rupees Twenty Three Lakh Ten Thousand only) i.e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

ALL THAT PIECE AND PARCEL OF BUILT - UP FREE HOLD PROPERTY BEARING NO. 99, LAND AREA MEASURING 68.75 SQ. MTRS. IN BLOCK -BK -II, SITUATED AT SHALIMAR BAGH, DELHI - 110088, FROM BOTTOM TO TOP WITH ITS ROOF RIGHTS UPTO SKY, ALONGWITH THE FREE HOLD RIGHTS OF THE LAND UNDERNEATH, WITH ALL FITTINGS AND FIXTURE OF ELECTRIC AND WATER SANITARY CONNECTION, WITH UNDIVIDED SHARE OF THE SAID NORTH : ROAD SOUTH : SERVICE LANE EAST : PROPERTY NO. 100 WEST : PROERTY NO. 98

For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionbazaar.com.

sd/-
AUTHORISED OFFICER
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED (Formerly known as INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)

Date : 16.03.2026
Place : NEW DELHI

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

No. DYCE-I-GSU-PRYJ-07-2026

Dated: 20.03.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Dy. Chief Engineer-II/GSU/Prayagraj, North Central Railway, acting for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-tenders for the following work through **Open Tender-Two Packet System**. Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids up to closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored.

Tender No. : DYCE-I-GSU-PRYJ-07-2026	Approx. Cost of Work (INR): ₹ 163.33 Cr.
Brief Description of work: Construction of 02 Lane ROB (End to End) along with FOB at KM 1153/13-15 in lieu of LC No. 25, 02 Lane ROB (End to End) in lieu of LC No. 26 at Km. 1154/23-25 and 02 Lane ROB (End to End) along with FOB in lieu of LC No. 60 at KM 1226/9-11 in Ambiapur-Tundla Section of Prayagraj Division of North Central Railway	
Amount of EMD (INR): ₹ 3,26.65,500/-	Completion Period: 15 months
Cost of Tender Document: 0.00/-	
Tender Opening date and Time: 14.04.2026, 15:00 Hrs.	

Note:- 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-works tender will be available on website <https://irops.gov.in> up to 15:00 hrs. on the due date of tender opening. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with class III Digital signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. 3. Rate entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head attached by tenderer shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. 4. Documents being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. 5. In case of any difficulty, helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. **645/26 (DG)**

 North central railways  @CPRONCR  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Hemant S/o Lt. Sh. Ashok Kumar R/o C-192, Tarun Garden Extension, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 309/2017 U/S 324/506 IPC, PS Rajouri Garden, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Hemant** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Hemant** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Raj Bahadur** of **FIR No. 309/2017 U/S 324/506 IPC, PS Hemant, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **08.06.2026**.

By Order,
Sh. Shashank Nandan Bhatt
Metropolitan Magistrate (West)
Room No. 356, 3rd Floor
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/3709/WD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **OM Prakash, S/o: Late Isahwar Lala, R/o: Juggi No. 8, Ravi Dass Camp, Near Mother Dairy Mandawali, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 98/2021, U/s: 33 Delhi Excise Act PS: Mandawli, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **OM Prakash**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **OM Prakash**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **OM Prakash**, of **FIR No. 98/2021, U/s: 33 Delhi Excise Act PS: Mandawli, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.05.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sachin
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Room No. 16
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/3733/ED/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Rakesh @ Suraj, S/o: Sehdev Rai, R/o: Jhuggi No. E-79/46, Sonia Vihar Sabji Mandi, Mandawali, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 04/2018 PS: Mandawli, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Rakesh @ Suraj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Rakesh @ Suraj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Rakesh @ Suraj** of **FIR No. 04/2018 PS: Mandawli, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **20.05.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sachin
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Court No. 16
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/3730/ED/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ravi S/o Pyare Lal R/o F-10, Shiv Vihar, Vikas Nagar, Delhi** (2) **Rampura, Phul Nahar Colony, Bhatinda, Punjab** (3) **Village Palasali, Tehsil Tijara, Alwar, Rajasthan-301001 & Gali No. 3, Khui Wala Baba Ka Dera, Bhatinda Road, District Mansa, Chhoti Kainchi, Punjab** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 444/2022 U/S 324/354/354B/109 IPC & 08 POCSO Act, PS Ranhola, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Ravi** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Ravi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ravi** of **FIR No. 444/2022 U/S 324/354/354B/109 IPC & 08 POCSO Act** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **30.04.2026 at 10:00 am**

By Order,

RANBIR KAPOOR, SAIF ALI KHAN TO VEDANG RAINA

MANY FACES OF IMTIAZ ALI'S HEROES

Be it 'Rockstar', 'Love Aaj Kal' or 'Jab We Met', the 'hero' has remained a restless traveller of the heart

OUR CORRESPONDENT

There is a particular kind of hero who walks through an Imtiaz Ali film. He isn't about his swagger. Often, he is confused. Sometimes he is self-ish. But he feels intensely, inconveniently and beautifully. Love, for him, is an experience that rearranges his entire life.

Across two decades of storytelling, Ali has built a gallery of such men. They are romantic without being conventional. They search for meaning through relationships, journeys and memory. With 'Main Wapas Aaunga', a new entrant joins this group of men - Vedang Raina. To understand what this means, it helps to look back at the lover boys who came before him.

Shahid Kapoor: The romantic who learns to live ('Jab We Met')



In 'Jab We Met', Shahid Kapoor's Aditya Kashyap begins as a man who has already given up. He is wealthy, educated and emotionally exhausted. Love does not energise him because he is wounded. What makes this character memorable is his gradual rediscovery of desire. Through Geet's (Kareena Kapoor) chaos and warmth, he learns that romance begins with finding one's own self. He must first find the will to live before he can find the courage to love. This is a template: the Imtiaz Ali man is often broken before he becomes whole.

Saif Ali Khan: Love across time ('Love Aaj Kal')



Saif Ali Khan's Sai is modern and practical and someone who believes relationships must fit into life's schedule. Yet the film reveals the fragility of this logic. Love refuses to obey timelines. It lingers, returns and complicates. Running parallel to Sai's story is an older love tale, suggesting that love is timeless.

Ranbir Kapoor: The artist who can't escape himself ('Rockstar', 'Tamasha')

Few actors have embodied Ali's emotional universe as fully as Ranbir Kapoor. In 'Rockstar', Jordan's hunger for love and recognition turns destructive. In 'Tamasha', Ved struggles with a different crisis, the suffocation of routine and eventually finds a release by finding the artist in him. He must accept his own fragmented self before he can commit to another person. These characters expanded the Imtiaz Ali hero from romantic wanderer to existential seeker. Love took a philosophical turn here.



Avinash Tiwary: Devotion as destiny ('Laila Majnu')



With 'Laila Majnu', which the director wrote, he returned to a more classical idea of romance. Avinash Tiwary's Qais does not evolve in love. Instead, he dissolves into love completely. This is yearning in its rawest form possible... It is obsessive, spiritual and tragic.

Diljit Dosanjh: Love, fame and loneliness ('Amar Singh Chamkila')



In 'Amar Singh Chamkila', Diljit Dosanjh plays the titular character and portrays a man adored by crowds yet haunted by his own demons. Romance exists, but that's not the defining part of this artist; it was his hunger to perform. This iteration of the Imtiaz Ali hero is rooted in reality. He is shaped by class mobility, artistic hunger and public scrutiny. Love becomes both refuge and risk. Like every Imtiaz Ali, he loves dangerously and his story meets the inevitable tragic ending.

Vedang Raina: The promise that refuses to fade ('Main Wapas Aaunga')

Now comes Vedang Raina, stepping into this lineage with the role of a young Punjabi man separated from his beloved by the violence of Partition. His character in the upcoming film 'Main Wapas Aaunga' evokes memories of a bygone era and his promise to return is the story we are hoping to chase. What makes this casting intriguing is the actor's unpredictability. A Gen-Z boy playing a man from the 40s is an enchanting choice. Unlike his predecessors, Vedang arrives like a fresh slate here. This allows the performance to feel unburdened, almost fragile. He also carries the responsibility of portraying a character whose later life is shaped by decades of absence. In doing so, he must build on the art of longing.

Across his films, the Imtiaz Ali hero has remained a restless traveller of the heart, searching, stumbling and loving with a sincerity that often costs him everything.



Soulful Blues returns to Mumbai this weekend

This year's two-day festival will be held this weekend, from March 28 to March 29



JAI TALWAR



Shakura S'Aida and Sugaray Rayford will headline the music festival

NCPA Soulful Blues two-day festival in Mumbai has become an eagerly awaited event ever since its inception in 2003. The festival has featured award-winning artists such as Demetria Taylor, Terrie Odabi and Thornetta Davis, amongst a few others. Last year, it expanded into a three-day festival.

This year's two-day festival, being held this weekend on March 28 and March 29, will feature Shakura S'Aida on the first day and on day two, headlining the festival will be Grammy-nominated Sugaray Rayford.

Shakura S'Aida is a Canadian blues vocalist, songwriter and actress also known as Shakura. Although born in Brooklyn, USA, she moved to Switzerland, finally settling in Canada. She has also performed as a backing vocalist for Rita MacNeil and Patti LaBelle, as well as with jazz musicians such as Jimmy Smith and has won numerous blues awards. As an actress, she has acted in numerous television shows as well as theatre. In 2010, she won the 'Female Vocalist of the Year' at the

Maple Blues Awards and in 2013 was nominated for 'Contemporary Blues Female Artist' at the Blues Music Awards. She is known for her dynamic and deeply emotional performance style.

Sugaray Rayford is an American soul blues singer and songwriter from Texas and has released five albums to date, winning three Blues Music Awards. His 2019 album, 'Somebody Save Me' was nominated for a Grammy Award in the 'Best Contemporary Blues Album'. Rayford's vocals have an earthy and powerful old-school blend of soul, blues and funk, with a gospel feel. His album 'In Too Deep' released in 2022, was cited as 'Soul Blues Album of the Year' at the 2023 Blues Music Awards. He performed at the Mahindra Blues Festival in February 2019 and one is looking forward to his finale concert at the festival.

Aditya Dhar leads IMDb's 'Popular Indian Celebrities List' for 'Dhurandhar'

OUR CORRESPONDENT



Akshaye Khanna, who was in 'Dhurandhar', is in 16th position

The 'IMDb Popular Indian Celebrities' list this week is led by the cast and crew of 'Dhurandhar: The Revenge'.

Director Aditya Dhar is in 1st position, followed by the cast securing top ranks with Sara Arjun on 2nd position, Ranveer Singh on 3rd position, Udaybir Sandhu on 7th, Arjun Rampal on 9th, Saumya Tandon on 10th, Gaurav Gera on 12th, Danish Iqbal on 13th and Rakesh Bedi on the 20th spot. Akshaye Khanna, who was in 'Dhurandhar', is in 16th position.

The list also features Anaswara Rajan in the 6th spot, as her film 'With Love' was recently released on OTT. Jatin Goswami, who is a part of the recently released third season of Aspirants, is in the 14th spot.

'There's a lot of hate online'

Barry Keoghan said he receives a lot of hate online about his looks

LONDON: Irish actor Barry Keoghan said he receives a lot of hate online about his looks and feels disappointed that his three-year-old son, Brando, will have to read all the comments as he grows up.

The 'Saltburn' star said he does have 'an incredible fanbase', but there is also a 'nasty side'. "There's a lot of hate online. It's a lot of abuse of how I look," he said on SiriusXM's 'The Morning Mash Up', according to the entertainment news magazine 'People'. He added, "It's also disappointing that my little boy has to read all of this stuff when he gets older."

Keoghan welcomed Brando

Keoghan said such comments made him 'shy away' and prefer not 'to go outside' and admitted it is becoming an issue

in August 2022 with his ex-girlfriend Alyson Sandro. The actor removed his social media handles back in 2024 following the intense online abuse after his breakup with singer Sabrina Carpenter.

Keoghan said such comments made him 'shy away' and prefer

not 'to go outside' and admitted it is becoming an issue. "But I'm still a curious human being that wants to go on... If I attend an event or if I go somewhere, I want to see how it was received and it's not nice... It's made me shy away; it's made me really go inside myself and not want to attend places and go outside," he said.

"And I say this, being absolutely pure and honest to you. It's becoming a problem... I actually don't go to places because of these things," he concluded.

The actor is currently shooting for "The Beatles: A Four-Film Cinematic Event", a film by Sam Mendes.



Arijit Singh introduced me to Pritam da: Aarvan

From Murshidabad to Mumbai, his song 'Ram Ji Aake Bhala Karenge' from 'Bhoot Bangla' is trending

ANINDITA ACHARYA

Young singer Aarvan, earlier known as Dev Arijit, shares a strong musical connection with Arijit Singh, not by blood, but through roots and rhythm. Both are from Murshidabad in West Bengal and it was Singh who introduced him to Pritam in Mumbai, just like he himself had once started with the composer. Growing up in Berhampore, close to Arijit's Jiaganj, Aarvan took to Indian classical music after Class 10 and also played in an alt-rock band in Murshidabad. That's when he met Singh, went on to assist him, joined his live band and toured the world.

He moved to Mumbai in 2013 and joined Pritam's core team. His big break came when he recorded the scratch of 'Ram Ji Aake Bhala Karenge', for Akshay Kumar's upcoming horror-comedy 'Bhoot Bangla' and it ended up being used in the final version. Working on a project linked to Priyadarshan and Akshay is a big moment for someone who's mostly worked behind the scenes.

Even before this breakthrough, Aarvan had made his mark in Bengali cinema with tracks like 'Rajar Raja' from 'Khadaan' and 'Bidroher Gaan' from 'Adama'. Today, however, he is widely recognised as the voice behind the trending 'Ram Ji Aake Bhala Karenge'. In a chat with 'Millennium Post', the young singer talks about his journey, his learnings from Arijit Singh and his ambition to lend his voice for leading



"In the case of 'Ram Ji Aake Bhala Karenge', I originally sang the scratch"

stars across the film industry.

The first track, 'Ram Ji Aake Bhala Karenge', from Akshay Kumar-starrer 'Bhoot Bangla' is viral and also courted controversy. Being a part of Pritam's core team, how did you end up being the key voice of the film?

Being part of Pritam da's team, one of my main roles is singing scratch versions when we present a song. In the case of 'Ram Ji Aake Bhala Karenge', I originally sang the scratch. They were looking for a distinct voice texture and style and I gave it my best. Everyone felt it suited the track, so they kept my voice in the final version. I've spent

years learning, doing scratches and understanding how songs are built while working with Pritam da and the team. So, this feels like I have achieved a milestone.

Why have you changed your name from Dev Arijit to Aarvan?

My actual name is Arijit Dev. Initially, I performed under the name 'Dev Arijit' as my artist identity. However, in 2025, I switched to Aarvan for better uniqueness and internet searchability. I also wanted to avoid the confusion of listeners because there's 'Arijit' in my name. I belong to a small town called Berhampore, Murshidabad. I had an

alt-rock band in Murshidabad. During that time, I met Arijit Singh, who introduced me to Pritam da. I moved to Mumbai in 2013 and that's how my journey really began.

Both Arijit Singh and you hail from Murshidabad in West Bengal. Arijit was a crucial part of Pritam's music team early in his career. Today, Arijit is a global name. Do you follow his career closely and do you share a close bond with him?

Yes, we both come from Murshidabad in Bengal and that connection is special to me. In fact, I assisted Arijit Singh and was part of his live band,

touring with him around the world. I've learned so much from him, musically and beyond and I truly consider him one of my gurus. I do follow his career closely, and his journey from our Jiaganj to being a global name is truly inspiring.

Arijit Singh has announced his retirement from playback singing now.

I believe this is his step towards exploring even greater creative horizons. I think he's pursuing the things he's always wanted to do. So, this step away from playback singing is simply him focusing on other aspects of his creativity. In the end, I think we'll see him shine in new ways.

With Arijit Singh retiring from playback, do you see yourself taking his place in the future?

Not at all. Arijit Singh is Arijit Singh. There's no taking his place... He's one of the finest in the industry has ever seen. My focus is different... I'm committed to making more music, including independent songs that reflect my own thoughts and style, while continuing playback singing as well. For me, it's about growing and expressing myself through different avenues of music.

How do you plan to take your career forward?

The plan is to keep working on more great compositions where I can lend my voice. As a singer, my dream is to sing for all my matinee idols and the great superstars of our industry.

RAY OF CONTROVERSY



'Ram Ji Aake Bhala Karenge' has found its audience, but many in Bengal aren't happy with the way the music of Satyajit Ray's cult classic 'Goopy Gyne Bagha Byne' has been utilised. Do you think this 'tribute' is justified?

■ I completely understand why people in Bengal feel strongly. The music of 'Goopy Gyne Bagha Byne' is iconic and anything tied to Satyajit Ray carries deep cultural weight. That said, compositionally and scale-wise, both songs are different. The only real similarity is the use of the word 'Bhoot' at the end, which ties into 'Bhoot Bangla'. If we go deeper into the composition, Satyajit Ray's song 'Bhoot Raja Dilo Bor' from the film 'Goopy Gyne Bagha Byne' has an 'antara' that begins with a major scale progression, 'Ga Ma Pa', 'Pa Ma Ga' with 'Shuddha Ga'. In contrast, our song is composed on a minor scale using 'Komal Ga', with a melodic phrase like 'Re Re Ga', 'Ga Re Sa'. Composition-wise, the songs are completely different.

■ I feel the intention here was never to disrespect the original work but to pay tribute to something that has been such an important part of our cinematic and musical heritage. When a classic inspires new interpretations, reactions can be mixed and that's natural.

■ Of course, the original created by Satyajit Ray will always remain timeless and untouchable in its own space. Having said that, we all know that today's generation listens to global music like K-pop and many may not have heard this beautiful classic by Satyajit Ray if our song encourages younger audiences to discover that legendary track, which would truly make it a tribute.